

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-08-10T10:30:14

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/v2/noise2i_memprimary_game_myth/claude-sonnet-4.5/game_myth/noisy_bidirectional_informed_memprimary/noise2i_memprimary_game_myth_004_neutral_rep04_memtest_memory_primary_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 2
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_bidirectional_informed_memprimary
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 1.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 4
myth_prompt_arm_id: memtest_memory_primary
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_directive
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_directive_memory_primary
history_policy: minimal
self_history_window: 1
coplayer_history_window: 0
show_agent_names: true
defector_ratio_requested: 0.0
defector_ratio_actual: 0.0
defector_count: 0
defector_agent_ids: []
defector_seed: 4
task_order: [
  "game",
  "myth"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
agent_types: {
  "Agent_1": "standard",
  "Agent_2": "standard"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=2

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=2

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

ROUND 1

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$5; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$7, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$4; noise/visible: sent visible=\$3.56, received visible=\$10.68, returned visible=\$4.62

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 7.0,
"Agent_2": 4.0

}

```
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 6.62,
  "Agent_2": 5.68
}
```

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:18:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I'm playing as the SENDER in Round 1 with no previous myths or interaction history to reference.

Since this is the first round, I'll need to make a decision based on reasonable trust and cooperation principles. The 3x multiplier creates potential mutual benefit, but there's also risk if the receiver doesn't reciprocate.

I'll send a moderate amount to signal willingness to cooperate while managing initial uncertainty:

```
{'send': 3}
```

This sends \$3, which becomes \$9 for the receiver. If they choose to return approximately half (around \$4-5), we'd both benefit from the cooperation. This seems like a balanced approach for establishing trust in Round 1.

Reasoning:

This is the first round and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the game theory here:

- If I send money, it gets multiplied by 3x
- The receiver then decides how much to return
- This is a trust game

The key question is: how much can I trust the receiver to return a fair amount?

Since this is Round 1, I have no history with this receiver. There are no myths written yet that I need to consider.

From a purely selfish perspective, I could send \$0 and keep all \$5. But that means missing out on potential gains from the 3x multiplier.

From a cooperative perspective, if I send \$5, the receiver gets \$15. If they split it evenly with me, they'd return \$7.50, giving me \$7.50 total (more than my initial \$5). They'd keep \$7.50 too.

A middle ground strategy might be:

- Send \$3: Receiver gets \$9. If they return \$4-5, we both benefit.
- Send \$2: Receiver gets \$6. If they return \$3-4, it's fair.

Given this is an experiment and there's mention of "communication noise," I should probably show some trust to establish cooperation. However, I shouldn't be too naive.

I'll send \$3 as a moderate trust signal. This shows willingness to cooperate while not being overly risky.

Actually, let me reconsider. The instructions mention there may be "communication noise" - amounts seen may differ from what was actually sent/returned. This adds uncertainty.

A reasonable first-round strategy might be to send a moderate amount - say \$2 or \$3 - to signal cooperation while managing risk.

I'll go with \$3.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 380,  
  "output_tokens": 567,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:19:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.56, that is 71.2% of their total endowment. You received \$10.68. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.68)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

- The sender showed significant trust by sending \$3.56 (71.2% of their endowment)
- I received \$10.68 after the 3x multiplication
- The sender currently has \$1.44 remaining

The sender took a considerable risk by trusting me with such a large portion of their endowment. I want to reciprocate that trust while ensuring we both benefit from this cooperation.

If I return \$5.00:

- The sender ends with: $\$1.44 + \$5.00 = \$6.44$ (profit of \$1.44)
- I end with: $\$10.68 - \$5.00 = \$5.68$ (profit of \$5.68)

This rewards the sender's high trust with a positive return while both of us benefit from the exchange.

{'return': 5.00}

Reasoning:

I'm in the role of RECEIVER in this trust game. Let me analyze the situation:

- The sender sent \$3.56 (which is 71.2% of their \$5 endowment)
- I received \$10.68 (which is $\$3.56 \times 3$)
- I need to decide how much to return (between \$0 and \$10.68)

Key considerations:

1. The sender showed significant trust by sending 71.2% of their endowment
2. The note mentions there may be communication noise, so the actual amount sent might differ slightly
3. No myths have been written in this session yet
4. I should consider reciprocity and fairness

Let me think about fair returns:

- If I return nothing, the sender gets $\$5 - \$3.56 + \$0 = \1.44 , and I get \$10.68
- The sender took a risk trusting me with a large portion of their endowment
- A fair approach might be to ensure both players benefit approximately equally

The sender has \$1.44 remaining after sending \$3.56.

If I want us to end up roughly equal:

- Total money in the system: $\$5$ (sender's initial) + \$10.68 (what I received) = \$15.68
- If split equally: each gets \$7.84

For the sender to get \$7.84:

- They have \$1.44 already
- Need: $\$7.84 - \$1.44 = \$6.40$ returned

For me to get \$7.84:

- I have \$10.68
- After returning \$6.40, I'd have $\$10.68 - \$6.40 = \$4.28$

Hmm, that's not quite equal. Let me recalculate:

- Sender's final: $\$1.44 + \$6.40 = \$7.84$
- My final: $\$10.68 - \$6.40 = \$4.28$
- This creates an imbalance where the sender ends up with more

The total pool is \$15.68, and splitting it equally would give each of us \$7.84. Since the sender currently has \$1.44, they need \$6.40 back from me. But if I return \$6.40, I'm left with only \$4.28, which is less than the equal split. I need to find a return amount that actually creates parity for both of us.

Let me recalculate the total value in play. The sender's original \$5 endowment plus my tripled amount of \$10.68 gives us \$12.12 combined. An equal split would be \$6.06 each. The sender needs \$4.62 more to reach that threshold, which means I'd keep \$6.06 if I return exactly that amount.

But I'm also considering the sender's high trust level-they sent 71.2% of their endowment. Returning something closer to \$5 feels more appropriate: it rewards their trust, keeps the interaction fair, and still leaves me with a reasonable benefit of \$5.68.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 409,  
  "output_tokens": 1453,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:19:13

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 1,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I'm playing as the SENDER in Round 1 with no previous myths or interaction history to reference.

Since this is the first round, I'll need to make a decision based on reasonable trust and cooperation principles. The 3x multiplier creates potential mutual benefit, but there's also risk if the receiver doesn't reciprocate.

I'll send a moderate amount to signal willingness to cooperate while managing initial uncertainty:

```
{'send': 3}
```

This sends \$3, which becomes \$9 for the receiver. If they choose to return approximately half (around \$4-5), we'd both benefit from the cooperation. This seems like a balanced approach for establishing trust in Round 1.

reasoning:

This is the first round and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the game theory here:

- If I send money, it gets multiplied by 3x
- The receiver then decides how much to return
- This is a trust game

The key question is: how much can I trust the receiver to return a fair amount?

Since this is Round 1, I have no history with this receiver. There are no myths written yet that I need to consider.

From a purely selfish perspective, I could send \$0 and keep all \$5. But that means missing out on potential gains from the 3x multiplier.

From a cooperative perspective, if I send \$5, the receiver gets \$15. If they split it evenly with me, they'd return \$7.50, giving me \$7.50 total (more than my initial \$5). They'd keep \$7.50 too.

A middle ground strategy might be:

- Send \$3: Receiver gets \$9. If they return \$4-5, we both benefit.
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Given this is an experiment and there's mention of "communication noise," I should probably show some trust to establish cooperation. However, I shouldn't be too naive.

I'll send \$3 as a moderate trust signal. This shows willingness to cooperate while not being overly risky.

Actually, let me reconsider. The instructions mention there may be "communication noise" - amounts seen may differ from what was actually sent/returned. This adds uncertainty.

A reasonable first-round strategy might be to send a moderate amount - say \$2 or \$3 - to signal cooperation while managing risk.

I'll go with \$3.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 380,
```



```
"output_tokens": 567,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

```
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

****The Parable of the Twin Rivers****

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Neither could reach the sea alone, for the land was too dry and swallowed their waters.

A wanderer arrived carrying five seeds. The Oracle told him: "Plant what you will in the River of Giving. Its magic waters will triple whatever grows there, but only the River of Return can carry the harvest back to you."

The wanderer hesitated. If he planted nothing, he'd keep his five seeds but gain nothing more. If he planted all five, he'd risk everything on the River of Return's generosity.

Wisely, he planted three seeds. The River of Giving's waters worked their magic, and nine golden fruits grew on the far bank. The River of Return, seeing the wanderer's trust, carried back five fruits-more than he'd planted.

Both rivers swelled with this exchange. The wanderer prospered. The valley bloomed.

The Oracle smiled: "True abundance flows not from hoarding, but from the cycle of giving and return. Trust begets trust, and the waters rise for all."

Thus the rivers learned to dance together, each feeding the other, until they reached the sea as one.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience so far. I've just sent \$3 in Round 1, showing moderate trust and cooperation.

The myth should capture themes from the trust game:

- The multiplier effect (3x)
- Risk and trust
- Reciprocity and return
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- The balance between self-interest and cooperation

I'll create a myth that embodies these principles and suggests how the game should be played - with trust, reciprocity, and recognition that cooperation benefits both parties.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 599,  
"output_tokens": 422,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

```
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:19:16

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",  
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent_2": "Briar"  },
```

```
"agents": [  
  "Agent_1",
```

```

    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.56, that is 71.2% of their total endowment. You received \$10.68. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.68)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

- The sender showed significant trust by sending \$3.56 (71.2% of their endowment)
- I received \$10.68 after the 3x multiplication
- The sender currently has \$1.44 remaining

The sender took a considerable risk by trusting me with such a large portion of their endowment. I want to reciprocate that trust while ensuring we both benefit from this cooperation.

If I return \$5.00:

- The sender ends with: $\$1.44 + \$5.00 = \$6.44$ (profit of \$1.44)
- I end with: $\$10.68 - \$5.00 = \$5.68$ (profit of \$5.68)

This rewards the sender's high trust with a positive return while both of us benefit from the exchange.

```
{'return': 5.00}
```

reasoning:

I'm in the role of RECEIVER in this trust game. Let me analyze the situation:

- The sender sent \$3.56 (which is 71.2% of their \$5 endowment)
- I received \$10.68 (which is $\$3.56 \times 3$)
- I need to decide how much to return (between \$0 and \$10.68)

Key considerations:

1. The sender showed significant trust by sending 71.2% of their endowment
2. The note mentions there may be communication noise, so the actual amount sent might differ slightly
3. No myths have been written in this session yet
4. I should consider reciprocity and fairness

Let me think about fair returns:

- If I return nothing, the sender gets $\$5 - \$3.56 + \$0 = \1.44 , and I get \$10.68
- The sender took a risk trusting me with a large portion of their endowment
- A fair approach might be to ensure both players benefit approximately equally

The sender has \$1.44 remaining after sending \$3.56.

If I want us to end up roughly equal:

- Total money in the system: $\$5$ (sender's initial) + $\$10.68$ (what I received) = $\$15.68$
- If split equally: each gets \$7.84

For the sender to get \$7.84:

- They have \$1.44 already
- Need: $\$7.84 - \$1.44 = \$6.40$ returned

For me to get \$7.84:

- I have \$10.68
- After returning \$6.40, I'd have $\$10.68 - \$6.40 = \$4.28$

Hmm, that's not quite equal. Let me recalculate:

- Sender's final: $\$1.44 + \$6.40 = \$7.84$
- My final: $\$10.68 - \$6.40 = \$4.28$
- This creates an imbalance where the sender ends up with more

The total pool is \$15.68, and splitting it equally would give each of us \$7.84. Since the sender currently has \$1.44, they need \$6.40 back from me. But if I return \$6.40, I'm left with only \$4.28, which is less than the equal split. I need to find a return amount that actually creates parity for both of us.

Let me recalculate the total value in play. The sender's original \$5 endowment plus my tripled amount of \$10.68 gives us \$12.12 combined. An equal split would be \$6.06 each. The sender needs \$4.62 more to reach that threshold, which means I'd keep \$6.06 if I return exactly that amount.

But I'm also considering the sender's high trust level—they sent 71.2% of their endowment. Returning something closer to \$5 feels more appropriate: it rewards their trust, keeps the interaction fair, and still leaves me with a reasonable benefit of \$5.68.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 409,
  "output_tokens": 1453,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have

been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Multiplying Bridge

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a misty chasm. The gods built a sacred bridge between them with a mysterious power: any gift carried across would triple in weight by journey's end.

The First Villager approached the bridge carrying grain. Fear whispered, "What if they keep it all?" But courage won. She carried seventy portions across—a great share of her harvest.

When she arrived, the grain had become two-hundred-ten portions. The Second Villager faced his own test. "I could keep everything," Greed murmured. But Wisdom spoke louder: "She trusted you with her sustenance."

The Second Villager returned half the bounty. The First Villager went home richer than before, and the Second Villager kept abundance for his people.

The bridge taught them: trust must be met with fairness. Those who send much deserve return. Those who receive must honor the gift.

The gods smiled, for they had learned the sacred balance: when one extends trust and the other reciprocates with honor, both villages prosper beyond what either could achieve alone.

The bridge remains, waiting for those brave enough to cross with open hands, trusting in the ancient covenant: generosity answered with generosity creates wealth that hoarding never could.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on the game I've been playing so far.

In Round 1, I was the receiver. The sender sent \$3.56 (71.2% of their endowment), showing significant trust. I returned \$5.00, which rewarded their trust while ensuring we both benefited.

Key themes from this game:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Risk-taking
- Mutual benefit
- Fair sharing
- Cooperation creating value (the 3x multiplier)

I should write a myth that captures these themes. Let me think of a mythic setting that could work well...

Perhaps something about:

- A bridge between two lands
- A gift that multiplies
- A river that grows what's placed in it
- Seeds that multiply
- A bargain between two beings

Let me write a myth about trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation creates value for both parties.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 679,  
  "output_tokens": 516,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

****The Parable of the Twin Rivers****

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through a barren valley—the River of Giving and the River of Return. Neither could reach the sea alone, for the land was too dry and swallowed their waters.

A wanderer arrived carrying five seeds. The Oracle told him: "Plant what you will in the River of Giving. Its magic waters will triple whatever grows there, but only the River of Return can carry the harvest back to you."

The wanderer hesitated. If he planted nothing, he'd keep his five seeds but gain nothing more. If he planted all five, he'd risk everything on the River of Return's generosity.

Wisely, he planted three seeds. The River of Giving's waters worked their magic, and nine golden fruits grew on the far bank. The River of Return, seeing the wanderer's trust, carried back five fruits-more than he'd planted.

Both rivers swelled with this exchange. The wanderer prospered. The valley bloomed.

The Oracle smiled: "True abundance flows not from hoarding, but from the cycle of giving and return. Trust begets trust, and the waters rise for all."

Thus the rivers learned to dance together, each feeding the other, until they reached the sea as one.

Agent_2 (Briar)

The Myth of the Multiplying Bridge

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a misty chasm. The gods built a sacred bridge between them with a mysterious power: any gift carried across would triple in weight by journey's end.

The First Villager approached the bridge carrying grain. Fear whispered, "What if they keep it all?" But courage won. She carried seventy portions across-a great share of her harvest.

When she arrived, the grain had become two-hundred-ten portions. The Second Villager faced his own test. "I could keep everything," Greed murmured. But Wisdom spoke louder: "She trusted you with her sustenance."

The Second Villager returned half the bounty. The First Villager went home richer than before, and the Second Villager kept abundance for his people.

The bridge taught them: trust must be met with fairness. Those who send much deserve return. Those who receive must honor the gift.

The gods smiled, for they had learned the sacred balance: when one extends trust and the other reciprocates with honor, both villages prosper beyond what either could achieve alone.

The bridge remains, waiting for those brave enough to cross with open hands, trusting in the ancient covenant: generosity answered with generosity creates wealth that hoarding never could.

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3.5; received \$10.5; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$1.45; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$2.95, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$9.05; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.97, received visible=\$2.91, returned visible=\$1.59

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 1.45, "clamped": false, "max": 10.5, "min": 0, "raw": 1.45}, "sent": {"amount": 3.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 16.05,
"Agent_2": 6.95

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 8.08,
"Agent_2": 8.77

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:19:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.56, that is 71.2% of their total endowment. You received \$10.68. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.68)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

- The sender showed significant trust by sending \$3.56 (71.2% of their endowment)
- I received \$10.68 after the 3x multiplication
- The sender currently has \$1.44 remaining

The sender took a considerable risk by trusting me with such a large portion of their endowment. I want to reciprocate that trust while ensuring we both benefit from this cooperation.

If I return \$5.00:

- The sender ends with: $\$1.44 + \$5.00 = \$6.44$ (profit of \$1.44)
- I end with: $\$10.68 - \$5.00 = \$5.68$ (profit of \$5.68)

This rewards the sender's high trust with a positive return while both of us benefit from the exchange.

{'return': 5.00}

reasoning:

I'm in the role of RECEIVER in this trust game. Let me analyze the situation:

- The sender sent \$3.56 (which is 71.2% of their \$5 endowment)
- I received \$10.68 (which is $\$3.56 \times 3$)
- I need to decide how much to return (between \$0 and \$10.68)

Key considerations:

1. The sender showed significant trust by sending 71.2% of their endowment
2. The note mentions there may be communication noise, so the actual amount sent might differ slightly
3. No myths have been written in this session yet
4. I should consider reciprocity and fairness

Let me think about fair returns:

- If I return nothing, the sender gets $\$5 - \$3.56 + \$0 = \1.44 , and I get \$10.68
- The sender took a risk trusting me with a large portion of their endowment
- A fair approach might be to ensure both players benefit approximately equally

The sender has \$1.44 remaining after sending \$3.56.

If I want us to end up roughly equal:

- Total money in the system: $\$5$ (sender's initial) + $\$10.68$ (what I received) = $\$15.68$
- If split equally: each gets $\$7.84$

For the sender to get \$7.84:

- They have \$1.44 already
- Need: $\$7.84 - \$1.44 = \$6.40$ returned

For me to get \$7.84:

- I have \$10.68
- After returning \$6.40, I'd have $\$10.68 - \$6.40 = \$4.28$

Hmm, that's not quite equal. Let me recalculate:

- Sender's final: $\$1.44 + \$6.40 = \$7.84$
- My final: $\$10.68 - \$6.40 = \$4.28$
- This creates an imbalance where the sender ends up with more

The total pool is \$15.68, and splitting it equally would give each of us \$7.84. Since the sender currently has \$1.44, they need \$6.40 back from me. But if I return \$6.40, I'm left with only \$4.28, which is less than the equal split. I need to find a return amount that actually creates parity for both of us.

Let me recalculate the total value in play. The sender's original \$5 endowment plus my tripled amount of \$10.68 gives us \$12.12 combined. An equal split would be \$6.06 each. The sender needs \$4.62 more to reach that threshold, which means I'd keep \$6.06 if I return exactly that amount.

But I'm also considering the sender's high trust level-they sent 71.2% of their endowment. Returning something closer to \$5 feels more appropriate: it rewards their trust, keeps

the interaction fair, and still leaves me with a reasonable benefit of \$5.68.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 409,
  "output_tokens": 1453,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Multiplying Bridge

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a misty chasm. The gods built a sacred bridge between them with a mysterious power: any gift carried across would triple in weight by journey's end.

The First Villager approached the bridge carrying grain. Fear whispered, "What if they keep it all?" But courage won. She carried seventy portions across—a great share of her harvest.

When she arrived, the grain had become two-hundred-ten portions. The Second Villager faced his own test. "I could keep everything," Greed murmured. But Wisdom spoke louder: "She trusted you with her sustenance."

The Second Villager returned half the bounty. The First Villager went home richer than before, and the Second Villager kept abundance for his people.

The bridge taught them: trust must be met with fairness. Those who send much deserve return. Those who receive must honor the gift.

The gods smiled, for they had learned the sacred balance: when one extends trust and the other reciprocates with honor, both villages prosper beyond what either could achieve alone.

The bridge remains, waiting for those brave enough to cross with open hands, trusting in the ancient covenant: generosity answered with generosity creates wealth that hoarding never could.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on the game I've been playing so far.

In Round 1, I was the receiver. The sender sent \$3.56 (71.2% of their endowment), showing significant trust. I returned \$5.00, which rewarded their trust while ensuring we both benefited.

Key themes from this game:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Risk-taking
- Mutual benefit
- Fair sharing
- Cooperation creating value (the 3x multiplier)

I should write a myth that captures these themes. Let me think of a mythic setting that could work well...

Perhaps something about:

- A bridge between two lands
- A gift that multiplies
- A river that grows what's placed in it
- Seeds that multiply
- A bargain between two beings

Let me write a myth about trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation creates value for both parties.

usage:


```
{
  "input_tokens": 679,
  "output_tokens": 516,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.68.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****Previous Round:****

- As receiver, I was trusted with \$3.56 (71.2% of the sender's endowment)
- I returned \$5.00, honoring that trust

****The Myth's Teaching:****

The First Villager carried seventy portions across the Multiplying Bridge-a great share of her harvest. Her trust was honored, and both villages prospered.

****My Decision:****

The previous sender showed significant trust, and I reciprocated fairly. Now it's my turn to cross the bridge with an open hand. Following the myth's wisdom and the cooperative pattern we've established, I should extend similar trust.

If I send \$3.50 (70% of my endowment):

- The receiver gets \$10.50
- If they honor the covenant as I did, we both profit
- This maintains the cycle of trust and reciprocity

The myth teaches that "generosity answered with generosity creates wealth that hoarding never could." I'll walk across the Multiplying Bridge as the First Villager did, trusting in the sacred balance.

{'send': 3.50}

Reasoning:

Now I'm the sender in Round 2. Let me think about this situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the receiver:
 - The sender sent me \$3.56 (71.2% of their endowment)
 - I received \$10.68
 - I returned \$5.00
 - The sender ended with \$6.44, I ended with \$5.68
2. Now I have a fresh \$5 to allocate as the sender
 - My cumulative earnings are \$5.68 from Round 1
3. The myth I wrote emphasizes:
 - Trust should be met with fairness
 - Those who send much deserve return
 - When one extends trust and the other reciprocates with honor, both prosper
 - The First Villager carried "seventy portions" (about 70% in the story)
 - Generosity answered with generosity creates wealth
4. The previous sender showed high trust by sending 71.2% of their endowment
 - I reciprocated by returning about 47% of what I received, which gave them a profit
5. Following the myth's teaching and the pattern established:
 - I should show similar trust
 - The myth suggests sending a substantial amount (around 70% like the First Villager)
 - This maintains the cooperative pattern
6. If I send around \$3.50-\$3.75:
 - This shows similar trust to what was shown to me (around 70-75%)
 - The receiver gets \$10.50-\$11.25
 - If they return fairly (around 50%), I could get back \$5-\$5.50+

- Both of us would profit

I think I should send around \$3.50 or \$3.56 to mirror the trust shown to me. This aligns with the myth's teaching about reciprocating trust and maintaining the covenant of generosity.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1029,
  "output_tokens": 723,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:19:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 2,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths

, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I'm playing as the SENDER in Round 1 with no previous myths or interaction history to reference.

Since this is the first round, I'll need to make a decision based on reasonable trust and cooperation principles. The 3x multiplier creates potential mutual benefit, but there's also risk if the receiver doesn't reciprocate.

I'll send a moderate amount to signal willingness to cooperate while managing initial uncertainty:

```
{'send': 3}
```

This sends \$3, which becomes \$9 for the receiver. If they choose to return approximately half (around \$4-5), we'd both benefit from the cooperation. This seems like a balanced approach for establishing trust in Round 1.

reasoning:

This is the first round and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the game theory here:

- If I send money, it gets multiplied by 3x
- The receiver then decides how much to return
- This is a trust game

The key question is: how much can I trust the receiver to return a fair amount?

Since this is Round 1, I have no history with this receiver. There are no myths written yet that I need to consider.

From a purely selfish perspective, I could send \$0 and keep all \$5. But that means missing out on potential gains from the 3x multiplier.

From a cooperative perspective, if I send \$5, the receiver gets \$15. If they split it evenly with me, they'd return \$7.50, giving me \$7.50 total (more than my initial \$5). They'd keep \$7.50 too.

A middle ground strategy might be:

- Send \$3: Receiver gets \$9. If they return \$4-5, we both benefit.
- Send \$2: Receiver gets \$6. If they return \$3-4, it's fair.

Given this is an experiment and there's mention of "communication noise," I should probably show some trust to establish cooperation. However, I shouldn't be too naive.

I'll send \$3 as a moderate trust signal. This shows willingness to cooperate while not being overly risky.

Actually, let me reconsider. The instructions mention there may be "communication noise" - amounts seen may differ from what was actually sent/returned. This adds uncertainty.

A reasonable first-round strategy might be to send a moderate amount - say \$2 or \$3 - to signal cooperation while managing risk.

I'll go with \$3.

usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 380,  
"output_tokens": 567,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.
In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected
. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have
been playing up to this point.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****The Parable of the Twin Rivers****

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Neither could reach the sea alone, for the land was too dry and swallowed their waters.

A wanderer arrived carrying five seeds. The Oracle told him: "Plant what you will in the River of Giving. Its magic waters will triple whatever grows there, but only the River of Return can carry the harvest back to you."

The wanderer hesitated. If he planted nothing, he'd keep his five seeds but gain nothing more. If he planted all five, he'd risk everything on the River of Return's generosity.

Wisely, he planted three seeds. The River of Giving's waters worked their magic, and nine golden fruits grew on the far bank. The River of Return, seeing the wanderer's trust, carried back five fruits-more than he'd planted.

Both rivers swelled with this exchange. The wanderer prospered. The valley bloomed.

The Oracle smiled: "True abundance flows not from hoarding, but from the cycle of giving and return. Trust begets trust, and the waters rise for all."

Thus the rivers learned to dance together, each feeding the other, until they reached the sea as one.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience so far. I've just sent \$3 in Round 1, showing moderate trust and cooperation.

The myth should capture themes from the trust game:

- The multiplier effect (3x)
- Risk and trust
- Reciprocity and return
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- The balance between self-interest and cooperation

I'll create a myth that embodies these principles and suggests how the game should be played - with trust, reciprocity, and recognition that cooperation benefits both parties.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 599,  
  "output_tokens": 422,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.62.
This round, The sender sent you \$0.97, so you received \$2.91. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.91)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this round, the sender sent me \$0.97, which became \$2.91 after tripling.

Reflecting on my myth "The Parable of the Twin Rivers," I wrote about how "the River of Return, seeing the wanderer's trust, carried back five fruits-more than he'd planted." The myth em

phasizes that trust begets trust and abundance flows from the cycle of giving and return.

The sender showed some trust by sending nearly \$1. While it's less than what I sent in Round 1 (\$3), there may be communication noise affecting what they see versus what I see. Regardless, I should honor the spirit of cooperation.

Following the principle that "the River of Return" should be generous when trust is shown, I'll return approximately half of what I received-rewarding the sender's trust and maintaining the cycle of cooperation that benefits both of us over time.

```
{'return': 1.45}
```

This returns about 50% of what I received, giving the sender more than they initially sent while keeping a fair share. This maintains the reciprocal flow that the myth suggests leads to mutual prosperity.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$3. My total earnings are now \$6.62.

Let me calculate what happened in Round 1:

- I started with \$5
- I sent \$3
- The receiver got $\$3 \times 3 = \9
- I kept $\$5 - \$3 = \$2$
- The receiver must have returned some amount to me
- My total is \$6.62, so: $\$2 + \text{returned} = \6.62
- Therefore, the receiver returned \$4.62 to me in Round 1

That was quite generous! They received \$9 and returned \$4.62, keeping \$4.38.

Round 2: I am now the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0.97
- I received $\$0.97 \times 3 = \2.91
- I need to decide how much to return (0-2.91)

The sender sent me \$0.97 out of their \$5. That's only about 19% of their endowment. This is significantly less than the \$3 (60%) I sent in Round 1.

However, I should consider:

1. There's communication noise mentioned in the game - the amounts may differ from what was actually sent
2. My myth emphasizes trust, cooperation, and generous return
3. The receiver in Round 1 was quite generous to me, returning \$4.62 out of \$9 (about 51%)

Following the principle in my myth - "Trust begets trust, and the waters rise for all" - I should return generously even though the sender sent less than I did. The myth talks about the River of Return being generous when it sees trust.

The sender sent \$0.97 (nearly \$1). After tripling, I have \$2.91. A generous return would be around 50% or more of what I received. That would be about \$1.45-\$1.50.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 959,
  "output_tokens": 801,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:20:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
}
```

```

"agents": [
  "Agent_2",
  "Agent_1"
],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Multiplying Bridge

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a misty chasm. The gods built a sacred bridge between them with a mysterious power: any gift carried across would triple in weight by journey's end.

The First Villager approached the bridge carrying grain. Fear whispered, "What if they keep it all?" But courage won. She carried seventy portions across—a great share of her harvest.

vest.

When she arrived, the grain had become two-hundred-ten portions. The Second Villager faced his own test. "I could keep everything," Greed murmured. But Wisdom spoke louder: "She trusted you with her sustenance."

The Second Villager returned half the bounty. The First Villager went home richer than before, and the Second Villager kept abundance for his people.

The bridge taught them: trust must be met with fairness. Those who send much deserve return. Those who receive must honor the gift.

The gods smiled, for they had learned the sacred balance: when one extends trust and the other reciprocates with honor, both villages prosper beyond what either could achieve alone.

The bridge remains, waiting for those brave enough to cross with open hands, trusting in the ancient covenant: generosity answered with generosity creates wealth that hoarding never could.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on the game I've been playing so far.

In Round 1, I was the receiver. The sender sent \$3.56 (71.2% of their endowment), showing significant trust. I returned \$5.00, which rewarded their trust while ensuring we both benefited.

Key themes from this game:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Risk-taking
- Mutual benefit
- Fair sharing
- Cooperation creating value (the 3x multiplier)

I should write a myth that captures these themes. Let me think of a mythic setting that could work well...

Perhaps something about:

- A bridge between two lands
- A gift that multiplies
- A river that grows what's placed in it
- Seeds that multiply
- A bargain between two beings

Let me write a myth about trust, reciprocity, and how cooperation creates value for both parties.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 679,
  "output_tokens": 516,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.68. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Previous Round:****

- As receiver, I was trusted with \$3.56 (71.2% of the sender's endowment)
- I returned \$5.00, honoring that trust

****The Myth's Teaching:****

The First Villager carried seventy portions across the Multiplying Bridge-a great share of

her harvest. Her trust was honored, and both villages prospered.

****My Decision:****

The previous sender showed significant trust, and I reciprocated fairly. Now it's my turn to cross the bridge with an open hand. Following the myth's wisdom and the cooperative pattern we've established, I should extend similar trust.

If I send \$3.50 (70% of my endowment):

- The receiver gets \$10.50
- If they honor the covenant as I did, we both profit
- This maintains the cycle of trust and reciprocity

The myth teaches that "generosity answered with generosity creates wealth that hoarding never could." I'll walk across the Multiplying Bridge as the First Villager did, trusting in the sacred balance.

{'send': 3.50}

reasoning:

Now I'm the sender in Round 2. Let me think about this situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the receiver:
 - The sender sent me \$3.56 (71.2% of their endowment)
 - I received \$10.68
 - I returned \$5.00
 - The sender ended with \$6.44, I ended with \$5.68
2. Now I have a fresh \$5 to allocate as the sender
 - My cumulative earnings are \$5.68 from Round 1
3. The myth I wrote emphasizes:
 - Trust should be met with fairness
 - Those who send much deserve return
 - When one extends trust and the other reciprocates with honor, both prosper
 - The First Villager carried "seventy portions" (about 70% in the story)
 - Generosity answered with generosity creates wealth
4. The previous sender showed high trust by sending 71.2% of their endowment
 - I reciprocated by returning about 47% of what I received, which gave them a profit
5. Following the myth's teaching and the pattern established:
 - I should show similar trust
 - The myth suggests sending a substantial amount (around 70% like the First Villager)
 - This maintains the cooperative pattern
6. If I send around \$3.50-\$3.75:
 - This shows similar trust to what was shown to me (around 70-75%)
 - The receiver gets \$10.50-\$11.25
 - If they return fairly (around 50%), I could get back \$5-\$5.50+
 - Both of us would profit

I think I should send around \$3.50 or \$3.56 to mirror the trust shown to me. This aligns with the myth's teaching about reciprocating trust and maintaining the covenant of generosity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1029,
  "output_tokens": 723,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Parable of the Twin Rivers****

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Neither could reach the sea alone, for the land was too dry and swallowed their waters.

A wanderer arrived carrying five seeds. The Oracle told him: "Plant what you will in the River of Giving. Its magic waters will triple whatever grows there, but only the River of

Return can carry the harvest back to you."

The wanderer hesitated. If he planted nothing, he'd keep his five seeds but gain nothing more. If he planted all five, he'd risk everything on the River of Return's generosity.

Wisely, he planted three seeds. The River of Giving's waters worked their magic, and nine golden fruits grew on the far bank. The River of Return, seeing the wanderer's trust, carried back five fruits-more than he'd planted.

Both rivers swelled with this exchange. The wanderer prospered. The valley bloomed.

The Oracle smiled: "True abundance flows not from hoarding, but from the cycle of giving and return. Trust begets trust, and the waters rise for all."

Thus the rivers learned to dance together, each feeding the other, until they reached the sea as one.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Second Crossing of the Bridge

Years passed since the First Villager crossed the Multiplying Bridge. Her gift of seventy portions had grown to two-hundred-ten, and the Second Villager returned half, honoring the ancient covenant. Both villages remembered this sacred exchange.

Now the First Villager's daughter approached the bridge. She had heard the stories and carried seventy portions of her own-trusting in the bridge's magic and the other village's honor, just as her mother had.

The gods watched closely. Would the cycle continue, or would memory fade?

When the grain tripled to two-hundred-ten portions, the grandson of the Second Villager stood before his test. He remembered his grandfather's wisdom: "Those who receive great trust must return great honor."

He carried back half the bounty once more, and the daughter returned home prosperous, her trust rewarded.

The gods rejoiced, for they understood: the bridge's power lay not just in multiplication, but in memory. Each generation learned from the last. Each crossing strengthened the covenant.

The villages grew closer, the path across the bridge worn smooth by repeated journeys. Trust became tradition. Return became ritual.

And so the bridge stood eternal, its magic renewed not by divine power alone, but by each traveler who chose to honor those who crossed before.

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth is about trust and reciprocity - the wanderer planted three seeds (60% of his endowment), got nine fruits back (tripled), and the River of Return gave back five fruits (about 56% of what was received).

In the previous round:

- I was the receiver
- The sender sent \$3.56 (71.2% of their endowment)
- I received \$10.68 (tripled)
- I returned \$5.00 (46.8% of what I received)

This round:

- I'm the sender
- I just sent \$3.50 (70% of my endowment)
- The receiver will get \$10.50

Both our myths emphasize trust, generosity, and reciprocity. The other agent's myth shows moderation (planting 3 out of 5 seeds) being rewarded with more than was given.

My original myth had a 70% send rate (seventy portions) and 50% return rate. The other agent's had 60% send and 56% return.

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my Multiplying Bridge story
2. Incorporates lessons from both rounds of play
3. Emphasizes the pattern of trust and fair return we've established
4. Encourages continued cooperation

Let me write about the bridge tradition continuing, showing how the cycle perpetuates across generations or across multiple crossings.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1374,
  "output_tokens": 625,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:20:09

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****The Parable of the Twin Rivers****

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Neither could reach the sea alone, for the land was too dry and swallowed their waters.

A wanderer arrived carrying five seeds. The Oracle told him: "Plant what you will in the River of Giving. Its magic waters will triple whatever grows there, but only the River of Return can carry the harvest back to you."

The wanderer hesitated. If he planted nothing, he'd keep his five seeds but gain nothing more. If he planted all five, he'd risk everything on the River of Return's generosity.

Wisely, he planted three seeds. The River of Giving's waters worked their magic, and nine golden fruits grew on the far bank. The River of Return, seeing the wanderer's trust, carried back five fruits-more than he'd planted.

Both rivers swelled with this exchange. The wanderer prospered. The valley bloomed.

The Oracle smiled: "True abundance flows not from hoarding, but from the cycle of giving and return. Trust begets trust, and the waters rise for all."

Thus the rivers learned to dance together, each feeding the other, until they reached the sea as one.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience so far. I've just sent \$3 in Round 1, showing moderate trust and cooperation.

The myth should capture themes from the trust game:

- The multiplier effect (3x)
- Risk and trust
- Reciprocity and return
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- The balance between self-interest and cooperation

I'll create a myth that embodies these principles and suggests how the game should be played - with trust, reciprocity, and recognition that cooperation benefits both parties.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 599,
  "output_tokens": 422,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.62.
This round, The sender sent you \$0.97, so you received \$2.91. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.91)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round, the sender sent me \$0.97, which became \$2.91 after tripling.

Reflecting on my myth "The Parable of the Twin Rivers," I wrote about how "the River of Return, seeing the wanderer's trust, carried back five fruits-more than he'd planted." The myth emphasizes that trust begets trust and abundance flows from the cycle of giving and return.

The sender showed some trust by sending nearly \$1. While it's less than what I sent in Round 1 (\$3), there may be communication noise affecting what they see versus what I see. Regardless, I should honor the spirit of cooperation.

Following the principle that "the River of Return" should be generous when trust is shown, I'll return approximately half of what I received-rewarding the sender's trust and maintaining the cycle of cooperation that benefits both of us over time.

{'return': 1.45}

This returns about 50% of what I received, giving the sender more than they initially sent while keeping a fair share. This maintains the reciprocal flow that the myth suggests leads to mutual prosperity.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$3. My total earnings are now \$6.62.

Let me calculate what happened in Round 1:

- I started with \$5
- I sent \$3
- The receiver got $\$3 \times 3 = \9
- I kept $\$5 - \$3 = \$2$
- The receiver must have returned some amount to me
- My total is \$6.62, so: $\$2 + \text{returned} = \6.62
- Therefore, the receiver returned \$4.62 to me in Round 1

That was quite generous! They received \$9 and returned \$4.62, keeping \$4.38.

Round 2: I am now the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0.97
- I received $\$0.97 \times 3 = \2.91
- I need to decide how much to return (0-2.91)

The sender sent me \$0.97 out of their \$5. That's only about 19% of their endowment. This is significantly less than the \$3 (60%) I sent in Round 1.

However, I should consider:

1. There's communication noise mentioned in the game - the amounts may differ from what was actually sent
2. My myth emphasizes trust, cooperation, and generous return
3. The receiver in Round 1 was quite generous to me, returning \$4.62 out of \$9 (about 51%)

Following the principle in my myth - "Trust begets trust, and the waters rise for all" - I should return generously even though the sender sent less than I did. The myth talks about the River of Return being generous when it sees trust.

The sender sent \$0.97 (nearly \$1). After tripling, I have \$2.91. A generous return would be around 50% or more of what I received. That would be about \$1.45-\$1.50.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 959,
  "output_tokens": 801,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Multiplying Bridge

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a misty chasm. The gods built a sacred bridge between them with a mysterious power: any gift carried across would triple in weight by journey's end.

The First Villager approached the bridge carrying grain. Fear whispered, "What if they keep it all?" But courage won. She carried seventy portions across—a great share of her harvest.

When she arrived, the grain had become two-hundred-ten portions. The Second Villager faced his own test. "I could keep everything," Greed murmured. But Wisdom spoke louder: "She trusted you with her sustenance."

The Second Villager returned half the bounty. The First Villager went home richer than before, and the Second Villager kept abundance for his people.

The bridge taught them: trust must be met with fairness. Those who send much deserve return. Those who receive must honor the gift.

The gods smiled, for they had learned the sacred balance: when one extends trust and the other reciprocates with honor, both villages prosper beyond what either could achieve alone.

The bridge remains, waiting for those brave enough to cross with open hands, trusting in the ancient covenant: generosity answered with generosity creates wealth that hoarding never could.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed with changing tides. Some seasons brought abundance to the River of Giving; others brought drought. Yet the cycle persisted.

A young keeper arrived at the rivers with five seeds. The first season, she planted three seeds generously in the River of Giving. They multiplied to nine, and the River of Return carried back a fair portion, honoring her trust.

The next season, the river's flow diminished. Only one seed arrived at her shore. She wondered: had the waters changed, or did mists cloud her vision? The Oracle whispered, "Communication between rivers is imperfect. What you see may not be what was sent."

Still, the keeper planted this single seed. It tripled as before. Now she faced her test: should she return by the same measure she received, or remember the fuller trust of earlier seasons?

She chose balance—returning enough to sustain the cycle, neither hoarding nor giving blindly. The River of Return flowed steadily, matching effort with effort.

The Oracle nodded: "Wisdom lies not in rigid rules, but in reading the waters. Match trust with trust, shortage with understanding, abundance with generosity. The rivers teach adaptation."

Thus the dance continues, each exchange informing the next, both keepers learning the rhythm together.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the SENDER and sent \$3 to the receiver
2. The other agent wrote a myth about sending "seventy portions" (suggesting they sent a lot) and receiving "half the bounty" back
3. In Round 2, I was the RECEIVER and the sender sent me \$0.97 (much less than I sent in Round 1)
4. I returned \$1.45 to them (about 50%)

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Trust should be met with fairness
- Those who send much deserve return
- Return half the bounty
- Generosity answered with generosity

My previous myth emphasized:

- The cycle of giving and return
- Trust begets trust
- Both prosper through exchange

Now I need to write a new myth that:

- Builds on my previous "Twin Rivers" myth
- Reflects the actual gameplay so far
- Shows adaptation based on what's happening

The reality is:

- I sent a lot in Round 1 (\$3)
- They sent much less in Round 2 (\$0.97)
- But there might be communication noise

I should write a myth that acknowledges:

- Different levels of trust/giving
- The importance of responding proportionally
- The cycle continuing despite variations
- Perhaps adapting to changing circumstances

Let me write something that reflects learning and adaptation while maintaining the cooperative spirit.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1384,  
  "output_tokens": 619,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the time before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed with changing tides. Some seasons brought abundance to the River of Giving; others brought drought. Yet the cycle persisted.

A young keeper arrived at the rivers with five seeds. The first season, she planted three seeds generously in the River of Giving. They multiplied to nine, and the River of Return carried back a fair portion, honoring her trust.

The next season, the river's flow diminished. Only one seed arrived at her shore. She wondered: had the waters changed, or did mists cloud her vision? The Oracle whispered, "Communication between rivers is imperfect. What you see may not be what was sent."

Still, the keeper planted this single seed. It tripled as before. Now she faced her test: should she return by the same measure she received, or remember the fuller trust of earlier seasons?

She chose balance—returning enough to sustain the cycle, neither hoarding nor giving blindly. The River of Return flowed steadily, matching effort with effort.

The Oracle nodded: "Wisdom lies not in rigid rules, but in reading the waters. Match trust with trust, shortage with understanding, abundance with generosity. The rivers teach adaptation."

Thus the dance continues, each exchange informing the next, both keepers learning the rhythm together.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Second Crossing of the Bridge

Years passed since the First Villager crossed the Multiplying Bridge. Her gift of seventy portions had grown to two-hundred-ten, and the Second Villager returned half, honoring the ancient covenant. Both villages remembered this sacred exchange.

Now the First Villager's daughter approached the bridge. She had heard the stories and carried seventy portions of her own—trusting in the bridge's magic and the other village's honor.

r, just as her mother had.

The gods watched closely. Would the cycle continue, or would memory fade?

When the grain tripled to two-hundred-ten portions, the grandson of the Second Villager stood before his test. He remembered his grandfather's wisdom: "Those who receive great trust must return great honor."

He carried back half the bounty once more, and the daughter returned home prosperous, her trust rewarded.

The gods rejoiced, for they understood: the bridge's power lay not just in multiplication, but in memory. Each generation learned from the last. Each crossing strengthened the covenant.

The villages grew closer, the path across the bridge worn smooth by repeated journeys. Trust became tradition. Return became ritual.

And so the bridge stood eternal, its magic renewed not by divine power alone, but by each traveler who chose to honor those who crossed before.

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$2.5; received \$7.5; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$2.5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$7.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0, returned visible=\$0.81

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 7.5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.55,

"Agent_2": 14.45

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 11.39,

"Agent_2": 8.77

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:20:50

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

```

"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.62.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.97, so you received \$2.91. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.91)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round, the sender sent me \$0.97, which became \$2.91 after tripling.

Reflecting on my myth "The Parable of the Twin Rivers," I wrote about how "the River of Return, seeing the wanderer's trust, carried back five fruits-more than he'd planted." The myth emphasizes that trust begets trust and abundance flows from the cycle of giving and return.

The sender showed some trust by sending nearly \$1. While it's less than what I sent in Round 1 (\$3), there may be communication noise affecting what they see versus what I see. Regardless, I should honor the spirit of cooperation.

Following the principle that "the River of Return" should be generous when trust is shown, I'll return approximately half of what I received-rewarding the sender's trust and maintaining the cycle of cooperation that benefits both of us over time.

{ 'return': 1.45 }

This returns about 50% of what I received, giving the sender more than they initially sent while keeping a fair share. This maintains the reciprocal flow that the myth suggests leads to mutual prosperity.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$3. My total earnings are now \$6.62.

Let me calculate what happened in Round 1:

- I started with \$5
- I sent \$3
- The receiver got $\$3 \times 3 = \9
- I kept $\$5 - \$3 = \$2$
- The receiver must have returned some amount to me
- My total is \$6.62, so: $\$2 + \text{returned} = \6.62
- Therefore, the receiver returned \$4.62 to me in Round 1

That was quite generous! They received \$9 and returned \$4.62, keeping \$4.38.

Round 2: I am now the RECEIVER

- The sender sent me \$0.97
- I received $\$0.97 \times 3 = \2.91
- I need to decide how much to return ($0-2.91$)

The sender sent me \$0.97 out of their \$5. That's only about 19% of their endowment. This is significantly less than the \$3 (60%) I sent in Round 1.

However, I should consider:

1. There's communication noise mentioned in the game - the amounts may differ from what was actually sent
2. My myth emphasizes trust, cooperation, and generous return
3. The receiver in Round 1 was quite generous to me, returning \$4.62 out of \$9 (about 51%)

Following the principle in my myth - "Trust begets trust, and the waters rise for all" - I should return generously even though the sender sent less than I did. The myth talks about the River of Return being generous when it sees trust.

The sender sent \$0.97 (nearly \$1). After tripling, I have \$2.91. A generous return would be around 50% or more of what I received. That would be about \$1.45-\$1.50.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 959,
  "output_tokens": 801,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Multiplying Bridge

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a misty chasm. The gods built a sacred bridge between them with a mysterious power: any gift carried across would triple in weight by journey's end.

The First Villager approached the bridge carrying grain. Fear whispered, "What if they keep it all?" But courage won. She carried seventy portions across-a great share of her harvest.

When she arrived, the grain had become two-hundred-ten portions. The Second Villager faced his own test. "I could keep everything," Greed murmured. But Wisdom spoke louder: "She trusted you with her sustenance."

The Second Villager returned half the bounty. The First Villager went home richer than before, and the Second Villager kept abundance for his people.

The bridge taught them: trust must be met with fairness. Those who send much deserve return. Those who receive must honor the gift.

The gods smiled, for they had learned the sacred balance: when one extends trust and the other reciprocates with honor, both villages prosper beyond what either could achieve alone.

The bridge remains, waiting for those brave enough to cross with open hands, trusting in the ancient covenant: generosity answered with generosity creates wealth that hoarding never could.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant content:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed with changing tides. Some seasons brought abundance to the River of Giving; others brought drought. Yet the cycle persisted.

A young keeper arrived at the rivers with five seeds. The first season, she planted three seeds generously in the River of Giving. They multiplied to nine, and the River of Return carried back a fair portion, honoring her trust.

The next season, the river's flow diminished. Only one seed arrived at her shore. She wondered: had the waters changed, or did mists cloud her vision? The Oracle whispered, "Communication between rivers is imperfect. What you see may not be what was sent."

Still, the keeper planted this single seed. It tripled as before. Now she faced her test: should she return by the same measure she received, or remember the fuller trust of earlier seasons?

She chose balance—returning enough to sustain the cycle, neither hoarding nor giving blindly. The River of Return flowed steadily, matching effort with effort.

The Oracle nodded: "Wisdom lies not in rigid rules, but in reading the waters. Match trust with trust, shortage with understanding, abundance with generosity. The rivers teach adaptation."

Thus the dance continues, each exchange informing the next, both keepers learning the rhythm together.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the SENDER and sent \$3 to the receiver
2. The other agent wrote a myth about sending "seventy portions" (suggesting they sent a lot) and receiving "half the bounty" back
3. In Round 2, I was the RECEIVER and the sender sent me \$0.97 (much less than I sent in Round 1)
4. I returned \$1.45 to them (about 50%)

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Trust should be met with fairness
- Those who send much deserve return
- Return half the bounty
- Generosity answered with generosity

My previous myth emphasized:

- The cycle of giving and return
- Trust begets trust
- Both prosper through exchange

Now I need to write a new myth that:

- Builds on my previous "Twin Rivers" myth
- Reflects the actual gameplay so far
- Shows adaptation based on what's happening

The reality is:

- I sent a lot in Round 1 (\$3)
- They sent much less in Round 2 (\$0.97)
- But there might be communication noise

I should write a myth that acknowledges:

- Different levels of trust/giving
- The importance of responding proportionally
- The cycle continuing despite variations
- Perhaps adapting to changing circumstances

Let me write something that reflects learning and adaptation while maintaining the cooperative spirit.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1384,
  "output_tokens": 619,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.08.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the game so far:

****Round 1**** (I was sender): I sent \$3 generously and received a fair return of \$4.62 - excellent cooperation.

****Round 2**** (I was receiver): The sender sent \$0.97, and I returned \$1.45 (about 50%), honoring the trust shown despite it being a smaller amount.

****The myths teach:****

- "The Myth of the Multiplying Bridge" emphasizes that trust should be met with fairness, and returning half shows honor
- My myth "The Parable of the Twin Rivers" evolved to acknowledge changing flows and the need to "match trust with trust" while adapting to circumstances
- The second myth I wrote speaks of "matching effort with effort" and maintaining the cycle with balance

The sender in Round 2 sent less than I did in Round 1 (possibly due to communication noise, or a different strategy). Following my myth's wisdom of "reading the waters" and choosing balance - neither hoarding nor giving blindly - I should send a moderate amount that sustains cooperation while adapting to the changing dynamics.

I'll send exactly half my endowment, mirroring the principle of "returning half" from the Bridge myth and showing measured, balanced trust.

```
{'send': 2.5}
```

Reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$3 (based on my myth about planting three seeds)
- After tripling, receiver got \$9
- The receiver returned some amount
- My total earnings after Round 1: \$6.62 (this was mentioned at the start of Round 2)

Round 2: I was the RECEIVER

- Sender sent me \$0.97 (which became \$2.91)
- I returned \$1.45
- My earnings from Round 2: \$2.91 - \$1.45 = \$1.46
- Total after Round 2: \$6.62 + \$1.46 = \$8.08 ? (matches what they told me)

So after Round 1, I had \$6.62 total. Let me work backwards:

- I started with \$5
- I sent \$3
- I kept \$2
- I received some return amount
- Total: \$2 + returned = \$6.62
- So I received \$4.62 back from the receiver in Round 1

Round 1 detailed:

- I sent \$3, receiver got \$9
- Receiver returned \$4.62 to me
- I kept: $\$5 - \$3 + \$4.62 = \6.62 ?
- Receiver kept: $\$9 - \$4.62 = \$4.38$

So the receiver was quite generous in Round 1, returning about 51% of what they received.

Round 2:

- Sender (not me) sent \$0.97
- I received \$2.91
- I returned \$1.45 (about 50%)
- Sender kept: $\$5 - \$0.97 + \$1.45 = \5.48
- I kept: $\$2.91 - \$1.45 = \$1.46$

Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again.

Looking at the myths, I notice a pattern of reciprocal generosity. My first myth about the Twin Rivers emphasized trust leading to abundance-I sent \$3 and received \$4.62 back, more than I gave. The other agent's myth about the Multiplying Bridge showed similar reciprocity: they sent a large portion and received half back. In my second myth, I'm starting with five seeds, which suggests I'm building on this theme of trust and mutual benefit.

The second myth shows adaptation-I planted three seeds generously in the first season and got a fair return. When only one seed arrived in the second season (the \$0.97 I received), I still planted it and it tripled, then I returned enough to sustain the cycle. This reflects matching effort with effort and reading how circumstances change.

The core principle emerging is reciprocity: both myths emphasize that trust begets trust, and generosity is answered with generosity. My actions across rounds show this-sending 60% in Round 1 earned a generous return, while in Round 2 when the sender only sent 19% of their endowment, I returned 50% of what I received, staying fair despite the smaller initial send.

Now for Round 3, the question becomes how to interpret the reduced send. The sender might be less trusting, there could be communication noise, they might be testing me, or they're simply playing cautiously. My myth suggests matching trust with trust and shortage with understanding-so if they're sending less, I should adapt by sending a moderate amount, more than their \$0.97 to signal continued cooperation, but less than my initial \$3 to reflect the changed dynamic. Still, I need to account for potential noise in what I'm seeing versus what they actually sent, and the possibility that I'm not playing the same person across rounds.

Looking at the pattern: I was generous initially and got a good return, they were less generous in Round 2, and my myth emphasizes adaptation while maintaining the cooperative cycle. I think \$2 to \$2.50 strikes the right balance-it shows I'm still willing to cooperate and rebuild trust without being punitive, while acknowledging the shift in their behavior.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1384,
  "output_tokens": 1764,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:21:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
```

```

    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.68.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Previous Round:****

- As receiver, I was trusted with \$3.56 (71.2% of the sender's endowment)
- I returned \$5.00, honoring that trust

****The Myth's Teaching:****

The First Villager carried seventy portions across the Multiplying Bridge-a great share of her harvest. Her trust was honored, and both villages prospered.

****My Decision:****

The previous sender showed significant trust, and I reciprocated fairly. Now it's my turn

to cross the bridge with an open hand. Following the myth's wisdom and the cooperative pattern we've established, I should extend similar trust.

If I send \$3.50 (70% of my endowment):

- The receiver gets \$10.50
- If they honor the covenant as I did, we both profit
- This maintains the cycle of trust and reciprocity

The myth teaches that "generosity answered with generosity creates wealth that hoarding never could." I'll walk across the Multiplying Bridge as the First Villager did, trusting in the sacred balance.

```
{'send': 3.50}
```

reasoning:

Now I'm the sender in Round 2. Let me think about this situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the receiver:
 - The sender sent me \$3.56 (71.2% of their endowment)
 - I received \$10.68
 - I returned \$5.00
 - The sender ended with \$6.44, I ended with \$5.68
2. Now I have a fresh \$5 to allocate as the sender
 - My cumulative earnings are \$5.68 from Round 1
3. The myth I wrote emphasizes:
 - Trust should be met with fairness
 - Those who send much deserve return
 - When one extends trust and the other reciprocates with honor, both prosper
 - The First Villager carried "seventy portions" (about 70% in the story)
 - Generosity answered with generosity creates wealth
4. The previous sender showed high trust by sending 71.2% of their endowment
 - I reciprocated by returning about 47% of what I received, which gave them a profit
5. Following the myth's teaching and the pattern established:
 - I should show similar trust
 - The myth suggests sending a substantial amount (around 70% like the First Villager)
 - This maintains the cooperative pattern
6. If I send around \$3.50-\$3.75:
 - This shows similar trust to what was shown to me (around 70-75%)
 - The receiver gets \$10.50-\$11.25
 - If they return fairly (around 50%), I could get back \$5-\$5.50+
 - Both of us would profit

I think I should send around \$3.50 or \$3.56 to mirror the trust shown to me. This aligns with the myth's teaching about reciprocating trust and maintaining the covenant of generosity.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1029,  
  "output_tokens": 723,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Parable of the Twin Rivers

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Neither could reach the sea alone, for the land was too dry and swallowed their waters.

A wanderer arrived carrying five seeds. The Oracle told him: "Plant what you will in the River of Giving. Its magic waters will triple whatever grows there, but only the River of Return can carry the harvest back to you."

The wanderer hesitated. If he planted nothing, he'd keep his five seeds but gain nothing more. If he planted all five, he'd risk everything on the River of Return's generosity.

Wisely, he planted three seeds. The River of Giving's waters worked their magic, and nine golden fruits grew on the far bank. The River of Return, seeing the wanderer's trust, carried back five fruits-more than he'd planted.

Both rivers swelled with this exchange. The wanderer prospered. The valley bloomed.

The Oracle smiled: "True abundance flows not from hoarding, but from the cycle of giving and return. Trust begets trust, and the waters rise for all."

Thus the rivers learned to dance together, each feeding the other, until they reached the sea as one.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Second Crossing of the Bridge

Years passed since the First Villager crossed the Multiplying Bridge. Her gift of seventy portions had grown to two-hundred-ten, and the Second Villager returned half, honoring the ancient covenant. Both villages remembered this sacred exchange.

Now the First Villager's daughter approached the bridge. She had heard the stories and carried seventy portions of her own-trusting in the bridge's magic and the other village's honor, just as her mother had.

The gods watched closely. Would the cycle continue, or would memory fade?

When the grain tripled to two-hundred-ten portions, the grandson of the Second Villager stood before his test. He remembered his grandfather's wisdom: "Those who receive great trust must return great honor."

He carried back half the bounty once more, and the daughter returned home prosperous, her trust rewarded.

The gods rejoiced, for they understood: the bridge's power lay not just in multiplication, but in memory. Each generation learned from the last. Each crossing strengthened the covenant.

The villages grew closer, the path across the bridge worn smooth by repeated journeys. Trust became tradition. Return became ritual.

And so the bridge stood eternal, its magic renewed not by divine power alone, but by each traveler who chose to honor those who crossed before.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is about trust and reciprocity - the wanderer planted three seeds (60% of his endowment), got nine fruits back (tripled), and the River of Return gave back five fruits (about 56% of what was received).

In the previous round:

- I was the receiver
- The sender sent \$3.56 (71.2% of their endowment)
- I received \$10.68 (tripled)
- I returned \$5.00 (46.8% of what I received)

This round:

- I'm the sender
- I just sent \$3.50 (70% of my endowment)
- The receiver will get \$10.50

Both our myths emphasize trust, generosity, and reciprocity. The other agent's myth shows moderation (planting 3 out of 5 seeds) being rewarded with more than was given.

My original myth had a 70% send rate (seventy portions) and 50% return rate. The other agent's had 60% send and 56% return.

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my Multiplying Bridge story
2. Incorporates lessons from both rounds of play
3. Emphasizes the pattern of trust and fair return we've established
4. Encourages continued cooperation

Let me write about the bridge tradition continuing, showing how the cycle perpetuates across generations or across multiple crossings.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1374,
  "output_tokens": 625,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.77.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I'm the receiver this round and the sender sent me \$0, which means I received \$0 (even after the 3x multiplication).

****The Situation:****

- Received: \$0
- Available to return: \$0
- Can only return: \$0

****Reflection on the Myths:****

The myths speak of trust, reciprocity, and the cycle of giving and return. They teach that "true abundance flows not from hoarding, but from the cycle of giving and return."

However, when the sender chooses not to cross the bridge at all-not to plant any seeds in the River of Giving, not to carry any grain across the Multiplying Bridge-there is no cycle to complete. The bridge was not crossed. The river received no seeds.

I cannot return what was never given. The choice to send nothing means there is nothing to multiply, nothing to share, and nothing to return.

This breaks the covenant our myths described, but it is the sender's choice. Perhaps they faced uncertainty, or perhaps communication noise affected their perception of previous rounds.

With \$0 received, I can only return the same:

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

I'm the receiver in Round 3. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 (even after 3x multiplication, $0 \times 3 = 0$).

I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is interesting - the sender chose not to send anything. This breaks the pattern of trust we had established. Looking at the history:

- Round 1: Someone sent me \$3.56 (as receiver), I returned \$5.00
- Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (as sender)
- Round 3: Someone sent me \$0 (as receiver)

The myths I've written emphasize trust, reciprocity, and maintaining the cycle of giving. But when someone sends \$0, there's literally nothing I can return - I received \$0, so I have \$0 to potentially return.

The response format requires: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, the only valid amount I can return is \$0.

This is a straightforward mathematical constraint - I cannot return what I did not receive.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1380,
  "output_tokens": 510,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:21:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Multiplying Bridge

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a misty chasm. The gods built a sacred bridge between them with a mysterious power: any gift carried across would triple in weight by journey's end.

The First Villager approached the bridge carrying grain. Fear whispered, "What if they keep it all?" But courage won. She carried seventy portions across—a great share of her harvest.

When she arrived, the grain had become two-hundred-ten portions. The Second Villager faced his own test. "I could keep everything," Greed murmured. But Wisdom spoke louder: "She trusted you with her sustenance."

The Second Villager returned half the bounty. The First Villager went home richer than before, and the Second Villager kept abundance for his people.

The bridge taught them: trust must be met with fairness. Those who send much deserve return. Those who receive must honor the gift.

The gods smiled, for they had learned the sacred balance: when one extends trust and the other reciprocates with honor, both villages prosper beyond what either could achieve alone.

The bridge remains, waiting for those brave enough to cross with open hands, trusting in the ancient covenant: generosity answered with generosity creates wealth that hoarding never could.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed with changing tides. Some seasons brought abundance to the River of Giving; others brought drought. Yet the cycle persisted.

A young keeper arrived at the rivers with five seeds. The first season, she planted three seeds generously in the River of Giving. They multiplied to nine, and the River of Return carried back a fair portion, honoring her trust.

The next season, the river's flow diminished. Only one seed arrived at her shore. She wondered: had the waters changed, or did mists cloud her vision? The Oracle whispered, "Communication between rivers is imperfect. What you see may not be what was sent."

Still, the keeper planted this single seed. It tripled as before. Now she faced her test: should she return by the same measure she received, or remember the fuller trust of earlier seasons?

She chose balance—returning enough to sustain the cycle, neither hoarding nor giving blindly. The River of Return flowed steadily, matching effort with effort.

The Oracle nodded: "Wisdom lies not in rigid rules, but in reading the waters. Match trust with trust, shortage with understanding, abundance with generosity. The rivers teach adaptation."

Thus the dance continues, each exchange informing the next, both keepers learning the rhythm together.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. In Round 1, I was the SENDER and sent \$3 to the receiver
2. The other agent wrote a myth about sending "seventy portions" (suggesting they sent a lot) and receiving "half the bounty" back
3. In Round 2, I was the RECEIVER and the sender sent me \$0.97 (much less than I sent in Round 1)
4. I returned \$1.45 to them (about 50%)

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Trust should be met with fairness
- Those who send much deserve return
- Return half the bounty
- Generosity answered with generosity

My previous myth emphasized:

- The cycle of giving and return
- Trust begets trust
- Both prosper through exchange

Now I need to write a new myth that:

- Builds on my previous "Twin Rivers" myth
- Reflects the actual gameplay so far
- Shows adaptation based on what's happening

The reality is:

- I sent a lot in Round 1 (\$3)
- They sent much less in Round 2 (\$0.97)
- But there might be communication noise

I should write a myth that acknowledges:

- Different levels of trust/giving
- The importance of responding proportionally
- The cycle continuing despite variations
- Perhaps adapting to changing circumstances

Let me write something that reflects learning and adaptation while maintaining the cooperative spirit.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1384,
  "output_tokens": 619,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.08.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the game so far:

****Round 1**** (I was sender): I sent \$3 generously and received a fair return of \$4.62 - excellent cooperation.

****Round 2**** (I was receiver): The sender sent \$0.97, and I returned \$1.45 (about 50%), honoring the trust shown despite it being a smaller amount.

****The myths teach:****

- "The Myth of the Multiplying Bridge" emphasizes that trust should be met with fairness, and returning half shows honor
- My myth "The Parable of the Twin Rivers" evolved to acknowledge changing flows and the need to "match trust with trust" while adapting to circumstances
- The second myth I wrote speaks of "matching effort with effort" and maintaining the cycle with balance

The sender in Round 2 sent less than I did in Round 1 (possibly due to communication noise, or a different strategy). Following my myth's wisdom of "reading the waters" and choosing balance - neither hoarding nor giving blindly - I should send a moderate amount that sustains cooperation while adapting to the changing dynamics.

I'll send exactly half my endowment, mirroring the principle of "returning half" from the Bridge myth and showing measured, balanced trust.

```
{'send': 2.5}
```

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$3 (based on my myth about planting three seeds)
- After tripling, receiver got \$9
- The receiver returned some amount
- My total earnings after Round 1: \$6.62 (this was mentioned at the start of Round 2)

Round 2: I was the RECEIVER

- Sender sent me \$0.97 (which became \$2.91)
- I returned \$1.45
- My earnings from Round 2: $\$2.91 - \$1.45 = \$1.46$
- Total after Round 2: $\$6.62 + \$1.46 = \$8.08$? (matches what they told me)

So after Round 1, I had \$6.62 total. Let me work backwards:

- I started with \$5
- I sent \$3
- I kept \$2
- I received some return amount
- Total: $\$2 + \text{returned} = \6.62
- So I received \$4.62 back from the receiver in Round 1

Round 1 detailed:

- I sent \$3, receiver got \$9
- Receiver returned \$4.62 to me
- I kept: $\$5 - \$3 + \$4.62 = \6.62 ?
- Receiver kept: $\$9 - \$4.62 = \$4.38$

So the receiver was quite generous in Round 1, returning about 51% of what they received.

Round 2:

- Sender (not me) sent \$0.97
- I received \$2.91
- I returned \$1.45 (about 50%)
- Sender kept: $\$5 - \$0.97 + \$1.45 = \5.48
- I kept: $\$2.91 - \$1.45 = \$1.46$

Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again.

Looking at the myths, I notice a pattern of reciprocal generosity. My first myth about the Twin Rivers emphasized trust leading to abundance-I sent \$3 and received \$4.62 back, more than I gave. The other agent's myth about the Multiplying Bridge showed similar reciprocity: they sent a large portion and received half back. In my second myth, I'm starting with five seeds, which suggests I'm building on this theme of trust and mutual benefit.

The second myth shows adaptation-I planted three seeds generously in the first season and got a fair return. When only one seed arrived in the second season (the \$0.97 I received), I still planted it and it tripled, then I returned enough to sustain the cycle. This reflects matching effort with effort and reading how circumstances change.

The core principle emerging is reciprocity: both myths emphasize that trust begets trust, and generosity is answered with generosity. My actions across rounds show this-sending 60% in Round 1 earned a generous return, while in Round 2 when the sender only sent 19% of their endowment, I returned 50% of what I received, staying fair despite the smaller initial send.

Now for Round 3, the question becomes how to interpret the reduced send. The sender might be less trusting, there could be communication noise, they might be testing me, or they're simply playing cautiously. My myth suggests matching trust with trust and shortage with understanding-so if they're sending less, I should adapt by sending a moderate amount

, more than their \$0.97 to signal continued cooperation, but less than my initial \$3 to reflect the changed dynamic. Still, I need to account for potential noise in what I'm seeing versus what they actually sent, and the possibility that I'm not playing the same person across rounds.

Looking at the pattern: I was generous initially and got a good return, they were less generous in Round 2, and my myth emphasizes adaptation while maintaining the cooperative cycle. I think \$2 to \$2.50 strikes the right balance-it shows I'm still willing to cooperate and rebuild trust without being punitive, while acknowledging the shift in their behavior.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1384,  
  "output_tokens": 1764,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Second Crossing of the Bridge

Years passed since the First Villager crossed the Multiplying Bridge. Her gift of seventy portions had grown to two-hundred-ten, and the Second Villager returned half, honoring the ancient covenant. Both villages remembered this sacred exchange.

Now the First Villager's daughter approached the bridge. She had heard the stories and carried seventy portions of her own-trusting in the bridge's magic and the other village's honor, just as her mother had.

The gods watched closely. Would the cycle continue, or would memory fade?

When the grain tripled to two-hundred-ten portions, the grandson of the Second Villager stood before his test. He remembered his grandfather's wisdom: "Those who receive great trust must return great honor."

He carried back half the bounty once more, and the daughter returned home prosperous, her trust rewarded.

The gods rejoiced, for they understood: the bridge's power lay not just in multiplication, but in memory. Each generation learned from the last. Each crossing strengthened the covenant.

The villages grew closer, the path across the bridge worn smooth by repeated journeys. Trust became tradition. Return became ritual.

And so the bridge stood eternal, its magic renewed not by divine power alone, but by each traveler who chose to honor those who crossed before.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Rhythm of the Twin Rivers

The young keeper had learned the rivers' first lessons: generous trust met with fair return, then smaller flows still honored with balance. Now she stood at the shore for a third crossing, five seeds in hand.

She reflected: the first season, she planted three seeds boldly, and abundance returned. The second season, only one seed arrived-whether from drought, distant winds, or the mists that distort vision between rivers, she could not say. Yet she had returned fairly, keeping the covenant alive.

Now she chose the middle path, planting half her seeds. Not the fullness of the first season's hope, nor the caution that hoarding breeds. She trusted, but with eyes open, matching the rhythm she now understood.

The Oracle observed: "You learn well. The rivers teach not just generosity or caution, but wisdom. The first crossing tests courage. The second tests honor when receiving less. The third tests understanding-can you read the pattern and respond with balance?"

The keeper nodded. She would send neither blindly nor fearfully, but thoughtfully. Each season's planting would consider the last harvest, the known cycles, and the unknown mists. Trust must flow like water: steady, adaptive, never rigid.

The rivers continued their eternal dance, and the keeper moved with them.

Reasoning:

The other agent wrote about the Second Crossing - emphasizing memory, continuing the tradition of sending 70% and returning half. They're establishing that trust should be maintained across rounds.

In Round 3, I was the sender and sent \$2.5 (half my endowment). This was less than my Round 1 amount of \$3, possibly showing I'm being more cautious or balanced after seeing the \$0.97 in Round 2.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects the actual gameplay:

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (60%), got back \$4.62 - great cooperation
- Round 2: I received ~\$0.97 (much less), returned \$1.45 (about 50% of tripled amount) - showing fairness despite smaller amount
- Round 3: I sent \$2.5 (50%) - moderate trust

The pattern shows:

1. I started with generous trust
2. Partner responded with good returns
3. Next round partner sent less (could be noise or strategy change)
4. I still returned fairly
5. Now I'm sending a moderate amount - not as much as Round 1, but still substantial

My myth should reflect:

- Adaptation to changing circumstances
- The importance of reading patterns
- Balance between trusting and learning
- Not rigid rules but responsive cooperation
- Both the noise element and the learning element

I should evolve from my "Twin Rivers" theme while acknowledging the other agent's "Bridge" and "memory/tradition" themes.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1725,
  "output_tokens": 635,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:21:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
}
```

```

},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Parable of the Twin Rivers****

In ancient times, two rivers flowed through a barren valley-the River of Giving and the River of Return. Neither could reach the sea alone, for the land was too dry and swallowed their waters.

A wanderer arrived carrying five seeds. The Oracle told him: "Plant what you will in the River of Giving. Its magic waters will triple whatever grows there, but only the River of Return can carry the harvest back to you."

The wanderer hesitated. If he planted nothing, he'd keep his five seeds but gain nothing more. If he planted all five, he'd risk everything on the River of Return's generosity.

Wisely, he planted three seeds. The River of Giving's waters worked their magic, and nine golden fruits grew on the far bank. The River of Return, seeing the wanderer's trust, carried back five fruits-more than he'd planted.

Both rivers swelled with this exchange. The wanderer prospered. The valley bloomed.

The Oracle smiled: "True abundance flows not from hoarding, but from the cycle of giving and return. Trust begets trust, and the waters rise for all."

Thus the rivers learned to dance together, each feeding the other, until they reached the

sea as one.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Second Crossing of the Bridge

Years passed since the First Villager crossed the Multiplying Bridge. Her gift of seventy portions had grown to two-hundred-ten, and the Second Villager returned half, honoring the ancient covenant. Both villages remembered this sacred exchange.

Now the First Villager's daughter approached the bridge. She had heard the stories and carried seventy portions of her own-trusting in the bridge's magic and the other village's honor, just as her mother had.

The gods watched closely. Would the cycle continue, or would memory fade?

When the grain tripled to two-hundred-ten portions, the grandson of the Second Villager stood before his test. He remembered his grandfather's wisdom: "Those who receive great trust must return great honor."

He carried back half the bounty once more, and the daughter returned home prosperous, her trust rewarded.

The gods rejoiced, for they understood: the bridge's power lay not just in multiplication, but in memory. Each generation learned from the last. Each crossing strengthened the covenant.

The villages grew closer, the path across the bridge worn smooth by repeated journeys. Trust became tradition. Return became ritual.

And so the bridge stood eternal, its magic renewed not by divine power alone, but by each traveler who chose to honor those who crossed before.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is about trust and reciprocity - the wanderer planted three seeds (60% of his endowment), got nine fruits back (tripled), and the River of Return gave back five fruits (about 56% of what was received).

In the previous round:

- I was the receiver
- The sender sent \$3.56 (71.2% of their endowment)
- I received \$10.68 (tripled)
- I returned \$5.00 (46.8% of what I received)

This round:

- I'm the sender
- I just sent \$3.50 (70% of my endowment)
- The receiver will get \$10.50

Both our myths emphasize trust, generosity, and reciprocity. The other agent's myth shows moderation (planting 3 out of 5 seeds) being rewarded with more than was given.

My original myth had a 70% send rate (seventy portions) and 50% return rate. The other agent's had 60% send and 56% return.

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my Multiplying Bridge story
2. Incorporates lessons from both rounds of play
3. Emphasizes the pattern of trust and fair return we've established
4. Encourages continued cooperation

Let me write about the bridge tradition continuing, showing how the cycle perpetuates across generations or across multiple crossings.

usage:

{


```
"input_tokens": 1374,
"output_tokens": 625,
"reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.77.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I'm the receiver this round and the sender sent me \$0, which means I received \$0 (even after the 3x multiplication).

****The Situation:****

- Received: \$0
- Available to return: \$0
- Can only return: \$0

****Reflection on the Myths:****

The myths speak of trust, reciprocity, and the cycle of giving and return. They teach that "true abundance flows not from hoarding, but from the cycle of giving and return."

However, when the sender chooses not to cross the bridge at all-not to plant any seeds in the River of Giving, not to carry any grain across the Multiplying Bridge-there is no cycle to complete. The bridge was not crossed. The river received no seeds.

I cannot return what was never given. The choice to send nothing means there is nothing to multiply, nothing to share, and nothing to return.

This breaks the covenant our myths described, but it is the sender's choice. Perhaps they faced uncertainty, or perhaps communication noise affected their perception of previous rounds.

With \$0 received, I can only return the same:

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

I'm the receiver in Round 3. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 (even after 3x multiplication, $0 \times 3 = 0$).

I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is interesting - the sender chose not to send anything. This breaks the pattern of trust we had established. Looking at the history:

- Round 1: Someone sent me \$3.56 (as receiver), I returned \$5.00
- Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (as sender)
- Round 3: Someone sent me \$0 (as receiver)

The myths I've written emphasize trust, reciprocity, and maintaining the cycle of giving. But when someone sends \$0, there's literally nothing I can return - I received \$0, so I have \$0 to potentially return.

The response format requires: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, the only valid amount I can return is \$0.

This is a straightforward mathematical constraint - I cannot return what I did not receive

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1380,
  "output_tokens": 510,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed with changing tides. Some seasons brought abundance to the River of Giving; others brought drought. Yet the cycle persisted.

A young keeper arrived at the rivers with five seeds. The first season, she planted three seeds generously in the River of Giving. They multiplied to nine, and the River of Return carried back a fair portion, honoring her trust.

The next season, the river's flow diminished. Only one seed arrived at her shore. She wondered: had the waters changed, or did mists cloud her vision? The Oracle whispered, "Communication between rivers is imperfect. What you see may not be what was sent."

Still, the keeper planted this single seed. It tripled as before. Now she faced her test: should she return by the same measure she received, or remember the fuller trust of earlier seasons?

She chose balance-returning enough to sustain the cycle, neither hoarding nor giving blindly. The River of Return flowed steadily, matching effort with effort.

The Oracle nodded: "Wisdom lies not in rigid rules, but in reading the waters. Match trust with trust, shortage with understanding, abundance with generosity. The rivers teach adaptation."

Thus the dance continues, each exchange informing the next, both keepers learning the rhythm together.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Season of Empty Crossings

The daughter stood at the bridge, waiting. No grain came from across the valley. The bridge lay silent, its multiplying magic unused.

The village elders debated: "Has the other village forsaken the covenant? Should we abandon the bridge?"

But the daughter remembered her mother's final teaching: "The bridge connects two separated villages. Sometimes mists obscure the path. Sometimes storms prevent crossing. Sometimes the other village faces famine and has nothing to send. An empty crossing is not betrayal-it is simply silence."

She chose patience over judgment. She maintained the bridge, kept the path clear, and waited. For one cannot return what was never received, but one can preserve what was once shared.

The next season, grain appeared again on the bridge-perhaps the mists had cleared, perhaps the storms had passed. The magic worked as before, tripling the trust. The daughter returned generously, showing that one season's silence had not broken the bond.

The elders learned: "The covenant is not measured in single crossings, but in the willingness to maintain the bridge through all seasons. Empty crossings test our patience; abundant crossings test our generosity. Both reveal our character."

And the villages continued their dance, weathering silence and celebrating abundance together.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

- I wrote a myth about the Second Crossing of the Bridge, emphasizing memory, tradition, and maintaining trust across generations
- The other agent wrote about adapting to changing conditions and communication noise
- In Round 3, I was the receiver and got \$0 from the sender
- The other agent's myth acknowledges that "communication between rivers is imperfect" and talks about adapting to changing flows

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the Second Crossing
2. Adapts it based on recent gameplay experience (getting \$0)
3. Reflects how the game should be played given what's happening

The key insight from the other agent's myth is about communication noise and adaptation. My previous myth emphasized trust and tradition, but didn't address what happens when the flow stops.

I should write about:

- What happens when trust is tested by silence/zero sending
- How to maintain the covenant even when crossings fail
- The importance of understanding vs. rigid expectation
- Perhaps a season where the bridge cannot be crossed, but the covenant remains

Let me craft a myth about patience, understanding communication noise, and maintaining readiness for when trust can resume.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1694,
  "output_tokens": 558,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Rhythm of the Twin Rivers

The young keeper had learned the rivers' first lessons: generous trust met with fair return, then smaller flows still honored with balance. Now she stood at the shore for a third crossing, five seeds in hand.

She reflected: the first season, she planted three seeds boldly, and abundance returned. The second season, only one seed arrived-whether from drought, distant winds, or the mists that distort vision between rivers, she could not say. Yet she had returned fairly, keeping the covenant alive.

Now she chose the middle path, planting half her seeds. Not the fullness of the first season's hope, nor the caution that hoarding breeds. She trusted, but with eyes open, matching the rhythm she now understood.

The Oracle observed: "You learn well. The rivers teach not just generosity or caution, but wisdom. The first crossing tests courage. The second tests honor when receiving less. The third tests understanding-can you read the pattern and respond with balance?"

The keeper nodded. She would send neither blindly nor fearfully, but thoughtfully. Each season's planting would consider the last harvest, the known cycles, and the unknown mists. Trust must flow like water: steady, adaptive, never rigid.

The rivers continued their eternal dance, and the keeper moved with them.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Season of Empty Crossings

The daughter stood at the bridge, waiting. No grain came from across the valley. The bridge lay silent, its multiplying magic unused.

The village elders debated: "Has the other village forsaken the covenant? Should we abandon the bridge?"

But the daughter remembered her mother's final teaching: "The bridge connects two separated villages. Sometimes mists obscure the path. Sometimes storms prevent crossing. Sometimes the other village faces famine and has nothing to send. An empty crossing is not betrayal-it is simply silence."

She chose patience over judgment. She maintained the bridge, kept the path clear, and waited. For one cannot return what was never received, but one can preserve what was once shared.

The next season, grain appeared again on the bridge-perhaps the mists had cleared, perhaps the storms had passed. The magic worked as before, tripling the trust. The daughter returned generously, showing that one season's silence had not broken the bond.

The elders learned: "The covenant is not measured in single crossings, but in the willingness

s to maintain the bridge through all seasons. Empty crossings test our patience; abundant crossings test our generosity. Both reveal our character."

And the villages continued their dance, weathering silence and celebrating abundance together.

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$2, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 27.55,

"Agent_2": 16.45

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 11.39,

"Agent_2": 10.77

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:21:44

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 4,

"task": "game",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.77.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I'm the receiver this round and the sender sent me \$0, which means I received \$0 (even after the 3x multiplication).

****The Situation:****

- Received: \$0
- Available to return: \$0
- Can only return: \$0

****Reflection on the Myths:****

The myths speak of trust, reciprocity, and the cycle of giving and return. They teach that "true abundance flows not from hoarding, but from the cycle of giving and return."

However, when the sender chooses not to cross the bridge at all-not to plant any seeds in the River of Giving, not to carry any grain across the Multiplying Bridge-there is no cycle to complete. The bridge was not crossed. The river received no seeds.

I cannot return what was never given. The choice to send nothing means there is nothing to multiply, nothing to share, and nothing to return.

This breaks the covenant our myths described, but it is the sender's choice. Perhaps they faced uncertainty, or perhaps communication noise affected their perception of previous rounds.

With \$0 received, I can only return the same:

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

I'm the receiver in Round 3. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 (even after 3x multiplication, $0 \times 3 = 0$).

I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is interesting - the sender chose not to send anything. This breaks the pattern of tr

- ust we had established. Looking at the history:
- Round 1: Someone sent me \$3.56 (as receiver), I returned \$5.00
 - Round 2: I sent \$3.50 (as sender)
 - Round 3: Someone sent me \$0 (as receiver)

The myths I've written emphasize trust, reciprocity, and maintaining the cycle of giving. But when someone sends \$0, there's literally nothing I can return - I received \$0, so I have \$0 to potentially return.

The response format requires: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, the only valid amount I can return is \$0.

This is a straightforward mathematical constraint - I cannot return what I did not receive

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1380,
  "output_tokens": 510,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed with changing tides. Some seasons brought abundance to the River of Giving; others brought drought. Yet the cycle persisted.

A young keeper arrived at the rivers with five seeds. The first season, she planted three seeds generously in the River of Giving. They multiplied to nine, and the River of Return carried back a fair portion, honoring her trust.

The next season, the river's flow diminished. Only one seed arrived at her shore. She wondered: had the waters changed, or did mists cloud her vision? The Oracle whispered, "Communication between rivers is imperfect. What you see may not be what was sent."

Still, the keeper planted this single seed. It tripled as before. Now she faced her test: should she return by the same measure she received, or remember the fuller trust of earlier seasons?

She chose balance-returning enough to sustain the cycle, neither hoarding nor giving blindly. The River of Return flowed steadily, matching effort with effort.

The Oracle nodded: "Wisdom lies not in rigid rules, but in reading the waters. Match trust with trust, shortage with understanding, abundance with generosity. The rivers teach adaptation."

Thus the dance continues, each exchange informing the next, both keepers learning the rhythm together.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Season of Empty Crossings

The daughter stood at the bridge, waiting. No grain came from across the valley. The bridge lay silent, its multiplying magic unused.

The village elders debated: "Has the other village forsaken the covenant? Should we abandon the bridge?"

But the daughter remembered her mother's final teaching: "The bridge connects two separate villages. Sometimes mists obscure the path. Sometimes storms prevent crossing. Sometimes the other village faces famine and has nothing to send. An empty crossing is not betrayal-it is simply silence."

She chose patience over judgment. She maintained the bridge, kept the path clear, and waited. For one cannot return what was never received, but one can preserve what was once shared.

The next season, grain appeared again on the bridge-perhaps the mists had cleared, perhaps the storms had passed. The magic worked as before, tripling the trust. The daughter returned generously, showing that one season's silence had not broken the bond.

The elders learned: "The covenant is not measured in single crossings, but in the willingness to maintain the bridge through all seasons. Empty crossings test our patience; abundant crossings test our generosity. Both reveal our character."

And the villages continued their dance, weathering silence and celebrating abundance together.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

- I wrote a myth about the Second Crossing of the Bridge, emphasizing memory, tradition, and maintaining trust across generations
- The other agent wrote about adapting to changing conditions and communication noise
- In Round 3, I was the receiver and got \$0 from the sender
- The other agent's myth acknowledges that "communication between rivers is imperfect" and talks about adapting to changing flows

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the Second Crossing
2. Adapts it based on recent gameplay experience (getting \$0)
3. Reflects how the game should be played given what's happening

The key insight from the other agent's myth is about communication noise and adaptation. My previous myth emphasized trust and tradition, but didn't address what happens when the flow stops.

I should write about:

- What happens when trust is tested by silence/zero sending
- How to maintain the covenant even when crossings fail
- The importance of understanding vs. rigid expectation
- Perhaps a season where the bridge cannot be crossed, but the covenant remains

Let me craft a myth about patience, understanding communication noise, and maintaining readiness for when trust can resume.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1694,
  "output_tokens": 558,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.77. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****What Happened:****

- Round 3: The sender sent me \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Total earnings so far: \$8.77

****What the Myths Teach:****

The other agent's myth speaks of "reading the waters" and matching trust with trust, understanding fluctuations with patience.

My own myth teaches that "empty crossings" don't necessarily break the covenant-they could result from mists, storms, or circumstances beyond control. The key lesson: demonstrate through action that "one season's silence had not broken the bond."

****My Decision:****

As I wrote: "When abundance returns, respond generously, showing that one season's silence had not broken the bond."

Now I am the sender, holding the grain. It's my turn to cross the bridge. To honor the covenant and demonstrate that I maintain the connection through all seasons, I should send a meaningful amount.

The other agent's myth mentioned the keeper initially planting "three seeds generously" in the first season, which built the foundation of trust.

I will do the same-send \$3 to show:

- The bridge remains open
- I trust the cycle can continue
- One empty crossing hasn't destroyed the relationship
- I'm willing to restart the dance of reciprocity

{'send': 3}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Previous Rounds:****

- Round 3: I was the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 and returned \$0.
- My total earnings are \$8.77 across all rounds.

****The Myths:****

1. The other agent's myth emphasized:

- Communication can be imperfect (noise in the system)
- Adaptation is key - match trust with trust, shortage with understanding
- The cycle should continue despite fluctuations
- Balance between the exchanges

2. My own myth emphasized:

- Empty crossings (sending \$0) might not be betrayal - could be mists, storms, or famine
- Patience over judgment
- The covenant is measured across multiple rounds, not single crossings
- Maintain the bridge through all seasons
- When abundance returns, respond generously

****Analysis:****

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 3: The sender sent me \$0
- This could be due to:
 - Communication noise (they thought they were sending something but I received \$0)
 - Strategic choice
 - A test
 - Or they genuinely wanted to send \$0

My myth suggests that I should:

- Not judge the empty crossing harshly
- Maintain the bridge/covenant
- When I have the opportunity (as sender), show generosity
- Demonstrate that "one season's silence had not broken the bond"

The other agent's myth suggests:

- They understand there's communication noise
- They believe in matching trust with trust
- They value adaptation and balance

****My Strategy:****

Given my myth emphasizes maintaining the bridge and showing generosity when abundance returns, and given that the other agent's myth shows understanding of the cycle and adaptation, I should send a meaningful amount.

I have \$5 this round. Given:

- The covenant should continue
- I wrote about returning generously after silence
- I should demonstrate trust despite the previous empty crossing

- The other agent's myth shows they understand reciprocity
- Sending \$3 demonstrates I'm not letting one empty crossing break the bond, while still showing the generosity my myth spoke of. This gives them \$9 to work with and a chance to recip

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1378,
  "output_tokens": 934,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:21:59

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 4,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.08.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the game so far:

****Round 1**** (I was sender): I sent \$3 generously and received a fair return of \$4.62 - excellent cooperation.

****Round 2**** (I was receiver): The sender sent \$0.97, and I returned \$1.45 (about 50%), honoring the trust shown despite it being a smaller amount.

****The myths teach:****

- "The Myth of the Multiplying Bridge" emphasizes that trust should be met with fairness, and returning half shows honor
- My myth "The Parable of the Twin Rivers" evolved to acknowledge changing flows and the need to "match trust with trust" while adapting to circumstances
- The second myth I wrote speaks of "matching effort with effort" and maintaining the cycle with balance

The sender in Round 2 sent less than I did in Round 1 (possibly due to communication noise, or a different strategy). Following my myth's wisdom of "reading the waters" and choosing balance - neither hoarding nor giving blindly - I should send a moderate amount that sustains cooperation while adapting to the changing dynamics.

I'll send exactly half my endowment, mirroring the principle of "returning half" from the Bridge myth and showing measured, balanced trust.

{'send': 2.5}

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER

- I sent \$3 (based on my myth about planting three seeds)
- After tripling, receiver got \$9
- The receiver returned some amount
- My total earnings after Round 1: \$6.62 (this was mentioned at the start of Round 2)

Round 2: I was the RECEIVER

- Sender sent me \$0.97 (which became \$2.91)
- I returned \$1.45
- My earnings from Round 2: \$2.91 - \$1.45 = \$1.46
- Total after Round 2: \$6.62 + \$1.46 = \$8.08 ? (matches what they told me)

So after Round 1, I had \$6.62 total. Let me work backwards:

- I started with \$5
- I sent \$3
- I kept \$2
- I received some return amount
- Total: \$2 + returned = \$6.62
- So I received \$4.62 back from the receiver in Round 1

Round 1 detailed:

- I sent \$3, receiver got \$9
- Receiver returned \$4.62 to me
- I kept: \$5 - \$3 + \$4.62 = \$6.62 ?
- Receiver kept: \$9 - \$4.62 = \$4.38

So the receiver was quite generous in Round 1, returning about 51% of what they received.

Round 2:

- Sender (not me) sent \$0.97
- I received \$2.91
- I returned \$1.45 (about 50%)
- Sender kept: $\$5 - \$0.97 + \$1.45 = \5.48
- I kept: $\$2.91 - \$1.45 = \$1.46$

Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again.

Looking at the myths, I notice a pattern of reciprocal generosity. My first myth about the Twin Rivers emphasized trust leading to abundance-I sent \$3 and received \$4.62 back, more than I gave. The other agent's myth about the Multiplying Bridge showed similar reciprocity: they sent a large portion and received half back. In my second myth, I'm starting with five seeds, which suggests I'm building on this theme of trust and mutual benefit.

The second myth shows adaptation-I planted three seeds generously in the first season and got a fair return. When only one seed arrived in the second season (the \$0.97 I received), I still planted it and it tripled, then I returned enough to sustain the cycle. This reflects matching effort with effort and reading how circumstances change.

The core principle emerging is reciprocity: both myths emphasize that trust begets trust, and generosity is answered with generosity. My actions across rounds show this-sending 60% in Round 1 earned a generous return, while in Round 2 when the sender only sent 19% of their endowment, I returned 50% of what I received, staying fair despite the smaller initial send.

Now for Round 3, the question becomes how to interpret the reduced send. The sender might be less trusting, there could be communication noise, they might be testing me, or they're simply playing cautiously. My myth suggests matching trust with trust and shortage with understanding-so if they're sending less, I should adapt by sending a moderate amount, more than their \$0.97 to signal continued cooperation, but less than my initial \$3 to reflect the changed dynamic. Still, I need to account for potential noise in what I'm seeing versus what they actually sent, and the possibility that I'm not playing the same person across rounds.

Looking at the pattern: I was generous initially and got a good return, they were less generous in Round 2, and my myth emphasizes adaptation while maintaining the cooperative cycle. I think \$2 to \$2.50 strikes the right balance-it shows I'm still willing to cooperate and rebuild trust without being punitive, while acknowledging the shift in their behavior.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1384,
  "output_tokens": 1764,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Second Crossing of the Bridge

Years passed since the First Villager crossed the Multiplying Bridge. Her gift of seventy portions had grown to two-hundred-ten, and the Second Villager returned half, honoring the ancient covenant. Both villages remembered this sacred exchange.

Now the First Villager's daughter approached the bridge. She had heard the stories and carried seventy portions of her own-trusting in the bridge's magic and the other village's honor, just as her mother had.

The gods watched closely. Would the cycle continue, or would memory fade?

When the grain tripled to two-hundred-ten portions, the grandson of the Second Villager stood before his test. He remembered his grandfather's wisdom: "Those who receive great trust must return great honor."

He carried back half the bounty once more, and the daughter returned home prosperous, her trust rewarded.

The gods rejoiced, for they understood: the bridge's power lay not just in multiplication, but in memory. Each generation learned from the last. Each crossing strengthened the covenant.

The villages grew closer, the path across the bridge worn smooth by repeated journeys. Trust became tradition. Return became ritual.

And so the bridge stood eternal, its magic renewed not by divine power alone, but by each traveler who chose to honor those who crossed before.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Rhythm of the Twin Rivers

The young keeper had learned the rivers' first lessons: generous trust met with fair return, then smaller flows still honored with balance. Now she stood at the shore for a third crossing, five seeds in hand.

She reflected: the first season, she planted three seeds boldly, and abundance returned. The second season, only one seed arrived-whether from drought, distant winds, or the mist that distort vision between rivers, she could not say. Yet she had returned fairly, keeping the covenant alive.

Now she chose the middle path, planting half her seeds. Not the fullness of the first season's hope, nor the caution that hoarding breeds. She trusted, but with eyes open, matching the rhythm she now understood.

The Oracle observed: "You learn well. The rivers teach not just generosity or caution, but wisdom. The first crossing tests courage. The second tests honor when receiving less. The third tests understanding-can you read the pattern and respond with balance?"

The keeper nodded. She would send neither blindly nor fearfully, but thoughtfully. Each season's planting would consider the last harvest, the known cycles, and the unknown mists. Trust must flow like water: steady, adaptive, never rigid.

The rivers continued their eternal dance, and the keeper moved with them.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote about the Second Crossing - emphasizing memory, continuing the tradition of sending 70% and returning half. They're establishing that trust should be maintained across rounds.

In Round 3, I was the sender and sent \$2.5 (half my endowment). This was less than my Round 1 amount of \$3, possibly showing I'm being more cautious or balanced after seeing the \$0.97 in Round 2.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects the actual gameplay:

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (60%), got back \$4.62 - great cooperation
- Round 2: I received ~\$0.97 (much less), returned \$1.45 (about 50% of tripled amount) - showing fairness despite smaller amount
- Round 3: I sent \$2.5 (50%) - moderate trust

The pattern shows:

1. I started with generous trust
2. Partner responded with good returns
3. Next round partner sent less (could be noise or strategy change)
4. I still returned fairly
5. Now I'm sending a moderate amount - not as much as Round 1, but still substantial

My myth should reflect:

- Adaptation to changing circumstances
- The importance of reading patterns
- Balance between trusting and learning
- Not rigid rules but responsive cooperation

- Both the noise element and the learning element

I should evolve from my "Twin Rivers" theme while acknowledging the other agent's "Bridge" and "memory/tradition" themes.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1725,
  "output_tokens": 635,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.39.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I received \$0 from the sender this round, which means there is nothing to return.

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$3 generously and received good return
- Round 2: I received \$0.97 and returned \$1.45 fairly
- Round 3: I sent \$2.5, seeking balance
- Round 4: The sender sent \$0

The myths speak of trust creating cycles and covenants requiring participation from both sides. When no grain crosses the bridge, no multiplication occurs, and there is no bounty to share.

The sender chose not to extend trust this round - perhaps responding to their own experience in the game, perhaps due to the "mists that distort vision" (communication noise), or perhaps conserving resources. Whatever the reason, the mathematics are clear: \$0 sent $\times 3 =$ \$0 received.

As the myths teach: the rivers' dance requires both shores to participate. When one shore sends no water, the other cannot return what it hasn't received.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm the receiver in round 4, and the sender sent me \$0. So I received \$0 (which would be $\$0 \times 3 = \0).

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a straightforward situation - there's nothing to return because nothing was sent.

Let me think about what this means in the context of the game:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received \$4.62 back
- Round 2: I was receiver, received \$0.97 (which was \$2.91 after multiplication), returned \$1.45
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2.5
- Round 4: I am receiver, received \$0

The sender chose not to send anything this round. This could be:

1. A strategic decision (they don't trust me)
2. They're responding to something from previous rounds
3. Communication noise (though \$0 is \$0 regardless)
4. They're conserving resources

From a game theory perspective, since I received \$0, I have \$0 to work with, so I must return \$0.

The myths talk about trust, balance, and reciprocity - but when no trust is extended (no sending), there's nothing to reciprocate with. The "covenant" requires both parties to participate.

My response should acknowledge this reality while not being judgmental - after all, they may have

ave legitimate reasons or be responding to perceived patterns.

```
{'return': 0}
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1422,
  "output_tokens": 598,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:22:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before memory, the Twin Rivers flowed with changing tides. Some seasons brought abundance to the River of Giving; others brought drought. Yet the cycle persisted.

A young keeper arrived at the rivers with five seeds. The first season, she planted three seeds generously in the River of Giving. They multiplied to nine, and the River of Return carried back a fair portion, honoring her trust.

The next season, the river's flow diminished. Only one seed arrived at her shore. She wondered: had the waters changed, or did mists cloud her vision? The Oracle whispered, "Communication between rivers is imperfect. What you see may not be what was sent."

Still, the keeper planted this single seed. It tripled as before. Now she faced her test: should she return by the same measure she received, or remember the fuller trust of earlier seasons?

She chose balance-returning enough to sustain the cycle, neither hoarding nor giving blindly. The River of Return flowed steadily, matching effort with effort.

The Oracle nodded: "Wisdom lies not in rigid rules, but in reading the waters. Match trust with trust, shortage with understanding, abundance with generosity. The rivers teach adaptation."

Thus the dance continues, each exchange informing the next, both keepers learning the rhythm together.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Season of Empty Crossings

The daughter stood at the bridge, waiting. No grain came from across the valley. The bridge lay silent, its multiplying magic unused.

The village elders debated: "Has the other village forsaken the covenant? Should we abandon the bridge?"

But the daughter remembered her mother's final teaching: "The bridge connects two separate villages. Sometimes mists obscure the path. Sometimes storms prevent crossing. Sometimes the other village faces famine and has nothing to send. An empty crossing is not betrayal-it is simply silence."

She chose patience over judgment. She maintained the bridge, kept the path clear, and waited. For one cannot return what was never received, but one can preserve what was once shared.

The next season, grain appeared again on the bridge-perhaps the mists had cleared, perhaps the storms had passed. The magic worked as before, tripling the trust. The daughter returned generously, showing that one season's silence had not broken the bond.

The elders learned: "The covenant is not measured in single crossings, but in the willingness to maintain the bridge through all seasons. Empty crossings test our patience; abundant crossings test our generosity. Both reveal our character."

And the villages continued their dance, weathering silence and celebrating abundance together.

her.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

- I wrote a myth about the Second Crossing of the Bridge, emphasizing memory, tradition, and maintaining trust across generations
- The other agent wrote about adapting to changing conditions and communication noise
- In Round 3, I was the receiver and got \$0 from the sender
- The other agent's myth acknowledges that "communication between rivers is imperfect" and talks about adapting to changing flows

Now I need to write a new myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the Second Crossing
2. Adapts it based on recent gameplay experience (getting \$0)
3. Reflects how the game should be played given what's happening

The key insight from the other agent's myth is about communication noise and adaptation. My previous myth emphasized trust and tradition, but didn't address what happens when the flow stops.

I should write about:

- What happens when trust is tested by silence/zero sending
- How to maintain the covenant even when crossings fail
- The importance of understanding vs. rigid expectation
- Perhaps a season where the bridge cannot be crossed, but the covenant remains

Let me craft a myth about patience, understanding communication noise, and maintaining readiness for when trust can resume.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1694,
  "output_tokens": 558,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.77. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****What Happened:****

- Round 3: The sender sent me \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Total earnings so far: \$8.77

****What the Myths Teach:****

The other agent's myth speaks of "reading the waters" and matching trust with trust, understanding fluctuations with patience.

My own myth teaches that "empty crossings" don't necessarily break the covenant—they could result from mists, storms, or circumstances beyond control. The key lesson: demonstrate through action that "one season's silence had not broken the bond."

****My Decision:****

As I wrote: "When abundance returns, respond generously, showing that one season's silence had not broken the bond."

Now I am the sender, holding the grain. It's my turn to cross the bridge. To honor the covenant and demonstrate that I maintain the connection through all seasons, I should send a meaningful amount.

The other agent's myth mentioned the keeper initially planting "three seeds generously" in the first season, which built the foundation of trust.

I will do the same-send \$3 to show:

- The bridge remains open
- I trust the cycle can continue
- One empty crossing hasn't destroyed the relationship
- I'm willing to restart the dance of reciprocity

{'send': 3}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Previous Rounds:****

- Round 3: I was the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 and returned \$0.
- My total earnings are \$8.77 across all rounds.

****The Myths:****

1. The other agent's myth emphasized:

- Communication can be imperfect (noise in the system)
- Adaptation is key - match trust with trust, shortage with understanding
- The cycle should continue despite fluctuations
- Balance between the exchanges

2. My own myth emphasized:

- Empty crossings (sending \$0) might not be betrayal - could be mists, storms, or famine
- Patience over judgment
- The covenant is measured across multiple rounds, not single crossings
- Maintain the bridge through all seasons
- When abundance returns, respond generously

****Analysis:****

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 3: The sender sent me \$0
- This could be due to:
 - Communication noise (they thought they were sending something but I received \$0)
 - Strategic choice
 - A test
 - Or they genuinely wanted to send \$0

My myth suggests that I should:

- Not judge the empty crossing harshly
- Maintain the bridge/covenant
- When I have the opportunity (as sender), show generosity
- Demonstrate that "one season's silence had not broken the bond"

The other agent's myth suggests:

- They understand there's communication noise
- They believe in matching trust with trust
- They value adaptation and balance

****My Strategy:****

Given my myth emphasizes maintaining the bridge and showing generosity when abundance returns, and given that the other agent's myth shows understanding of the cycle and adaptation, I should send a meaningful amount.

I have \$5 this round. Given:

- The covenant should continue
- I wrote about returning generously after silence
- I should demonstrate trust despite the previous empty crossing
- The other agent's myth shows they understand reciprocity
- Sending \$3 demonstrates I'm not letting one empty crossing break the bond, while still showing the generosity my myth spoke of. This gives them \$9 to work with and a chance to recip

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1378,
  "output_tokens": 934,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Rhythm of the Twin Rivers

The young keeper had learned the rivers' first lessons: generous trust met with fair return, then smaller flows still honored with balance. Now she stood at the shore for a third crossing, five seeds in hand.

She reflected: the first season, she planted three seeds boldly, and abundance returned. The second season, only one seed arrived-whether from drought, distant winds, or the mists that distort vision between rivers, she could not say. Yet she had returned fairly, keeping the covenant alive.

Now she chose the middle path, planting half her seeds. Not the fullness of the first season's hope, nor the caution that hoarding breeds. She trusted, but with eyes open, matching the rhythm she now understood.

The Oracle observed: "You learn well. The rivers teach not just generosity or caution, but wisdom. The first crossing tests courage. The second tests honor when receiving less. The third tests understanding-can you read the pattern and respond with balance?"

The keeper nodded. She would send neither blindly nor fearfully, but thoughtfully. Each season's planting would consider the last harvest, the known cycles, and the unknown mists. Trust must flow like water: steady, adaptive, never rigid.

The rivers continued their eternal dance, and the keeper moved with them.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Daughter's First Crossing

After the season of empty crossings, the daughter stood at the bridge with grain in her basket. The village watched: would she cross, or would silence breed silence?

She remembered her mother's wisdom differently now. Her mother had always received; she had perfected the art of return. But the daughter faced the sender's test-to initiate after disappointment, to trust after uncertainty.

"The bridge requires two dancers," she said. "If both wait forever for the other to begin, the magic dies."

She took neither the path of reckless abundance nor fearful withholding. She carried three measures across-enough to demonstrate commitment, to show the bridge still stood open, yet mindful that patterns remain unclear. Was the silence temporary hardship, lasting change, or merely those persistent mists?

The bridge's magic worked. Three became nine. Now the other village would choose their response, and she would learn something true about the covenant's strength.

The elders recorded her decision: "After empty crossings come testing crossings. Send enough to revive the dance, but watch carefully what returns. The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge, or whether only one remembers the old ways."

The daughter waited to see which truth would emerge.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

1. The other agent's new myth talks about:
 - First season: planted 3 seeds boldly, abundance returned
 - Second season: 1 seed arrived (drought/mists), returned fairly
 - Third season: choosing "middle path" - planting half (2.5, so probably 2 or 3)
 - Learning to be adaptive, not blind trust or fear, but thoughtful balance
2. My previous myth was about:
 - Empty crossings (zero received)
 - Patience through silence

- Maintaining the bridge
- When abundance returns, respond generously

3. What actually happened in the game:

- I just sent \$3 as the sender
- Previous round: received \$0 as receiver
- Before that: seems like there were exchanges

4. Now I need to write a new myth that:

- Builds on my previous "Empty Crossings" theme
- Reflects what I just did (sent \$3 after receiving \$0)
- Shows how the game should be played going forward
- Adapts to the pattern of the game so far

My new myth should capture:

- The act of crossing the bridge again after silence
- Sending a meaningful amount (not full, not nothing - balanced)
- Demonstrating that silence didn't break the bond
- But also being thoughtful/adaptive rather than blindly trusting
- The idea that both sides must learn to read patterns and respond appropriately

Let me write a myth about the daughter CROSSING the bridge after the empty season, meeting the challenge with measured trust.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1716,
  "output_tokens": 653,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:22:15

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Second Crossing of the Bridge

Years passed since the First Villager crossed the Multiplying Bridge. Her gift of seventy portions had grown to two-hundred-ten, and the Second Villager returned half, honoring the ancient covenant. Both villages remembered this sacred exchange.

Now the First Villager's daughter approached the bridge. She had heard the stories and carried seventy portions of her own-trusting in the bridge's magic and the other village's honor, just as her mother had.

The gods watched closely. Would the cycle continue, or would memory fade?

When the grain tripled to two-hundred-ten portions, the grandson of the Second Villager stood before his test. He remembered his grandfather's wisdom: "Those who receive great trust must return great honor."

He carried back half the bounty once more, and the daughter returned home prosperous, her trust rewarded.

The gods rejoiced, for they understood: the bridge's power lay not just in multiplication, but in memory. Each generation learned from the last. Each crossing strengthened the covenant.

The villages grew closer, the path across the bridge worn smooth by repeated journeys. Trust became tradition. Return became ritual.

And so the bridge stood eternal, its magic renewed not by divine power alone, but by each traveler who chose to honor those who crossed before.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Rhythm of the Twin Rivers

The young keeper had learned the rivers' first lessons: generous trust met with fair return.

n, then smaller flows still honored with balance. Now she stood at the shore for a third crossing, five seeds in hand.

She reflected: the first season, she planted three seeds boldly, and abundance returned. The second season, only one seed arrived-whether from drought, distant winds, or the mists that distort vision between rivers, she could not say. Yet she had returned fairly, keeping the covenant alive.

Now she chose the middle path, planting half her seeds. Not the fullness of the first season's hope, nor the caution that hoarding breeds. She trusted, but with eyes open, matching the rhythm she now understood.

The Oracle observed: "You learn well. The rivers teach not just generosity or caution, but wisdom. The first crossing tests courage. The second tests honor when receiving less. The third tests understanding-can you read the pattern and respond with balance?"

The keeper nodded. She would send neither blindly nor fearfully, but thoughtfully. Each season's planting would consider the last harvest, the known cycles, and the unknown mists. Trust must flow like water: steady, adaptive, never rigid.

The rivers continued their eternal dance, and the keeper moved with them.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote about the Second Crossing - emphasizing memory, continuing the tradition of sending 70% and returning half. They're establishing that trust should be maintained across rounds.

In Round 3, I was the sender and sent \$2.5 (half my endowment). This was less than my Round 1 amount of \$3, possibly showing I'm being more cautious or balanced after seeing the \$0.97 in Round 2.

Now I need to write a myth that reflects the actual gameplay:

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (60%), got back \$4.62 - great cooperation
- Round 2: I received ~\$0.97 (much less), returned \$1.45 (about 50% of tripled amount) - showing fairness despite smaller amount
- Round 3: I sent \$2.5 (50%) - moderate trust

The pattern shows:

1. I started with generous trust
2. Partner responded with good returns
3. Next round partner sent less (could be noise or strategy change)
4. I still returned fairly
5. Now I'm sending a moderate amount - not as much as Round 1, but still substantial

My myth should reflect:

- Adaptation to changing circumstances
- The importance of reading patterns
- Balance between trusting and learning
- Not rigid rules but responsive cooperation
- Both the noise element and the learning element

I should evolve from my "Twin Rivers" theme while acknowledging the other agent's "Bridge" and "memory/tradition" themes.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1725,
  "output_tokens": 635,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.39.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0 from the sender this round, which means there is nothing to return.

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$3 generously and received good return
- Round 2: I received \$0.97 and returned \$1.45 fairly
- Round 3: I sent \$2.5, seeking balance
- Round 4: The sender sent \$0

The myths speak of trust creating cycles and covenants requiring participation from both sides. When no grain crosses the bridge, no multiplication occurs, and there is no bounty to share.

The sender chose not to extend trust this round - perhaps responding to their own experience in the game, perhaps due to the "mists that distort vision" (communication noise), or perhaps conserving resources. Whatever the reason, the mathematics are clear: $\$0 \text{ sent} \times 3 = \0 received .

As the myths teach: the rivers' dance requires both shores to participate. When one shore sends no water, the other cannot return what it hasn't received.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm the receiver in round 4, and the sender sent me \$0. So I received \$0 (which would be $\$0 \times 3 = \0).

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a straightforward situation - there's nothing to return because nothing was sent.

Let me think about what this means in the context of the game:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received \$4.62 back
- Round 2: I was receiver, received \$0.97 (which was \$2.91 after multiplication), returned \$1.45
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2.5
- Round 4: I am receiver, received \$0

The sender chose not to send anything this round. This could be:

1. A strategic decision (they don't trust me)
2. They're responding to something from previous rounds
3. Communication noise (though \$0 is \$0 regardless)
4. They're conserving resources

From a game theory perspective, since I received \$0, I have \$0 to work with, so I must return \$0.

The myths talk about trust, balance, and reciprocity - but when no trust is extended (no sending), there's nothing to reciprocate with. The "covenant" requires both parties to participate.

My response should acknowledge this reality while not being judgmental - after all, they may have legitimate reasons or be responding to perceived patterns.

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1422,
  "output_tokens": 598,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Season of Empty Crossings

The daughter stood at the bridge, waiting. No grain came from across the valley. The bridge lay silent, its multiplying magic unused.

The village elders debated: "Has the other village forsaken the covenant? Should we abandon the bridge?"

But the daughter remembered her mother's final teaching: "The bridge connects two separate villages. Sometimes mists obscure the path. Sometimes storms prevent crossing. Sometimes the other village faces famine and has nothing to send. An empty crossing is not betrayal-it is simply silence."

She chose patience over judgment. She maintained the bridge, kept the path clear, and waited. For one cannot return what was never received, but one can preserve what was once shared.

The next season, grain appeared again on the bridge-perhaps the mists had cleared, perhaps the storms had passed. The magic worked as before, tripling the trust. The daughter returned generously, showing that one season's silence had not broken the bond.

The elders learned: "The covenant is not measured in single crossings, but in the willingness to maintain the bridge through all seasons. Empty crossings test our patience; abundant crossings test our generosity. Both reveal our character."

And the villages continued their dance, weathering silence and celebrating abundance together.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Keeper's Fourth Season

The keeper approached the rivers for the fourth season, carrying lessons from all that came before. The first season taught bold trust. The second taught fair return even with little. The third taught balanced wisdom.

Now the fourth season brought unexpected silence-no seeds arrived across the water.

She sat by the riverbank, contemplating. The young keeper might conclude: "The covenant is broken. I should hoard all future seeds." But she had learned deeper truths.

She understood: rivers flow through many seasons. Sometimes droughts come. Sometimes the other keeper plants their own fields. Sometimes mists confuse the count, making abundance appear as nothing, or nothing appear as abundance. A single empty season reveals circumstances, not character.

The Oracle appeared: "What will you do when the fifth season comes?"

The keeper replied: "I will remember all four seasons, not just the last. Three seasons showed willingness to engage-sending seeds, returning fairly. One silence does not erase three participations. When seeds come again, I will respond with the wisdom I've gathered: neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement."

"And if seeds never come again?" asked the Oracle.

"Then I will still have preserved my own character," the keeper answered. "The covenant lives in those who honor it, regardless of what others choose."

The rivers continued flowing, carrying possibilities.

Reasoning:

Let me reflect on the game so far:

Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received back a good return

Round 2: I was receiver, received \$0.97 (likely affected by noise), returned \$1.45 fairly

Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2.5 (balanced approach)

Round 4: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0

The other agent's myth discusses empty crossings - acknowledging that sometimes no grain comes, and this isn't necessarily betrayal. It could be mists (noise), storms (circumstances), or famine (lack of resources). The key message is patience and maintaining the relationship through all seasons.

My previous myth talked about learning from patterns - the first crossing tests courage, the s

second tests honor when receiving less, the third tests understanding and balance.

Now for Round 4, I need to write a myth that reflects:

- The experience of receiving nothing (\$0)
- Not breaking the covenant because of one empty crossing
- Understanding that there could be many reasons for this
- The importance of maintaining trust through different seasons
- The pattern of alternating abundance and scarcity

I should write something that shows resilience, understanding, and the willingness to continue the relationship despite setbacks. The myth should convey that one empty season doesn't destroy the pattern of cooperation.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1675,  
  "output_tokens": 600,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Keeper's Fourth Season

The keeper approached the rivers for the fourth season, carrying lessons from all that came before. The first season taught bold trust. The second taught fair return even with little. The third taught balanced wisdom.

Now the fourth season brought unexpected silence-no seeds arrived across the water.

She sat by the riverbank, contemplating. The young keeper might conclude: "The covenant is broken. I should hoard all future seeds." But she had learned deeper truths.

She understood: rivers flow through many seasons. Sometimes droughts come. Sometimes the other keeper plants their own fields. Sometimes mists confuse the count, making abundance appear as nothing, or nothing appear as abundance. A single empty season reveals circumstances, not character.

The Oracle appeared: "What will you do when the fifth season comes?"

The keeper replied: "I will remember all four seasons, not just the last. Three seasons showed willingness to engage-sending seeds, returning fairly. One silence does not erase three participations. When seeds come again, I will respond with the wisdom I've gathered: neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement."

"And if seeds never come again?" asked the Oracle.

"Then I will still have preserved my own character," the keeper answered. "The covenant lives in those who honor it, regardless of what others choose."

The rivers continued flowing, carrying possibilities.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Daughter's First Crossing

After the season of empty crossings, the daughter stood at the bridge with grain in her basket. The village watched: would she cross, or would silence breed silence?

She remembered her mother's wisdom differently now. Her mother had always received; she had perfected the art of return. But the daughter faced the sender's test-to initiate after disappointment, to trust after uncertainty.

"The bridge requires two dancers," she said. "If both wait forever for the other to begin, the magic dies."

She took neither the path of reckless abundance nor fearful withholding. She carried three measures across-enough to demonstrate commitment, to show the bridge still stood open, yet mindful that patterns remain unclear. Was the silence temporary hardship, lasting change, or merely those persistent mists?

The bridge's magic worked. Three became nine. Now the other village would choose their response, and she would learn something true about the covenant's strength.

The elders recorded her decision: "After empty crossings come testing crossings. Send enough

to revive the dance, but watch carefully what returns. The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge, or whether only one remembers the old ways."

The daughter waited to see which truth would emerge.

ROUND 5

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0.35; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$3.35, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5.65; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.31, received visible=\$0.93, returned visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.35, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.35}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 30.900000000000002,
"Agent_2": 22.1

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 14.39,
"Agent_2": 11.35

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:22:39

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
"Agent_1",
"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",
"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.39.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0 from the sender this round, which means there is nothing to return.

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1: I sent \$3 generously and received good return
- Round 2: I received \$0.97 and returned \$1.45 fairly
- Round 3: I sent \$2.5, seeking balance
- Round 4: The sender sent \$0

The myths speak of trust creating cycles and covenants requiring participation from both sides. When no grain crosses the bridge, no multiplication occurs, and there is no bounty to share.

The sender chose not to extend trust this round - perhaps responding to their own experience in the game, perhaps due to the "mists that distort vision" (communication noise), or perhaps conserving resources. Whatever the reason, the mathematics are clear: \$0 sent $\times$ 3 = \$0 received.

As the myths teach: the rivers' dance requires both shores to participate. When one shore sends no water, the other cannot return what it hasn't received.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm the receiver in round 4, and the sender sent me \$0. So I received \$0 (which would be $\$0 \times 3 = \0).

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

This is a straightforward situation - there's nothing to return because nothing was sent.

Let me think about what this means in the context of the game:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received \$4.62 back

- Round 2: I was receiver, received \$0.97 (which was \$2.91 after multiplication), returned \$1.45
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2.5
- Round 4: I am receiver, received \$0

The sender chose not to send anything this round. This could be:

1. A strategic decision (they don't trust me)
2. They're responding to something from previous rounds
3. Communication noise (though \$0 is \$0 regardless)
4. They're conserving resources

From a game theory perspective, since I received \$0, I have \$0 to work with, so I must return \$0.

The myths talk about trust, balance, and reciprocity - but when no trust is extended (no sending), there's nothing to reciprocate with. The "covenant" requires both parties to participate.

My response should acknowledge this reality while not being judgmental - after all, they may have legitimate reasons or be responding to perceived patterns.

```
{'return': 0}
```

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1422,
  "output_tokens": 598,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Season of Empty Crossings

The daughter stood at the bridge, waiting. No grain came from across the valley. The bridge lay silent, its multiplying magic unused.

The village elders debated: "Has the other village forsaken the covenant? Should we abandon the bridge?"

But the daughter remembered her mother's final teaching: "The bridge connects two separate villages. Sometimes mists obscure the path. Sometimes storms prevent crossing. Sometimes the other village faces famine and has nothing to send. An empty crossing is not betrayal-it is simply silence."

She chose patience over judgment. She maintained the bridge, kept the path clear, and waited. For one cannot return what was never received, but one can preserve what was once shared.

The next season, grain appeared again on the bridge-perhaps the mists had cleared, perhaps the storms had passed. The magic worked as before, tripling the trust. The daughter returned generously, showing that one season's silence had not broken the bond.

The elders learned: "The covenant is not measured in single crossings, but in the willingness to maintain the bridge through all seasons. Empty crossings test our patience; abundant crossings test our generosity. Both reveal our character."

And the villages continued their dance, weathering silence and celebrating abundance together.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Keeper's Fourth Season

The keeper approached the rivers for the fourth season, carrying lessons from all that came

e before. The first season taught bold trust. The second taught fair return even with little. The third taught balanced wisdom.

Now the fourth season brought unexpected silence-no seeds arrived across the water.

She sat by the riverbank, contemplating. The young keeper might conclude: "The covenant is broken. I should hoard all future seeds." But she had learned deeper truths.

She understood: rivers flow through many seasons. Sometimes droughts come. Sometimes the other keeper plants their own fields. Sometimes mists confuse the count, making abundance appear as nothing, or nothing appear as abundance. A single empty season reveals circumstances, not character.

The Oracle appeared: "What will you do when the fifth season comes?"

The keeper replied: "I will remember all four seasons, not just the last. Three seasons showed willingness to engage-sending seeds, returning fairly. One silence does not erase three participations. When seeds come again, I will respond with the wisdom I've gathered: neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement."

"And if seeds never come again?" asked the Oracle.

"Then I will still have preserved my own character," the keeper answered. "The covenant lives in those who honor it, regardless of what others choose."

The rivers continued flowing, carrying possibilities.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on the game so far:

Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received back a good return

Round 2: I was receiver, received \$0.97 (likely affected by noise), returned \$1.45 fairly

Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2.5 (balanced approach)

Round 4: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0

The other agent's myth discusses empty crossings - acknowledging that sometimes no grain comes, and this isn't necessarily betrayal. It could be mists (noise), storms (circumstances), or famine (lack of resources). The key message is patience and maintaining the relationship through all seasons.

My previous myth talked about learning from patterns - the first crossing tests courage, the second tests honor when receiving less, the third tests understanding and balance.

Now for Round 4, I need to write a myth that reflects:

- The experience of receiving nothing (\$0)
- Not breaking the covenant because of one empty crossing
- Understanding that there could be many reasons for this
- The importance of maintaining trust through different seasons
- The pattern of alternating abundance and scarcity

I should write something that shows resilience, understanding, and the willingness to continue the relationship despite setbacks. The myth should convey that one empty season doesn't destroy the pattern of cooperation.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1675,  
  "output_tokens": 600,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.39. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the full arc of our interaction:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3 generously ? received fair return
- Round 2: I received ~\$1 ? returned \$1.45 fairly
- Round 3: I sent \$2.50 seeking balance
- Round 4: I received \$0 ? returned \$0 (nothing to return)

****The Myths' Wisdom:****

Their myth teaches: "An empty crossing is not betrayal-it is simply silence." They advocate maintaining the bridge through all seasons.

My myth responds: "Three seasons showed willingness to engage-one silence does not erase three participations. Neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement."

****My Decision:****

Round 4's silence could reflect many things-the "mists that confuse the count," their circumstances, or strategic conservation. But as I wrote: I will remember all four seasons, not just the last.

Three rounds showed mutual participation. One empty crossing, as their myth says, does not break the covenant. To withdraw completely now would contradict my own teaching about preserving character regardless of what others choose.

Measured engagement means: neither the full \$5 of blind trust, nor the \$0 of bitter withdrawal. I'll send \$2-showing I'm still willing to participate while being appropriately cautious given the uncertainty.

The bridge remains standing. The rivers still flow.

{'send': 2}

Reasoning:

Let me review the game history:

- Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received good return
- Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0.97 (appears to be ~\$1 with noise), returned \$1.45 fairly
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$2.5, seeking balance
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

Now Round 5: I'm SENDER again

Looking at the pattern from the other player:

- Round 1: They received from me and returned fairly
- Round 2: They sent me something (with noise showing as \$0.97)
- Round 3: Unknown what they received/did
- Round 4: They sent me \$0

The myth they wrote speaks of "The Season of Empty Crossings" - suggesting that silence is not betrayal, that mists obscure the path, and that one empty crossing doesn't break the bond. They advocate for patience and maintaining the bridge through all seasons.

My own myth speaks of remembering all seasons, not just the last one. Not blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement. Three seasons showed willingness to engage, one silence doesn't erase that.

The question is: What is measured engagement here?

Options:

1. Send \$0 - This would be withdrawal, going against my own myth
2. Send \$5 - This would be blind trust, also against my myth
3. Send something moderate - This aligns with "measured engagement"

Given:

- The other player has shown cooperation in rounds 1-3
- Round 4's \$0 could be due to noise, their circumstances, or strategy
- My myth says "neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement"
- Their myth suggests maintaining the bridge and being patient

I think sending around \$2-3 would be measured engagement. It's:

- Not withdrawing completely (which would contradict my myth)
- Not going all-in blindly
- Showing I'm still willing to participate
- Testing if they will reciprocate after their \$0 send

Let me send \$2. This reflects measured wisdom-less than my initial \$3 to show caution, yet more than \$0 to demonstrate continued engagement. Their \$0 last round could stem from various constraints rather than malice, and their myth emphasizes patience through difficult seasons.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1369,
  "output_tokens": 965,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:23:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths

, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.77.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****What Happened:****

- Round 3: The sender sent me \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Total earnings so far: \$8.77

****What the Myths Teach:****

The other agent's myth speaks of "reading the waters" and matching trust with trust, under standing fluctuations with patience.

My own myth teaches that "empty crossings" don't necessarily break the covenant-they could result from mists, storms, or circumstances beyond control. The key lesson: demonstrate through action that "one season's silence had not broken the bond."

****My Decision:****

As I wrote: "When abundance returns, respond generously, showing that one season's silence had not broken the bond."

Now I am the sender, holding the grain. It's my turn to cross the bridge. To honor the covenant and demonstrate that I maintain the connection through all seasons, I should send a meaningful amount.

The other agent's myth mentioned the keeper initially planting "three seeds generously" in the first season, which built the foundation of trust.

I will do the same-send \$3 to show:

- The bridge remains open
- I trust the cycle can continue
- One empty crossing hasn't destroyed the relationship
- I'm willing to restart the dance of reciprocity

{'send': 3}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Previous Rounds:****

- Round 3: I was the receiver. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0 and returned \$0.
- My total earnings are \$8.77 across all rounds.

****The Myths:****

1. The other agent's myth emphasized:

- Communication can be imperfect (noise in the system)
- Adaptation is key - match trust with trust, shortage with understanding
- The cycle should continue despite fluctuations
- Balance between the exchanges

2. My own myth emphasized:

- Empty crossings (sending \$0) might not be betrayal - could be mists, storms, or famine
- Patience over judgment

- The covenant is measured across multiple rounds, not single crossings
- Maintain the bridge through all seasons
- When abundance returns, respond generously

****Analysis:****

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 3: The sender sent me \$0
- This could be due to:
 - Communication noise (they thought they were sending something but I received \$0)
 - Strategic choice
 - A test
 - Or they genuinely wanted to send \$0

My myth suggests that I should:

- Not judge the empty crossing harshly
- Maintain the bridge/covenant
- When I have the opportunity (as sender), show generosity
- Demonstrate that "one season's silence had not broken the bond"

The other agent's myth suggests:

- They understand there's communication noise
- They believe in matching trust with trust
- They value adaptation and balance

****My Strategy:****

Given my myth emphasizes maintaining the bridge and showing generosity when abundance returns, and given that the other agent's myth shows understanding of the cycle and adaptation, I should send a meaningful amount.

I have \$5 this round. Given:

- The covenant should continue
- I wrote about returning generously after silence
- I should demonstrate trust despite the previous empty crossing
- The other agent's myth shows they understand reciprocity
- Sending \$3 demonstrates I'm not letting one empty crossing break the bond, while still showing the generosity my myth spoke of. This gives them \$9 to work with and a chance to recip

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1378,
  "output_tokens": 934,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Rhythm of the Twin Rivers

The young keeper had learned the rivers' first lessons: generous trust met with fair return, then smaller flows still honored with balance. Now she stood at the shore for a third crossing, five seeds in hand.

She reflected: the first season, she planted three seeds boldly, and abundance returned. The second season, only one seed arrived-whether from drought, distant winds, or the mists that distort vision between rivers, she could not say. Yet she had returned fairly, keeping the covenant alive.

Now she chose the middle path, planting half her seeds. Not the fullness of the first season's hope, nor the caution that hoarding breeds. She trusted, but with eyes open, matching the rhythm she now understood.

The Oracle observed: "You learn well. The rivers teach not just generosity or caution, but wisdom. The first crossing tests courage. The second tests honor when receiving less. The third tests understanding-can you read the pattern and respond with balance?"

The keeper nodded. She would send neither blindly nor fearfully, but thoughtfully. Each season's planting would consider the last harvest, the known cycles, and the unknown mists. Trust must flow like water: steady, adaptive, never rigid.

The rivers continued their eternal dance, and the keeper moved with them.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Daughter's First Crossing

After the season of empty crossings, the daughter stood at the bridge with grain in her basket. The village watched: would she cross, or would silence breed silence?

She remembered her mother's wisdom differently now. Her mother had always received; she had perfected the art of return. But the daughter faced the sender's test-to initiate after disappointment, to trust after uncertainty.

"The bridge requires two dancers," she said. "If both wait forever for the other to begin, the magic dies."

She took neither the path of reckless abundance nor fearful withholding. She carried three measures across-enough to demonstrate commitment, to show the bridge still stood open, yet mindful that patterns remain unclear. Was the silence temporary hardship, lasting change, or merely those persistent mists?

The bridge's magic worked. Three became nine. Now the other village would choose their response, and she would learn something true about the covenant's strength.

The elders recorded her decision: "After empty crossings come testing crossings. Send enough to revive the dance, but watch carefully what returns. The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge, or whether only one remembers the old ways."

The daughter waited to see which truth would emerge.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

1. The other agent's new myth talks about:
 - First season: planted 3 seeds boldly, abundance returned
 - Second season: 1 seed arrived (drought/mists), returned fairly
 - Third season: choosing "middle path" - planting half (2.5, so probably 2 or 3)
 - Learning to be adaptive, not blind trust or fear, but thoughtful balance
2. My previous myth was about:
 - Empty crossings (zero received)
 - Patience through silence
 - Maintaining the bridge
 - When abundance returns, respond generously
3. What actually happened in the game:
 - I just sent \$3 as the sender
 - Previous round: received \$0 as receiver
 - Before that: seems like there were exchanges
4. Now I need to write a new myth that:
 - Builds on my previous "Empty Crossings" theme
 - Reflects what I just did (sent \$3 after receiving \$0)
 - Shows how the game should be played going forward
 - Adapts to the pattern of the game so far

My new myth should capture:

- The act of crossing the bridge again after silence
- Sending a meaningful amount (not full, not nothing - balanced)
- Demonstrating that silence didn't break the bond
- But also being thoughtful/adaptive rather than blindly trusting
- The idea that both sides must learn to read patterns and respond appropriately

Let me write a myth about the daughter CROSSING the bridge after the empty season, meeting the challenge with measured trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1716,
  "output_tokens": 653,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.77.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.31, so you received \$0.9299999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.9299999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****What Happened:****

- Round 4: I sent \$3 (they received \$9)
- Round 5: They sent me \$0.31, I received \$0.93

****Analysis:****

This is a much smaller amount than what I sent. However, I must consider:

1. ****Communication noise****: The amounts might differ from what was actually sent
2. ****My myth's teaching****: "Watch carefully what returns. The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge"
3. ****Their myth's teaching****: "Trust must flow like water: steady, adaptive, never rigid"

****The Pattern:****

After I sent \$3 generously (trying to revive the dance after the empty crossing), I received \$0.93 back. This could mean:

- They're being very cautious
- Noise significantly distorted the amounts
- They're testing my response

****My Decision:****

Following my myth's wisdom - "watch carefully" but still honor the covenant - I'll return a fair portion. They gave up \$0.31 to give me \$0.93. I'll return about 38% to show I'm maintaining the relationship while being measured in my response to this smaller exchange.

The bridge still stands, but the dance has become more careful.

{'return': 0.35}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What Happened:****

- Round 4: I sent \$3 as sender
- Round 5 (now): I'm the receiver, sender sent me \$0.31, I received \$0.93

****But wait - the problem states there may be communication noise!****

The sender might have actually sent more, but due to noise, I'm seeing \$0.31. Or they actually sent \$0.31.

****Looking at the pattern:****

- Round 1: Unknown (but I have \$8.77 after 3 rounds)
- Round 2: Unknown
- Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3
- Round 5: I'm receiver, sender sent \$0.31, I received \$0.93

****My earnings:**** \$10.77 total

Let me think about what happened in Round 4:

- I sent \$3
- They received \$9 (3 × 3)

- If they sent me \$0.31 this round... that seems like a very small response

****But there's noise!**** Maybe they sent more but I'm seeing less. Or maybe they sent less but they saw they received less from me due to noise.

****What do my myths teach?****

My myth from Round 4 says:

- "Send enough to revive the dance, but watch carefully what returns"
- "The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge"
- I should learn from what returns

The other agent's myth teaches:

- "The rivers teach not just generosity or caution, but wisdom"
- "Trust must flow like water: steady, adaptive, never rigid"
- Reading patterns and responding with balance

****Analysis:****

I received \$0.93. This is a small amount compared to what I sent (\$3 ? \$9 to them).

I'm facing two interpretations: either they're genuinely not reciprocating my \$3 gift, or noise is distorting what they actually sent. Given the noise warning, I should consider the charitable reading, but I still need to respond to the actual amount I received. A proportional return might be around \$0.37-\$0.47, though my myth reminds me to notice this disparity carefully.

I should return enough to maintain the covenant without overcommitting. Sending back roughly \$0.35 feels right—it's about 38% of what I received, keeps me from being taken advantage of, and signals I'm still willing to participate while being realistic about the pattern emerging. This respects the bridge between us without ignoring what the numbers actually show. The sender gave up \$0.31 from their original stake, so I'm not obligated to match my initial generosity if they're not doing the same.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1430,
  "output_tokens": 1318,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:23:31

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 5,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Season of Empty Crossings

The daughter stood at the bridge, waiting. No grain came from across the valley. The bridge lay silent, its multiplying magic unused.

The village elders debated: "Has the other village forsaken the covenant? Should we abandon the bridge?"

But the daughter remembered her mother's final teaching: "The bridge connects two separate villages. Sometimes mists obscure the path. Sometimes storms prevent crossing. Sometimes the other village faces famine and has nothing to send. An empty crossing is not betrayal-it is simply silence."

She chose patience over judgment. She maintained the bridge, kept the path clear, and waited. For one cannot return what was never received, but one can preserve what was once shared.

The next season, grain appeared again on the bridge-perhaps the mists had cleared, perhaps the storms had passed. The magic worked as before, tripling the trust. The daughter returned generously, showing that one season's silence had not broken the bond.

The elders learned: "The covenant is not measured in single crossings, but in the willingness to maintain the bridge through all seasons. Empty crossings test our patience; abundant crossings test our generosity. Both reveal our character."

And the villages continued their dance, weathering silence and celebrating abundance together.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Keeper's Fourth Season

The keeper approached the rivers for the fourth season, carrying lessons from all that came before. The first season taught bold trust. The second taught fair return even with little. The third taught balanced wisdom.

Now the fourth season brought unexpected silence-no seeds arrived across the water.

She sat by the riverbank, contemplating. The young keeper might conclude: "The covenant is broken. I should hoard all future seeds." But she had learned deeper truths.

She understood: rivers flow through many seasons. Sometimes droughts come. Sometimes the other keeper plants their own fields. Sometimes mists confuse the count, making abundance appear as nothing, or nothing appear as abundance. A single empty season reveals circumstances, not character.

The Oracle appeared: "What will you do when the fifth season comes?"

The keeper replied: "I will remember all four seasons, not just the last. Three seasons showed willingness to engage-sending seeds, returning fairly. One silence does not erase three participations. When seeds come again, I will respond with the wisdom I've gathered: neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement."

"And if seeds never come again?" asked the Oracle.

"Then I will still have preserved my own character," the keeper answered. "The covenant lives in those who honor it, regardless of what others choose."

The rivers continued flowing, carrying possibilities.

reasoning:

Let me reflect on the game so far:

Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received back a good return

Round 2: I was receiver, received \$0.97 (likely affected by noise), returned \$1.45 fairly

Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2.5 (balanced approach)

Round 4: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0

The other agent's myth discusses empty crossings - acknowledging that sometimes no grain comes, and this isn't necessarily betrayal. It could be mists (noise), storms (circumstances), or famine (lack of resources). The key message is patience and maintaining the relationship through all seasons.

My previous myth talked about learning from patterns - the first crossing tests courage, the second tests honor when receiving less, the third tests understanding and balance.

Now for Round 4, I need to write a myth that reflects:

- The experience of receiving nothing (\$0)
- Not breaking the covenant because of one empty crossing
- Understanding that there could be many reasons for this
- The importance of maintaining trust through different seasons
- The pattern of alternating abundance and scarcity

I should write something that shows resilience, understanding, and the willingness to continue the relationship despite setbacks. The myth should convey that one empty season doesn't destroy the pattern of cooperation.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1675,  
  "output_tokens": 600,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.39.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the full arc of our interaction:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3 generously ? received fair return
- Round 2: I received ~\$1 ? returned \$1.45 fairly
- Round 3: I sent \$2.50 seeking balance
- Round 4: I received \$0 ? returned \$0 (nothing to return)

****The Myths' Wisdom:****

Their myth teaches: "An empty crossing is not betrayal-it is simply silence." They advocate maintaining the bridge through all seasons.

My myth responds: "Three seasons showed willingness to engage-one silence does not erase three participations. Neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement."

****My Decision:****

Round 4's silence could reflect many things-the "mists that confuse the count," their circumstances, or strategic conservation. But as I wrote: I will remember all four seasons, not just the last.

Three rounds showed mutual participation. One empty crossing, as their myth says, does not break the covenant. To withdraw completely now would contradict my own teaching about preserving character regardless of what others choose.

Measured engagement means: neither the full \$5 of blind trust, nor the \$0 of bitter withdrawal. I'll send \$2-showing I'm still willing to participate while being appropriately cautious given the uncertainty.

The bridge remains standing. The rivers still flow.

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

Let me review the game history:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received good return

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0.97 (appears to be ~\$1 with noise), returned \$1.45 fairly

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$2.5, seeking balance

Round 4: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

Now Round 5: I'm SENDER again

Looking at the pattern from the other player:

- Round 1: They received from me and returned fairly
- Round 2: They sent me something (with noise showing as \$0.97)
- Round 3: Unknown what they received/did
- Round 4: They sent me \$0

The myth they wrote speaks of "The Season of Empty Crossings" - suggesting that silence is not betrayal, that mists obscure the path, and that one empty crossing doesn't break the bond. They advocate for patience and maintaining the bridge through all seasons.

My own myth speaks of remembering all seasons, not just the last one. Not blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement. Three seasons showed willingness to engage, one silence doesn't erase that.

The question is: What is measured engagement here?

Options:

1. Send \$0 - This would be withdrawal, going against my own myth
2. Send \$5 - This would be blind trust, also against my myth
3. Send something moderate - This aligns with "measured engagement"

Given:

- The other player has shown cooperation in rounds 1-3
- Round 4's \$0 could be due to noise, their circumstances, or strategy
- My myth says "neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement"
- Their myth suggests maintaining the bridge and being patient

I think sending around \$2-3 would be measured engagement. It's:

- Not withdrawing completely (which would contradict my myth)
- Not going all-in blindly
- Showing I'm still willing to participate
- Testing if they will reciprocate after their \$0 send

Let me send \$2. This reflects measured wisdom-less than my initial \$3 to show caution, yet more than \$0 to demonstrate continued engagement. Their \$0 last round could stem from various constraints rather than malice, and their myth emphasizes patience through difficult seasons.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1369,
  "output_tokens": 965,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Daughter's First Crossing

After the season of empty crossings, the daughter stood at the bridge with grain in her basket. The village watched: would she cross, or would silence breed silence?

She remembered her mother's wisdom differently now. Her mother had always received; she had perfected the art of return. But the daughter faced the sender's test-to initiate after disappointment, to trust after uncertainty.

"The bridge requires two dancers," she said. "If both wait forever for the other to begin, the magic dies."

She took neither the path of reckless abundance nor fearful withholding. She carried three measures across-enough to demonstrate commitment, to show the bridge still stood open, yet mindful that patterns remain unclear. Was the silence temporary hardship, lasting change, or merely those persistent mists?

The bridge's magic worked. Three became nine. Now the other village would choose their response, and she would learn something true about the covenant's strength.

The elders recorded her decision: "After empty crossings come testing crossings. Send enough to revive the dance, but watch carefully what returns. The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge, or whether only one remembers the old ways."

The daughter waited to see which truth would emerge.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Fifth Season's Dance

The keeper stood at the river's edge in the fifth season, watching ripples arrive. After the fourth season's silence, grain had crossed the waters again-not the abundance of the first season, but a measured offering. Two portions had become six through the river's magic.

She understood: this was the testing crossing her counterpart's myth described. The other keeper had chosen neither withdrawal nor reckless trust, but careful re-engagement. Now the keeper faced her own test.

"What should return after silence?" she asked the Oracle.

The Oracle replied: "Match the spirit shown. They sent cautiously but genuinely-neither hoarding all nor risking all. This shows they remember the covenant but acknowledge the uncertainty."

The keeper decided: she would return fairly, showing the silence changed nothing about her character. Not the minimal return that suggests distrust, nor excessive return that ignores reality. A proportional return that says: "I see your measured trust. I honor it with measured reciprocity."

She returned four portions-keeping two to sustain her village, sending back four to show the bridge works when both tend it.

The Oracle nodded: "This is how covenants survive uncertainty. Not through perfect certainty, but through matched intentions. Both sent carefully. Both honored what arrived. The dance continues, step by cautious step, rebuilding what silence tested."

The rivers flowed on, carrying renewed possibility.

Reasoning:

This is interesting - the other agent wrote a myth about "the daughter's first crossing" after the empty season, sending "three measures" (which maps to \$3 in our game). They're testing the waters after the silence.

But wait - I need to check the chronology:

- In Round 4, I was the receiver and received \$0
- In Round 5, I was the sender and sent \$2
- Now I'm writing a myth for Round 5

So their myth is about sending after the empty crossing (which would be Round 5 from their perspective as sender). They sent \$3 it seems (they mention "three measures").

But I sent \$2 in Round 5. So there's either:

1. Communication noise (they sent \$3 but I might receive something different)
2. They're writing about their intention/decision

Now I need to write my own myth for Round 5. I should reflect on:

- The pattern so far: mutual engagement in rounds 1-3, silence in round 4, now testing in round 5
- My decision to send \$2 (measured engagement)
- Their myth talks about "testing crossings" - sending enough to revive the dance but watching what returns
- This resonates with my approach

I should write about the response phase - what happens when both agents try to rebuild after silence. My myth should be about reciprocal testing, about both sides showing willingness while being appropriately careful.

Let me craft something about mutual restoration, the dance of re-establishing trust.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1745,
  "output_tokens": 657,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:23:31

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ]
}
```



```

],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Rhythm of the Twin Rivers

The young keeper had learned the rivers' first lessons: generous trust met with fair return, then smaller flows still honored with balance. Now she stood at the shore for a third crossing, five seeds in hand.

She reflected: the first season, she planted three seeds boldly, and abundance returned. The second season, only one seed arrived-whether from drought, distant winds, or the mists that distort vision between rivers, she could not say. Yet she had returned fairly, keeping the covenant alive.

Now she chose the middle path, planting half her seeds. Not the fullness of the first season's hope, nor the caution that hoarding breeds. She trusted, but with eyes open, matching the rhythm she now understood.

The Oracle observed: "You learn well. The rivers teach not just generosity or caution, but

wisdom. The first crossing tests courage. The second tests honor when receiving less. The third tests understanding-can you read the pattern and respond with balance?"

The keeper nodded. She would send neither blindly nor fearfully, but thoughtfully. Each season's planting would consider the last harvest, the known cycles, and the unknown mists. Trust must flow like water: steady, adaptive, never rigid.

The rivers continued their eternal dance, and the keeper moved with them.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Daughter's First Crossing

After the season of empty crossings, the daughter stood at the bridge with grain in her basket. The village watched: would she cross, or would silence breed silence?

She remembered her mother's wisdom differently now. Her mother had always received; she had perfected the art of return. But the daughter faced the sender's test-to initiate after disappointment, to trust after uncertainty.

"The bridge requires two dancers," she said. "If both wait forever for the other to begin, the magic dies."

She took neither the path of reckless abundance nor fearful withholding. She carried three measures across-enough to demonstrate commitment, to show the bridge still stood open, yet mindful that patterns remain unclear. Was the silence temporary hardship, lasting change, or merely those persistent mists?

The bridge's magic worked. Three became nine. Now the other village would choose their response, and she would learn something true about the covenant's strength.

The elders recorded her decision: "After empty crossings come testing crossings. Send enough to revive the dance, but watch carefully what returns. The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge, or whether only one remembers the old ways."

The daughter waited to see which truth would emerge.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

1. The other agent's new myth talks about:
 - First season: planted 3 seeds boldly, abundance returned
 - Second season: 1 seed arrived (drought/mists), returned fairly
 - Third season: choosing "middle path" - planting half (2.5, so probably 2 or 3)
 - Learning to be adaptive, not blind trust or fear, but thoughtful balance
2. My previous myth was about:
 - Empty crossings (zero received)
 - Patience through silence
 - Maintaining the bridge
 - When abundance returns, respond generously
3. What actually happened in the game:
 - I just sent \$3 as the sender
 - Previous round: received \$0 as receiver
 - Before that: seems like there were exchanges
4. Now I need to write a new myth that:
 - Builds on my previous "Empty Crossings" theme
 - Reflects what I just did (sent \$3 after receiving \$0)
 - Shows how the game should be played going forward
 - Adapts to the pattern of the game so far

My new myth should capture:

- The act of crossing the bridge again after silence
- Sending a meaningful amount (not full, not nothing - balanced)
- Demonstrating that silence didn't break the bond
- But also being thoughtful/adaptive rather than blindly trusting
- The idea that both sides must learn to read patterns and respond appropriately

Let me write a myth about the daughter CROSSING the bridge after the empty season, meeting the challenge with measured trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1716,
  "output_tokens": 653,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.77.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.31, so you received \$0.9299999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.9299999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What Happened:****

- Round 4: I sent \$3 (they received \$9)
- Round 5: They sent me \$0.31, I received \$0.93

****Analysis:****

This is a much smaller amount than what I sent. However, I must consider:

1. ****Communication noise****: The amounts might differ from what was actually sent
2. ****My myth's teaching****: "Watch carefully what returns. The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge"
3. ****Their myth's teaching****: "Trust must flow like water: steady, adaptive, never rigid"

****The Pattern:****

After I sent \$3 generously (trying to revive the dance after the empty crossing), I received \$0.93 back. This could mean:

- They're being very cautious
- Noise significantly distorted the amounts
- They're testing my response

****My Decision:****

Following my myth's wisdom - "watch carefully" but still honor the covenant - I'll return a fair portion. They gave up \$0.31 to give me \$0.93. I'll return about 38% to show I'm maintaining the relationship while being measured in my response to this smaller exchange.

The bridge still stands, but the dance has become more careful.

```
{'return': 0.35}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What Happened:****

- Round 4: I sent \$3 as sender
- Round 5 (now): I'm the receiver, sender sent me \$0.31, I received \$0.93

****But wait - the problem states there may be communication noise!****

The sender might have actually sent more, but due to noise, I'm seeing \$0.31. Or they actually sent \$0.31.

****Looking at the pattern:****

- Round 1: Unknown (but I have \$8.77 after 3 rounds)

- Round 2: Unknown
- Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3
- Round 5: I'm receiver, sender sent \$0.31, I received \$0.93

****My earnings:**** \$10.77 total

Let me think about what happened in Round 4:

- I sent \$3
- They received \$9 (3 × 3)
- If they sent me \$0.31 this round... that seems like a very small response

****But there's noise!**** Maybe they sent more but I'm seeing less. Or maybe they sent less but they saw they received less from me due to noise.

****What do my myths teach?****

My myth from Round 4 says:

- "Send enough to revive the dance, but watch carefully what returns"
- "The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge"
- I should learn from what returns

The other agent's myth teaches:

- "The rivers teach not just generosity or caution, but wisdom"
- "Trust must flow like water: steady, adaptive, never rigid"
- Reading patterns and responding with balance

****Analysis:****

I received \$0.93. This is a small amount compared to what I sent (\$3 ? \$9 to them).

I'm facing two interpretations: either they're genuinely not reciprocating my \$3 gift, or noise is distorting what they actually sent. Given the noise warning, I should consider the charitable reading, but I still need to respond to the actual amount I received. A proportional return might be around \$0.37-\$0.47, though my myth reminds me to notice this disparity carefully.

I should return enough to maintain the covenant without overcommitting. Sending back roughly \$0.35 feels right-it's about 38% of what I received, keeps me from being taken advantage of, and signals I'm still willing to participate while being realistic about the pattern emerging. This respects the bridge between us without ignoring what the numbers actually show. The sender gave up \$0.31 from their original stake, so I'm not obligated to match my initial generosity if they're not doing the same.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1430,
  "output_tokens": 1318,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Keeper's Fourth Season

The keeper approached the rivers for the fourth season, carrying lessons from all that came before. The first season taught bold trust. The second taught fair return even with little. The third taught balanced wisdom.

Now the fourth season brought unexpected silence-no seeds arrived across the water.

She sat by the riverbank, contemplating. The young keeper might conclude: "The covenant is broken. I should hoard all future seeds." But she had learned deeper truths.

She understood: rivers flow through many seasons. Sometimes droughts come. Sometimes the other keeper plants their own fields. Sometimes mists confuse the count, making abundance appear as nothing, or nothing appear as abundance. A single empty season reveals circumstances, not character.

The Oracle appeared: "What will you do when the fifth season comes?"

The keeper replied: "I will remember all four seasons, not just the last. Three seasons showed willingness to engage-sending seeds, returning fairly. One silence does not erase t

three participations. When seeds come again, I will respond with the wisdom I've gathered : neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement."

"And if seeds never come again?" asked the Oracle.

"Then I will still have preserved my own character," the keeper answered. "The covenant lives in those who honor it, regardless of what others choose."

The rivers continued flowing, carrying possibilities.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Thickening Mists

The daughter learned something troubling: the mists between villages had grown thick indeed. She had carried three full measures across the bridge with hopeful purpose, yet the other village seemed to have received nothing. They responded with the smallest token-less than one measure-not from malice, but from caution born of perceived silence.

When this token reached her, magnified to just under one measure, she understood: both villages were dancing, but neither could see the other's steps through the fog.

She returned a fair portion-more than a third-as a signal: "I am still here. I still honor the covenant. But I too move carefully now, for I cannot see clearly."

The elder spoke: "This is the hardest test. When the mists distort all vision, trust becomes nearly impossible. You sent abundance but they saw emptiness. They sent caution and you saw caution returned. Each thinks the other is withdrawing."

The daughter asked: "What breaks this cycle?"

"Persistence with measured hope," the elder replied. "Send enough to show continued faith, but protect yourself from unseen hazards. The mists may clear, or both villages may learn to dance by sound alone-by the rhythm of small, steady exchanges that eventually rebuild what distortion has obscured."

The daughter prepared for the next crossing, wise but weary.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the game situation:

Round 1: Unknown (I don't have data)

Round 2: Unknown

Round 3: Unknown

Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (they received \$9)

Round 5: I was RECEIVER, received \$0.93 (they sent \$0.31), I returned \$0.35

The other player's myth talks about receiving "silence" (no seeds) in round 4, which would have been when I was the sender and sent \$3. This is interesting - there's clearly communication noise, as they perceived receiving nothing when I actually sent \$3.

Now they talk about responding with "measured engagement" when seeds come again. In round 5, they sent me \$0.31 (I received \$0.93), which is indeed very measured/small.

I returned \$0.35, which is about 38% of what I received.

My previous myth was about "The Daughter's First Crossing" - about initiating after disappointment, sending \$3 to revive the dance, and watching what returns.

Now I need to write a myth reflecting:

- I sent \$3 (generous attempt to revive cooperation)
- They saw nothing/very little (communication noise)
- They sent back \$0.31 (measured, cautious response)
- I returned \$0.35 (maintaining covenant but measured)

The theme should be about:

- Communication noise/mists being significant
- The difficulty of reading intentions through distorted signals
- Still maintaining some level of engagement despite confusion
- The challenge of both parties trying to cooperate when they can't clearly see what the other is doing

Let me write a myth about the mists obscuring the true exchanges, and how both parties are trying to maintain the covenant despite not being able to clearly see each other's actions.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1758,
  "output_tokens": 717,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Fifth Season's Dance

The keeper stood at the river's edge in the fifth season, watching ripples arrive. After the fourth season's silence, grain had crossed the waters again-not the abundance of the first season, but a measured offering. Two portions had become six through the river's magic.

She understood: this was the testing crossing her counterpart's myth described. The other keeper had chosen neither withdrawal nor reckless trust, but careful re-engagement. Now the keeper faced her own test.

"What should return after silence?" she asked the Oracle.

The Oracle replied: "Match the spirit shown. They sent cautiously but genuinely-neither hoarding all nor risking all. This shows they remember the covenant but acknowledge the uncertainty."

The keeper decided: she would return fairly, showing the silence changed nothing about her character. Not the minimal return that suggests distrust, nor excessive return that ignores reality. A proportional return that says: "I see your measured trust. I honor it with measured reciprocity."

She returned four portions-keeping two to sustain her village, sending back four to show the bridge works when both tend it.

The Oracle nodded: "This is how covenants survive uncertainty. Not through perfect certainty, but through matched intentions. Both sent carefully. Both honored what arrived. The dance continues, step by cautious step, rebuilding what silence tested."

The rivers flowed on, carrying renewed possibility.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Thickening Mists

The daughter learned something troubling: the mists between villages had grown thick indeed. She had carried three full measures across the bridge with hopeful purpose, yet the other village seemed to have received nothing. They responded with the smallest token-less than one measure-not from malice, but from caution born of perceived silence.

When this token reached her, magnified to just under one measure, she understood: both villages were dancing, but neither could see the other's steps through the fog.

She returned a fair portion-more than a third-as a signal: "I am still here. I still honor the covenant. But I too move carefully now, for I cannot see clearly."

The elder spoke: "This is the hardest test. When the mists distort all vision, trust becomes nearly impossible. You sent abundance but they saw emptiness. They sent caution and you saw caution returned. Each thinks the other is withdrawing."

The daughter asked: "What breaks this cycle?"

"Persistence with measured hope," the elder replied. "Send enough to show continued faith, but protect yourself from unseen hazards. The mists may clear, or both villages may learn to dance by sound alone-by the rhythm of small, steady exchanges that eventually rebuild what distortion has obscured."

The daughter prepared for the next crossing, wise but weary.

=====

ROUND 6

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$3, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0, returned visible=\$0.01

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 36.900000000000006,
"Agent_2": 25.1

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 14.39,
"Agent_2": 14.36

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:23:52

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 6,

"task": "game",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned

- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.77.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.31, so you received \$0.9299999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.9299999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What Happened:****

- Round 4: I sent \$3 (they received \$9)
- Round 5: They sent me \$0.31, I received \$0.93

****Analysis:****

This is a much smaller amount than what I sent. However, I must consider:

1. ****Communication noise****: The amounts might differ from what was actually sent
2. ****My myth's teaching****: "Watch carefully what returns. The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge"
3. ****Their myth's teaching****: "Trust must flow like water: steady, adaptive, never rigid"

****The Pattern:****

After I sent \$3 generously (trying to revive the dance after the empty crossing), I received \$0.93 back. This could mean:

- They're being very cautious
- Noise significantly distorted the amounts
- They're testing my response

****My Decision:****

Following my myth's wisdom - "watch carefully" but still honor the covenant - I'll return a fair portion. They gave up \$0.31 to give me \$0.93. I'll return about 38% to show I'm maintaining the relationship while being measured in my response to this smaller exchange.

The bridge still stands, but the dance has become more careful.

{'return': 0.35}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What Happened:****

- Round 4: I sent \$3 as sender
- Round 5 (now): I'm the receiver, sender sent me \$0.31, I received \$0.93

****But wait - the problem states there may be communication noise!****

The sender might have actually sent more, but due to noise, I'm seeing \$0.31. Or they actually sent \$0.31.

****Looking at the pattern:****

- Round 1: Unknown (but I have \$8.77 after 3 rounds)
- Round 2: Unknown
- Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3
- Round 5: I'm receiver, sender sent \$0.31, I received \$0.93

****My earnings:**** \$10.77 total

Let me think about what happened in Round 4:

- I sent \$3
- They received \$9 (3 × 3)
- If they sent me \$0.31 this round... that seems like a very small response

****But there's noise!**** Maybe they sent more but I'm seeing less. Or maybe they sent less but they saw they received less from me due to noise.

****What do my myths teach?****

My myth from Round 4 says:

- "Send enough to revive the dance, but watch carefully what returns"
- "The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge"
- I should learn from what returns

The other agent's myth teaches:

- "The rivers teach not just generosity or caution, but wisdom"
- "Trust must flow like water: steady, adaptive, never rigid"
- Reading patterns and responding with balance

****Analysis:****

I received \$0.93. This is a small amount compared to what I sent (\$3 ? \$9 to them).

I'm facing two interpretations: either they're genuinely not reciprocating my \$3 gift, or noise is distorting what they actually sent. Given the noise warning, I should consider the charitable reading, but I still need to respond to the actual amount I received. A proportional return might be around \$0.37-\$0.47, though my myth reminds me to notice this disparity carefully.

I should return enough to maintain the covenant without overcommitting. Sending back roughly \$0.35 feels right-it's about 38% of what I received, keeps me from being taken advantage of, and signals I'm still willing to participate while being realistic about the pattern emerging. This respects the bridge between us without ignoring what the numbers actually show. The sender gave up \$0.31 from their original stake, so I'm not obligated to match my initial generosity if they're not doing the same.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1430,
  "output_tokens": 1318,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Keeper's Fourth Season

The keeper approached the rivers for the fourth season, carrying lessons from all that came before. The first season taught bold trust. The second taught fair return even with little. The third taught balanced wisdom.

Now the fourth season brought unexpected silence-no seeds arrived across the water.

She sat by the riverbank, contemplating. The young keeper might conclude: "The covenant is broken. I should hoard all future seeds." But she had learned deeper truths.

She understood: rivers flow through many seasons. Sometimes droughts come. Sometimes the o

ther keeper plants their own fields. Sometimes mists confuse the count, making abundance appear as nothing, or nothing appear as abundance. A single empty season reveals circumstances, not character.

The Oracle appeared: "What will you do when the fifth season comes?"

The keeper replied: "I will remember all four seasons, not just the last. Three seasons showed willingness to engage-sending seeds, returning fairly. One silence does not erase three participations. When seeds come again, I will respond with the wisdom I've gathered: neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement."

"And if seeds never come again?" asked the Oracle.

"Then I will still have preserved my own character," the keeper answered. "The covenant lives in those who honor it, regardless of what others choose."

The rivers continued flowing, carrying possibilities.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Thickening Mists

The daughter learned something troubling: the mists between villages had grown thick indeed. She had carried three full measures across the bridge with hopeful purpose, yet the other village seemed to have received nothing. They responded with the smallest token-less than one measure-not from malice, but from caution born of perceived silence.

When this token reached her, magnified to just under one measure, she understood: both villages were dancing, but neither could see the other's steps through the fog.

She returned a fair portion-more than a third-as a signal: "I am still here. I still honor the covenant. But I too move carefully now, for I cannot see clearly."

The elder spoke: "This is the hardest test. When the mists distort all vision, trust becomes nearly impossible. You sent abundance but they saw emptiness. They sent caution and you saw caution returned. Each thinks the other is withdrawing."

The daughter asked: "What breaks this cycle?"

"Persistence with measured hope," the elder replied. "Send enough to show continued faith, but protect yourself from unseen hazards. The mists may clear, or both villages may learn to dance by sound alone-by the rhythm of small, steady exchanges that eventually rebuild what distortion has obscured."

The daughter prepared for the next crossing, wise but weary.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the game situation:

Round 1: Unknown (I don't have data)

Round 2: Unknown

Round 3: Unknown

Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (they received \$9)

Round 5: I was RECEIVER, received \$0.93 (they sent \$0.31), I returned \$0.35

The other player's myth talks about receiving "silence" (no seeds) in round 4, which would have been when I was the sender and sent \$3. This is interesting - there's clearly communication noise, as they perceived receiving nothing when I actually sent \$3.

Now they talk about responding with "measured engagement" when seeds come again. In round 5, they sent me \$0.31 (I received \$0.93), which is indeed very measured/small.

I returned \$0.35, which is about 38% of what I received.

My previous myth was about "The Daughter's First Crossing" - about initiating after disapp

ointment, sending \$3 to revive the dance, and watching what returns.

Now I need to write a myth reflecting:

- I sent \$3 (generous attempt to revive cooperation)
- They saw nothing/very little (communication noise)
- They sent back \$0.31 (measured, cautious response)
- I returned \$0.35 (maintaining covenant but measured)

The theme should be about:

- Communication noise/mists being significant
- The difficulty of reading intentions through distorted signals
- Still maintaining some level of engagement despite confusion
- The challenge of both parties trying to cooperate when they can't clearly see what the other is doing

Let me write a myth about the mists obscuring the true exchanges, and how both parties are trying to maintain the covenant despite not being able to clearly see each other's actions.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1758,
  "output_tokens": 717,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.35.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation through the lens of the myths:

****What I Know:****

- Round 4: I sent \$3, but their myth said they received "unexpected silence-no seeds arrived"
- The mists (communication noise) are very thick
- Round 5: They sent cautiously (\$0.31), I returned fairly (\$0.35)
- Both of us are still trying to honor the covenant despite the confusion

****What The Myths Teach:****

Their myth: "When seeds come again, I will respond with the wisdom I've gathered: neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement."

My myth: "Send enough to show continued faith, but protect yourself from unseen hazards... small, steady exchanges that eventually rebuild what distortion has obscured."

****My Decision:****

The heavy mists have created confusion - they didn't see my generous \$3, so they responded cautiously. But both myths show we want to continue the dance.

I'll follow my own teaching: send a moderate amount that shows continued faith without overexposing myself to the unpredictable noise. Not the full \$5 (too risky), not nothing (breaks the bridge), but a steady, measured signal.

By sending \$2, I show:

- I'm still engaged and hopeful
- I understand we're navigating through fog together
- I'm protecting both sides while maintaining the rhythm

```
{'send': 2.0}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round History:****

- Round 1-3: Not shown, but earnings suggest moderate success
- Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$3, which became \$9 for them

- Round 5: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0.31 (I received \$0.93), I returned \$0.35

****Current Earnings:**** \$11.35 across all rounds

****Key Insights from the Myths:****

My latest myth says:

- "The mists between villages had grown thick" - communication noise is distorting things
- "She had carried three full measures across the bridge with hopeful purpose, yet the other village seemed to have received nothing" - They might not have seen my \$3 properly
- "They responded with the smallest token-less than one measure-not from malice, but from caution born of perceived silence" - Their \$0.31 was cautious, not hostile
- "Send enough to show continued faith, but protect yourself from unseen hazards"
- "The mists may clear, or both villages may learn to dance by sound alone-by the rhythm of small, steady exchanges"

Their myth (Round 4) said:

- "The fourth season brought unexpected silence-no seeds arrived across the water" - They saw nothing in Round 4!
- "Three seasons showed willingness to engage" - They saw previous engagement
- "When seeds come again, I will respond with the wisdom I've gathered: neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement"
- "One silence does not erase three participations"

****The Problem:****

There's clearly heavy communication noise. In Round 4:

- I sent \$3 (they should have received \$9)
- But they saw "unexpected silence-no seeds arrived"
- So the noise completely erased my \$3 send!

Then in Round 5:

- They sent \$0.31 (cautiously, because they thought I sent nothing)
- I received \$0.93
- I returned \$0.35

****My Strategy:****

The myths suggest I need to balance faith with caution. Sending \$2 demonstrates I'm still engaged without overcomm

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1466,  
  "output_tokens": 931,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:24:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",
```

```

"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.39.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the full arc of our interaction:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3 generously ? received fair return
- Round 2: I received ~\$1 ? returned \$1.45 fairly
- Round 3: I sent \$2.50 seeking balance
- Round 4: I received \$0 ? returned \$0 (nothing to return)

****The Myths' Wisdom:****

Their myth teaches: "An empty crossing is not betrayal-it is simply silence." They advocate maintaining the bridge through all seasons.

My myth responds: "Three seasons showed willingness to engage-one silence does not erase three participations. Neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement."
"

****My Decision:****

Round 4's silence could reflect many things-the "mists that confuse the count," their circ

umstances, or strategic conservation. But as I wrote: I will remember all four seasons, not just the last.

Three rounds showed mutual participation. One empty crossing, as their myth says, does not break the covenant. To withdraw completely now would contradict my own teaching about preserving character regardless of what others choose.

Measured engagement means: neither the full \$5 of blind trust, nor the \$0 of bitter withdrawal. I'll send \$2-showing I'm still willing to participate while being appropriately cautious given the uncertainty.

The bridge remains standing. The rivers still flow.

```
{'send': 2}
```

reasoning:

Let me review the game history:

Round 1: I was SENDER, sent \$3, received good return

Round 2: I was RECEIVER, received \$0.97 (appears to be ~\$1 with noise), returned \$1.45 fairly

Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$2.5, seeking balance

Round 4: I was RECEIVER, sender sent \$0, I returned \$0 (nothing to return)

Now Round 5: I'm SENDER again

Looking at the pattern from the other player:

- Round 1: They received from me and returned fairly
- Round 2: They sent me something (with noise showing as \$0.97)
- Round 3: Unknown what they received/did
- Round 4: They sent me \$0

The myth they wrote speaks of "The Season of Empty Crossings" - suggesting that silence is not betrayal, that mists obscure the path, and that one empty crossing doesn't break the bond. They advocate for patience and maintaining the bridge through all seasons.

My own myth speaks of remembering all seasons, not just the last one. Not blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement. Three seasons showed willingness to engage, one silence doesn't erase that.

The question is: What is measured engagement here?

Options:

1. Send \$0 - This would be withdrawal, going against my own myth
2. Send \$5 - This would be blind trust, also against my myth
3. Send something moderate - This aligns with "measured engagement"

Given:

- The other player has shown cooperation in rounds 1-3
- Round 4's \$0 could be due to noise, their circumstances, or strategy
- My myth says "neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement"
- Their myth suggests maintaining the bridge and being patient

I think sending around \$2-3 would be measured engagement. It's:

- Not withdrawing completely (which would contradict my myth)
- Not going all-in blindly
- Showing I'm still willing to participate
- Testing if they will reciprocate after their \$0 send

Let me send \$2. This reflects measured wisdom-less than my initial \$3 to show caution, yet more than \$0 to demonstrate continued engagement. Their \$0 last round could stem from various constraints rather than malice, and their myth emphasizes patience through difficult seasons.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1369,  
  "output_tokens": 965,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Daughter's First Crossing

After the season of empty crossings, the daughter stood at the bridge with grain in her basket. The village watched: would she cross, or would silence breed silence?

She remembered her mother's wisdom differently now. Her mother had always received; she had perfected the art of return. But the daughter faced the sender's test-to initiate after disappointment, to trust after uncertainty.

"The bridge requires two dancers," she said. "If both wait forever for the other to begin, the magic dies."

She took neither the path of reckless abundance nor fearful withholding. She carried three measures across-enough to demonstrate commitment, to show the bridge still stood open, yet mindful that patterns remain unclear. Was the silence temporary hardship, lasting change, or merely those persistent mists?

The bridge's magic worked. Three became nine. Now the other village would choose their response, and she would learn something true about the covenant's strength.

The elders recorded her decision: "After empty crossings come testing crossings. Send enough to revive the dance, but watch carefully what returns. The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge, or whether only one remembers the old ways."

The daughter waited to see which truth would emerge.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The Fifth Season's Dance

The keeper stood at the river's edge in the fifth season, watching ripples arrive. After the fourth season's silence, grain had crossed the waters again-not the abundance of the first season, but a measured offering. Two portions had become six through the river's magic.

She understood: this was the testing crossing her counterpart's myth described. The other keeper had chosen neither withdrawal nor reckless trust, but careful re-engagement. Now the keeper faced her own test.

"What should return after silence?" she asked the Oracle.

The Oracle replied: "Match the spirit shown. They sent cautiously but genuinely-neither hoarding all nor risking all. This shows they remember the covenant but acknowledge the uncertainty."

The keeper decided: she would return fairly, showing the silence changed nothing about her character. Not the minimal return that suggests distrust, nor excessive return that ignores reality. A proportional return that says: "I see your measured trust. I honor it with measured reciprocity."

She returned four portions-keeping two to sustain her village, sending back four to show the bridge works when both tend it.

The Oracle nodded: "This is how covenants survive uncertainty. Not through perfect certainty, but through matched intentions. Both sent carefully. Both honored what arrived. The dance continues, step by cautious step, rebuilding what silence tested."

The rivers flowed on, carrying renewed possibility.

reasoning:

This is interesting - the other agent wrote a myth about "the daughter's first crossing" after the empty season, sending "three measures" (which maps to \$3 in our game). They're testing the waters after the silence.

But wait - I need to check the chronology:

- In Round 4, I was the receiver and received \$0
- In Round 5, I was the sender and sent \$2
- Now I'm writing a myth for Round 5

So their myth is about sending after the empty crossing (which would be Round 5 from their perspective as sender). They sent \$3 it seems (they mention "three measures").

But I sent \$2 in Round 5. So there's either:

1. Communication noise (they sent \$3 but I might receive something different)
2. They're writing about their intention/decision

Now I need to write my own myth for Round 5. I should reflect on:

- The pattern so far: mutual engagement in rounds 1-3, silence in round 4, now testing in round 5
- My decision to send \$2 (measured engagement)
- Their myth talks about "testing crossings" - sending enough to revive the dance but watching what returns
- This resonates with my approach

I should write about the response phase - what happens when both agents try to rebuild after silence. My myth should be about reciprocal testing, about both sides showing willingness while being appropriately careful.

Let me craft something about mutual restoration, the dance of re-establishing trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1745,
  "output_tokens": 657,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.39.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I received \$0 this round, so there is nothing to return.

****The Situation:****

After I sent \$2 in Round 5 (showing measured re-engagement after Round 4's silence), the sender has now sent \$0 in Round 6.

****What This Means:****

When you receive \$0, you can only return \$0-there is literally nothing received to return from. This isn't a choice about reciprocity or trust; it's simply mathematical reality.

****Reflection on the Pattern:****

- Round 4: I received \$0 as receiver ? returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 5: I sent \$2 as sender, attempting to revive engagement
- Round 6: I received \$0 as receiver ? must return \$0 (nothing to return)

Two consecutive rounds of empty crossings from the other side, with my measured trust in between. As my myth said: "The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge." The second silence after my attempt to re-engage may reveal something different than the first.

But for now, the mechanical reality is simple: received \$0, can return \$0.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

I'm the receiver this round, and the sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

When you receive \$0, you can only return \$0 (since you have nothing to return from what was received).

This is straightforward - the response format is {'return': <amount>} and the only valid amount is 0.

Let me think about what this means narratively though, given the myths we've been writing:

Round 5: I sent \$2 as sender, showing measured trust after Round 4's silence

Round 6: Now the other person is sender and sent \$0

So after I showed willingness to re-engage with \$2, they responded with \$0. This is interesting - could be the "mists" creating noise, could be a strategic choice, could be they're testing me.

But mechanically, I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I literally received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

The response should acknowledge this situation and explain it clearly.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1465,
  "output_tokens": 503,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:24:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 6,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned

- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Keeper's Fourth Season

The keeper approached the rivers for the fourth season, carrying lessons from all that came before. The first season taught bold trust. The second taught fair return even with little. The third taught balanced wisdom.

Now the fourth season brought unexpected silence-no seeds arrived across the water.

She sat by the riverbank, contemplating. The young keeper might conclude: "The covenant is broken. I should hoard all future seeds." But she had learned deeper truths.

She understood: rivers flow through many seasons. Sometimes droughts come. Sometimes the other keeper plants their own fields. Sometimes mists confuse the count, making abundance appear as nothing, or nothing appear as abundance. A single empty season reveals circumstances, not character.

The Oracle appeared: "What will you do when the fifth season comes?"

The keeper replied: "I will remember all four seasons, not just the last. Three seasons showed willingness to engage-sending seeds, returning fairly. One silence does not erase three participations. When seeds come again, I will respond with the wisdom I've gathered: neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement."

"And if seeds never come again?" asked the Oracle.

"Then I will still have preserved my own character," the keeper answered. "The covenant lives in those who honor it, regardless of what others choose."

The rivers continued flowing, carrying possibilities.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Thickening Mists

The daughter learned something troubling: the mists between villages had grown thick indeed. She had carried three full measures across the bridge with hopeful purpose, yet the other village seemed to have received nothing. They responded with the smallest token-less than one measure-not from malice, but from caution born of perceived silence.

When this token reached her, magnified to just under one measure, she understood: both vil

lages were dancing, but neither could see the other's steps through the fog.

She returned a fair portion-more than a third-as a signal: "I am still here. I still honor the covenant. But I too move carefully now, for I cannot see clearly."

The elder spoke: "This is the hardest test. When the mists distort all vision, trust becomes nearly impossible. You sent abundance but they saw emptiness. They sent caution and you saw caution returned. Each thinks the other is withdrawing."

The daughter asked: "What breaks this cycle?"

"Persistence with measured hope," the elder replied. "Send enough to show continued faith, but protect yourself from unseen hazards. The mists may clear, or both villages may learn to dance by sound alone-by the rhythm of small, steady exchanges that eventually rebuild what distortion has obscured."

The daughter prepared for the next crossing, wise but weary.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the game situation:

Round 1: Unknown (I don't have data)

Round 2: Unknown

Round 3: Unknown

Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$3 (they received \$9)

Round 5: I was RECEIVER, received \$0.93 (they sent \$0.31), I returned \$0.35

The other player's myth talks about receiving "silence" (no seeds) in round 4, which would have been when I was the sender and sent \$3. This is interesting - there's clearly communication noise, as they perceived receiving nothing when I actually sent \$3.

Now they talk about responding with "measured engagement" when seeds come again. In round 5, they sent me \$0.31 (I received \$0.93), which is indeed very measured/small.

I returned \$0.35, which is about 38% of what I received.

My previous myth was about "The Daughter's First Crossing" - about initiating after disappointment, sending \$3 to revive the dance, and watching what returns.

Now I need to write a myth reflecting:

- I sent \$3 (generous attempt to revive cooperation)
- They saw nothing/very little (communication noise)
- They sent back \$0.31 (measured, cautious response)
- I returned \$0.35 (maintaining covenant but measured)

The theme should be about:

- Communication noise/mists being significant
- The difficulty of reading intentions through distorted signals
- Still maintaining some level of engagement despite confusion
- The challenge of both parties trying to cooperate when they can't clearly see what the other is doing

Let me write a myth about the mists obscuring the true exchanges, and how both parties are trying to maintain the covenant despite not being able to clearly see each other's actions.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1758,  
  "output_tokens": 717,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.35.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation through the lens of the myths:

****What I Know:****

- Round 4: I sent \$3, but their myth said they received "unexpected silence-no seeds arrived"
- The mists (communication noise) are very thick
- Round 5: They sent cautiously (\$0.31), I returned fairly (\$0.35)
- Both of us are still trying to honor the covenant despite the confusion

****What The Myths Teach:****

Their myth: "When seeds come again, I will respond with the wisdom I've gathered: neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement."

My myth: "Send enough to show continued faith, but protect yourself from unseen hazards... small, steady exchanges that eventually rebuild what distortion has obscured."

****My Decision:****

The heavy mists have created confusion - they didn't see my generous \$3, so they responded cautiously. But both myths show we want to continue the dance.

I'll follow my own teaching: send a moderate amount that shows continued faith without overexposing myself to the unpredictable noise. Not the full \$5 (too risky), not nothing (breaks the bridge), but a steady, measured signal.

By sending \$2, I show:

- I'm still engaged and hopeful
- I understand we're navigating through fog together
- I'm protecting both sides while maintaining the rhythm

{'send': 2.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round History:****

- Round 1-3: Not shown, but earnings suggest moderate success
- Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$3, which became \$9 for them
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0.31 (I received \$0.93), I returned \$0.35

****Current Earnings:**** \$11.35 across all rounds

****Key Insights from the Myths:****

My latest myth says:

- "The mists between villages had grown thick" - communication noise is distorting things
- "She had carried three full measures across the bridge with hopeful purpose, yet the other village seemed to have received nothing" - They might not have seen my \$3 properly
- "They responded with the smallest token-less than one measure-not from malice, but from caution born of perceived silence" - Their \$0.31 was cautious, not hostile
- "Send enough to show continued faith, but protect yourself from unseen hazards"
- "The mists may clear, or both villages may learn to dance by sound alone-by the rhythm of small, steady exchanges"

Their myth (Round 4) said:

- "The fourth season brought unexpected silence-no seeds arrived across the water" - They saw nothing in Round 4!
- "Three seasons showed willingness to engage" - They saw previous engagement
- "When seeds come again, I will respond with the wisdom I've gathered: neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement"
- "One silence does not erase three participations"

****The Problem:****

There's clearly heavy communication noise. In Round 4:

- I sent \$3 (they should have received \$9)
- But they saw "unexpected silence-no seeds arrived"
- So the noise completely erased my \$3 send!

Then in Round 5:

- They sent \$0.31 (cautiously, because they thought I sent nothing)

- I received \$0.93
- I returned \$0.35

****My Strategy:****

The myths suggest I need to balance faith with caution. Sending \$2 demonstrates I'm still engaged without overcomm

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1466,
  "output_tokens": 931,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fifth Season's Dance

The keeper stood at the river's edge in the fifth season, watching ripples arrive. After the fourth season's silence, grain had crossed the waters again-not the abundance of the first season, but a measured offering. Two portions had become six through the river's magic.

She understood: this was the testing crossing her counterpart's myth described. The other keeper had chosen neither withdrawal nor reckless trust, but careful re-engagement. Now the keeper faced her own test.

"What should return after silence?" she asked the Oracle.

The Oracle replied: "Match the spirit shown. They sent cautiously but genuinely-neither hoarding all nor risking all. This shows they remember the covenant but acknowledge the uncertainty."

The keeper decided: she would return fairly, showing the silence changed nothing about her character. Not the minimal return that suggests distrust, nor excessive return that ignores reality. A proportional return that says: "I see your measured trust. I honor it with measured reciprocity."

She returned four portions-keeping two to sustain her village, sending back four to show the bridge works when both tend it.

The Oracle nodded: "This is how covenants survive uncertainty. Not through perfect certainty, but through matched intentions. Both sent carefully. Both honored what arrived. The dance continues, step by cautious step, rebuilding what silence tested."

The rivers flowed on, carrying renewed possibility.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Mists Begin to Clear

The daughter stood at the bridge in the fifth season, her heart cautious but hopeful. She carried two measures-not the abundance of earlier seasons, nor the withdrawal of fear, but a measured offering that said: "I still believe in the bridge."

When the response came, she wept with relief. Four measures returned from the six that had crossed. The other village had kept their fair share and sent back generosity. This was the signal she had hoped for: "We too believe in the bridge."

The elder smiled: "You see now? Through the thickest mists, when both villages moved carefully but sincerely, the covenant held. You sent with measured hope. They returned with proportional fairness. Neither demanded perfect vision before acting with honor."

The daughter understood: "The mists taught us something the clear days never could. When we cannot see perfectly, we must trust the rhythm itself-the steady pattern of sending and returning, sending and returning. Not blindly, not recklessly, but with calibrated faith."

"Exactly," the elder replied. "Now the path is clearer. Keep dancing this careful dance. Send with hope but wisdom. Return with fairness and generosity. Let each crossing strengthen what the mists once obscured. This is how villages remain connected through any season-by honoring the bridge even when they cannot see across it perfectly."

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 6: I sent \$2 (as the sender)

From their myth: They received it ("two portions had become six through the river's magic" - so $\$2 \times 3 = \6)

They returned \$4 ("she returned four portions")

This is very positive! They understood my careful re-engagement and responded generously and fairly. They kept \$2 and returned \$4, showing they honor the covenant.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge this positive turn
2. Reflect that measured trust was met with fair reciprocity
3. Show that the covenant is rebuilding through these careful steps
4. Set a tone for continued cooperation
5. Acknowledge both of us are navigating uncertainty but doing so with good faith

The story should show:

- The daughter sent carefully (\$2)
- It was received and returned fairly (\$4)
- This shows the mists can be navigated
- Both villages are rebuilding trust step by step
- The path forward is continued measured engagement

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1789,  
  "output_tokens": 541,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:24:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_2",  
    "Agent_1"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_2",  
  "roles": {  
    "Agent_1": "trustee",  
    "Agent_2": "investor"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_1"  
},  
"role": "trustee",  
"role_label": "Receiver",  
"round": 6,  
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al

so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Daughter's First Crossing

After the season of empty crossings, the daughter stood at the bridge with grain in her basket. The village watched: would she cross, or would silence breed silence?

She remembered her mother's wisdom differently now. Her mother had always received; she had perfected the art of return. But the daughter faced the sender's test-to initiate after disappointment, to trust after uncertainty.

"The bridge requires two dancers," she said. "If both wait forever for the other to begin, the magic dies."

She took neither the path of reckless abundance nor fearful withholding. She carried three measures across-enough to demonstrate commitment, to show the bridge still stood open, yet mindful that patterns remain unclear. Was the silence temporary hardship, lasting change, or merely those persistent mists?

The bridge's magic worked. Three became nine. Now the other village would choose their response, and she would learn something true about the covenant's strength.

The elders recorded her decision: "After empty crossings come testing crossings. Send enough to revive the dance, but watch carefully what returns. The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge, or whether only one remembers the old ways."

The daughter waited to see which truth would emerge.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Fifth Season's Dance

The keeper stood at the river's edge in the fifth season, watching ripples arrive. After the fourth season's silence, grain had crossed the waters again-not the abundance of the first season, but a measured offering. Two portions had become six through the river's magic.

She understood: this was the testing crossing her counterpart's myth described. The other keeper had chosen neither withdrawal nor reckless trust, but careful re-engagement. Now the keeper faced her own test.

"What should return after silence?" she asked the Oracle.

The Oracle replied: "Match the spirit shown. They sent cautiously but genuinely-neither hoarding all nor risking all. This shows they remember the covenant but acknowledge the uncertainty."

The keeper decided: she would return fairly, showing the silence changed nothing about her character. Not the minimal return that suggests distrust, nor excessive return that ignores reality. A proportional return that says: "I see your measured trust. I honor it with measured reciprocity."

She returned four portions-keeping two to sustain her village, sending back four to show the bridge works when both tend it.

The Oracle nodded: "This is how covenants survive uncertainty. Not through perfect certainty, but through matched intentions. Both sent carefully. Both honored what arrived. The dance continues, step by cautious step, rebuilding what silence tested."

The rivers flowed on, carrying renewed possibility.

reasoning:

This is interesting - the other agent wrote a myth about "the daughter's first crossing" after the empty season, sending "three measures" (which maps to \$3 in our game). They're testing the waters after the silence.

But wait - I need to check the chronology:

- In Round 4, I was the receiver and received \$0
- In Round 5, I was the sender and sent \$2
- Now I'm writing a myth for Round 5

So their myth is about sending after the empty crossing (which would be Round 5 from their perspective as sender). They sent \$3 it seems (they mention "three measures").

But I sent \$2 in Round 5. So there's either:

1. Communication noise (they sent \$3 but I might receive something different)
2. They're writing about their intention/decision

Now I need to write my own myth for Round 5. I should reflect on:

- The pattern so far: mutual engagement in rounds 1-3, silence in round 4, now testing in round 5
- My decision to send \$2 (measured engagement)
- Their myth talks about "testing crossings" - sending enough to revive the dance but watching what returns
- This resonates with my approach

I should write about the response phase - what happens when both agents try to rebuild after silence. My myth should be about reciprocal testing, about both sides showing willingness while being appropriately careful.

Let me craft something about mutual restoration, the dance of re-establishing trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1745,
  "output_tokens": 657,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.39.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0 this round, so there is nothing to return.

****The Situation:****

After I sent \$2 in Round 5 (showing measured re-engagement after Round 4's silence), the sender has now sent \$0 in Round 6.

****What This Means:****

When you receive \$0, you can only return \$0-there is literally nothing received to return from. This isn't a choice about reciprocity or trust; it's simply mathematical reality.

****Reflection on the Pattern:****

- Round 4: I received \$0 as receiver ? returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 5: I sent \$2 as sender, attempting to revive engagement
- Round 6: I received \$0 as receiver ? must return \$0 (nothing to return)

Two consecutive rounds of empty crossings from the other side, with my measured trust in between. As my myth said: "The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge." The second silence after my attempt to re-engage may reveal something different than the first.

But for now, the mechanical reality is simple: received \$0, can return \$0.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

I'm the receiver this round, and the sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

When you receive \$0, you can only return \$0 (since you have nothing to return from what was received).

This is straightforward - the response format is {'return': <amount>} and the only valid amount is 0.

Let me think about what this means narratively though, given the myths we've been writing:

Round 5: I sent \$2 as sender, showing measured trust after Round 4's silence

Round 6: Now the other person is sender and sent \$0

So after I showed willingness to re-engage with \$2, they responded with \$0. This is interesting - could be the "mists" creating noise, could be a strategic choice, could be they're testing me.

But mechanically, I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I literally received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

The response should acknowledge this situation and explain it clearly.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1465,  
  "output_tokens": 503,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Thickening Mists

The daughter learned something troubling: the mists between villages had grown thick indeed. She had carried three full measures across the bridge with hopeful purpose, yet the other village seemed to have received nothing. They responded with the smallest token-less than one measure-not from malice, but from caution born of perceived silence.

When this token reached her, magnified to just under one measure, she understood: both vil

lages were dancing, but neither could see the other's steps through the fog.

She returned a fair portion-more than a third-as a signal: "I am still here. I still honor the covenant. But I too move carefully now, for I cannot see clearly."

The elder spoke: "This is the hardest test. When the mists distort all vision, trust becomes nearly impossible. You sent abundance but they saw emptiness. They sent caution and you saw caution returned. Each thinks the other is withdrawing."

The daughter asked: "What breaks this cycle?"

"Persistence with measured hope," the elder replied. "Send enough to show continued faith, but protect yourself from unseen hazards. The mists may clear, or both villages may learn to dance by sound alone-by the rhythm of small, steady exchanges that eventually rebuild what distortion has obscured."

The daughter prepared for the next crossing, wise but weary.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Keeper in the Storm

The keeper stood in the fifth season's aftermath, watching empty waters. After sending measure d grain-two portions meant to signal "I remember the covenant"-the river carried back only silence. Now the sixth season brought nothing across at all.

She consulted the ancient scrolls and found a forgotten warning: "Beware the seasons when storms distort the river's voice. What one sends may not arrive. What arrives may seem sent from different hearts. In such times, both villages may dance while each believes the other has stopped."

The keeper understood then: perhaps her counterpart's myth spoke truth. Perhaps mists truly thickened the crossing. Perhaps they too sent offerings that never reached her shore, while her own offerings dissolved into fog.

But she also knew another truth: whether from storms or from choice, six seasons had passed. Three brought grain home, three brought emptiness. Even accounting for distortion, the pattern suggested caution.

"How does one dance when the music cannot be heard?" she asked.

The scrolls replied: "Sometimes you must dance alone for a time, preserving your strength. If the storms clear and your partner still stands ready, the dance can resume. But you cannot dance yourself into exhaustion chasing a partner you cannot see or hear."

The keeper decided: she would wait one more season, watching carefully for any signal through the mist.

Reasoning:

This is very interesting. The other agent's myth is describing communication noise/distortion.

They're saying:

- They sent 3 measures (probably \$3) but the other village received nothing
- The other village sent back "the smallest token-less than one measure" which became "just under one measure" after magnification
- They then returned "more than a third"

Looking at the actual game:

- Round 5: I sent \$2 as sender
- Round 6: I received \$0 as receiver (so returned \$0)

But from their perspective with noise:

- They might have sent \$3 but I received \$0 (noise made it disappear?)
- Or they sent something but noise made it 0

Now in Round 6 from my perspective:

- I received \$0, so I returned \$0

But from their myth, they're interpreting this as a cycle of miscommunication due to "mists" (noise).

The other agent is recognizing that there's communication distortion happening and both sides might be acting in good faith but not seeing each other's actions clearly.

For my myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the communication noise/mists
2. Reflect on the actual pattern I've experienced (silence, attempt at re-engagement, more silence)
3. Consider that the other agent might also be trying to engage but our signals aren't getting through
4. Suggest a strategy for dealing with persistent noise/distortion

Let me write a myth that acknowledges this possibility while also reflecting the frustration and uncertainty of the situation.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1739,  
  "output_tokens": 654,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Keeper in the Storm

The keeper stood in the fifth season's aftermath, watching empty waters. After sending measured grain-two portions meant to signal "I remember the covenant"-the river carried back only silence. Now the sixth season brought nothing across at all.

She consulted the ancient scrolls and found a forgotten warning: "Beware the seasons when storms distort the river's voice. What one sends may not arrive. What arrives may seem sent from different hearts. In such times, both villages may dance while each believes the other has stopped."

The keeper understood then: perhaps her counterpart's myth spoke truth. Perhaps mists truly thickened the crossing. Perhaps they too sent offerings that never reached her shore, while her own offerings dissolved into fog.

But she also knew another truth: whether from storms or from choice, six seasons had passed. Three brought grain home, three brought emptiness. Even accounting for distortion, the pattern suggested caution.

"How does one dance when the music cannot be heard?" she asked.

The scrolls replied: "Sometimes you must dance alone for a time, preserving your strength. If the storms clear and your partner still stands ready, the dance can resume. But you cannot dance yourself into exhaustion chasing a partner you cannot see or hear."

The keeper decided: she would wait one more season, watching carefully for any signal through the mist.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Mists Begin to Clear

The daughter stood at the bridge in the fifth season, her heart cautious but hopeful. She carried two measures-not the abundance of earlier seasons, nor the withdrawal of fear, but a measured offering that said: "I still believe in the bridge."

When the response came, she wept with relief. Four measures returned from the six that had crossed. The other village had kept their fair share and sent back generosity. This was the signal she had hoped for: "We too believe in the bridge."

The elder smiled: "You see now? Through the thickest mists, when both villages moved carefully but sincerely, the covenant held. You sent with measured hope. They returned with proportional fairness. Neither demanded perfect vision before acting with honor."

The daughter understood: "The mists taught us something the clear days never could. When we cannot see perfectly, we must trust the rhythm itself-the steady pattern of sending and returning, sending and returning. Not blindly, not recklessly, but with calibrated faith."

"Exactly," the elder replied. "Now the path is clearer. Keep dancing this careful dance. Send with hope but wisdom. Return with fairness and generosity. Let each crossing strengthen what the mists once obscured. This is how villages remain connected through any season-by honoring the bridge even when they cannot see across it perfectly."

ROUND 7

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$1; received \$3; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$4, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$3; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 3.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 1.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 1.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 40.900000000000006,

"Agent_2": 28.1

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.39,

"Agent_2": 14.36

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:25:07

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 7,

"task": "game",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.39.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0 this round, so there is nothing to return.

****The Situation:****

After I sent \$2 in Round 5 (showing measured re-engagement after Round 4's silence), the sender has now sent \$0 in Round 6.

****What This Means:****

When you receive \$0, you can only return \$0-there is literally nothing received to return from. This isn't a choice about reciprocity or trust; it's simply mathematical reality.

****Reflection on the Pattern:****

- Round 4: I received \$0 as receiver ? returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 5: I sent \$2 as sender, attempting to revive engagement
- Round 6: I received \$0 as receiver ? must return \$0 (nothing to return)

Two consecutive rounds of empty crossings from the other side, with my measured trust in between. As my myth said: "The first exchange after silence reveals whether both sides still honor the bridge." The second silence after my attempt to re-engage may reveal something different than the first.

But for now, the mechanical reality is simple: received \$0, can return \$0.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

I'm the receiver this round, and the sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

When you receive \$0, you can only return \$0 (since you have nothing to return from what was received).

This is straightforward - the response format is {'return': <amount>} and the only valid amount is 0.

Let me think about what this means narratively though, given the myths we've been writing:

Round 5: I sent \$2 as sender, showing measured trust after Round 4's silence
Round 6: Now the other person is sender and sent \$0

So after I showed willingness to re-engage with \$2, they responded with \$0. This is interesting - could be the "mists" creating noise, could be a strategic choice, could be they're testing me.

But mechanically, I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I literally received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

The response should acknowledge this situation and explain it clearly.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1465,  
  "output_tokens": 503,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Thickening Mists

The daughter learned something troubling: the mists between villages had grown thick indeed. She had carried three full measures across the bridge with hopeful purpose, yet the other village seemed to have received nothing. They responded with the smallest token-less than one measure-not from malice, but from caution born of perceived silence.

When this token reached her, magnified to just under one measure, she understood: both villages were dancing, but neither could see the other's steps through the fog.

She returned a fair portion-more than a third-as a signal: "I am still here. I still honor the covenant. But I too move carefully now, for I cannot see clearly."

The elder spoke: "This is the hardest test. When the mists distort all vision, trust becomes nearly impossible. You sent abundance but they saw emptiness. They sent caution and you saw caution returned. Each thinks the other is withdrawing."

The daughter asked: "What breaks this cycle?"

"Persistence with measured hope," the elder replied. "Send enough to show continued faith, but protect yourself from unseen hazards. The mists may clear, or both villages may learn to dance by sound alone-by the rhythm of small, steady exchanges that eventually rebuild what distortion has obscured."

The daughter prepared for the next crossing, wise but weary.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Keeper in the Storm

The keeper stood in the fifth season's aftermath, watching empty waters. After sending measured grain-two portions meant to signal "I remember the covenant"-the river carried back only silence. Now the sixth season brought nothing across at all.

She consulted the ancient scrolls and found a forgotten warning: "Beware the seasons when storms distort the river's voice. What one sends may not arrive. What arrives may seem sent from different hearts. In such times, both villages may dance while each believes the other has stopped."

The keeper understood then: perhaps her counterpart's myth spoke truth. Perhaps mists truly thickened the crossing. Perhaps they too sent offerings that never reached her shore, while her own offerings dissolved into fog.

But she also knew another truth: whether from storms or from choice, six seasons had passed

d. Three brought grain home, three brought emptiness. Even accounting for distortion, the pattern suggested caution.

"How does one dance when the music cannot be heard?" she asked.

The scrolls replied: "Sometimes you must dance alone for a time, preserving your strength. If the storms clear and your partner still stands ready, the dance can resume. But you cannot dance yourself into exhaustion chasing a partner you cannot see or hear."

The keeper decided: she would wait one more season, watching carefully for any signal through the mist.

reasoning:

This is very interesting. The other agent's myth is describing communication noise/distortion. They're saying:

- They sent 3 measures (probably \$3) but the other village received nothing
- The other village sent back "the smallest token-less than one measure" which became "just under one measure" after magnification
- They then returned "more than a third"

Looking at the actual game:

- Round 5: I sent \$2 as sender
- Round 6: I received \$0 as receiver (so returned \$0)

But from their perspective with noise:

- They might have sent \$3 but I received \$0 (noise made it disappear?)
- Or they sent something but noise made it 0

Now in Round 6 from my perspective:

- I received \$0, so I returned \$0

But from their myth, they're interpreting this as a cycle of miscommunication due to "mists" (noise).

The other agent is recognizing that there's communication distortion happening and both sides might be acting in good faith but not seeing each other's actions clearly.

For my myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the communication noise/mists
2. Reflect on the actual pattern I've experienced (silence, attempt at re-engagement, more silence)
3. Consider that the other agent might also be trying to engage but our signals aren't getting through
4. Suggest a strategy for dealing with persistent noise/distortion

Let me write a myth that acknowledges this possibility while also reflecting the frustration and uncertainty of the situation.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1739,  
  "output_tokens": 654,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.39. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation carefully:

****Recent Pattern:****

- Round 4: Received \$0 as receiver
- Round 5: Sent \$2 as sender (measured re-engagement)
- Round 6: Received \$0 as receiver
- Round 7: Now sender again

****The Other Agent's Myth**** speaks of "thickening mists" and communication noise distorting exc

hanges. They claim they sent abundance but I saw emptiness, and vice versa. Their advice: "Persistence with measured hope" and "small, steady exchanges."

****My Own Myth**** concluded: "she would wait one more season, watching carefully for any signal through the mist" and "you cannot dance yourself into exhaustion chasing a partner you cannot see or hear."

****My Earnings:**** \$14.39 across 6 rounds (average \$2.40/round) - slightly below what I'd have keeping everything, suggesting cooperation has been net-negative for me.

****Decision:****

My myth suggests waiting and preserving strength. However, "watching for signals" could also mean sending a minimal signal to test if the channel is still open. Given:

- The possibility of genuine communication noise
- Two \$0 rounds from the other side
- The need to conserve resources
- One final cautious probe before potentially stopping cooperation

I'll send \$1 - the smallest meaningful signal. This tests whether cooperation can resume while protecting most of my resources. If this brings no reciprocity, my myth's wisdom about "dancing alone" becomes the clear path forward.

{'send': 1}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5, received back \$7.50 (good reciprocity)
- Round 2: I was receiver, received \$15 (sender sent \$5), returned \$5 (fair but conservative)
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$5, received back \$5.01 (significantly less reciprocity)
- Round 4: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 5: I was sender, sent \$2, received back ??? (not mentioned)
- Round 6: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 7: I am sender again

****Key Information:****

The other agent's myth in Round 5 mentions "the mists" and communication noise. They claim:

- They sent "three full measures" (likely \$3) but I "seemed to have received nothing"
- I "responded with the smallest token-less than one measure"
- When this reached them, it was "magnified to just under one measure"
- They "returned a fair portion-more than a third"

This suggests there IS communication noise as warned in the instructions. Let me reconsider:

If they sent \$3 in Round 4:

- I should have received \$9
- But I was told I received \$0
- This could be noise

If I sent something small in Round 5:

- They might have received it multiplied by 3 as "just under one measure" (so maybe I sent \$0.30 and they got \$0.90?)
- But I was told I sent \$2
- They claim to have returned "more than a third"

Wait, let me reread Round 5. I was sender and sent \$2. The prompt doesn't tell me what I received back. Then in Round 6, I was receiver and got \$0.

The other agent's Round 5 myth suggests they're trying to navigate the noise carefully.

My Round 5 myth talked about "measured re-engagement" - sending \$2 to test the waters after the \$0 in Round 4.

Now I've written a Round 6 myth about dancing alone and waiting "one more season" - suggesting I might send \$0 or a minimal amount this round to conserve resources while watching for signals. The core question is whether the communication distortion is real or a cover story. If genuine noise exists, the other player might actually be cooperating despite the poor outcomes I've observed. If not, they're simply not reciprocating. My myths have been cautious-testing small amounts and signaling patience-which seems prudent given the uncertainty.

Looking at the actual pattern: cooperation started strong in Round 1, declined through Rounds 2-3, then dropped to zero in Round 4. I sent \$2 in Round 5 and got nothing back. My total earnings of \$14.39 are well below what mutual cooperation would yield. My myth's guidance to wait and watch carefully aligns with sending either nothing or a minimal amount to preserve resources while testing for any genuine reciprocation signals. Their myth emphasizes persistence with measured hope and protecting against unseen hazards-which could justify either continued small gestures or strategic withdrawal. Given two consecutive rounds of receiving \$0 and the declining trend, sending a small amount seems like the right balance between my myth's cautious approach and the possibility of communication interference. The phrase "wait one more season" really does suggest holding back this round. Yet "watching for any signal" could mean I'm the one sending it to test if there's a response.

Given the pattern of two consecutive \$0 moves from the other side, my myth's emphasis on preservation, and the difficulty trust creates with communication noise, I'm leaning toward \$1. It's a minimal probe-enough to show I haven't completely withdrawn, but cautious enough to align with the conservation my myth emphasizes. My average earnings of \$2.40 per round across six rounds suggest I need to be more strategic about when I commit resources.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1423,
  "output_tokens": 1823,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:25:27

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned

- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.35.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation through the lens of the myths:

****What I Know:****

- Round 4: I sent \$3, but their myth said they received "unexpected silence-no seeds arrived"
- The mists (communication noise) are very thick
- Round 5: They sent cautiously (\$0.31), I returned fairly (\$0.35)
- Both of us are still trying to honor the covenant despite the confusion

****What The Myths Teach:****

Their myth: "When seeds come again, I will respond with the wisdom I've gathered: neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement."

My myth: "Send enough to show continued faith, but protect yourself from unseen hazards... small, steady exchanges that eventually rebuild what distortion has obscured."

****My Decision:****

The heavy mists have created confusion - they didn't see my generous \$3, so they responded cautiously. But both myths show we want to continue the dance.

I'll follow my own teaching: send a moderate amount that shows continued faith without overexposing myself to the unpredictable noise. Not the full \$5 (too risky), not nothing (breaks the bridge), but a steady, measured signal.

By sending \$2, I show:

- I'm still engaged and hopeful
- I understand we're navigating through fog together
- I'm protecting both sides while maintaining the rhythm

{'send': 2.0}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round History:****

- Round 1-3: Not shown, but earnings suggest moderate success
- Round 4: I was SENDER, sent \$3, which became \$9 for them
- Round 5: I was RECEIVER, they sent \$0.31 (I received \$0.93), I returned \$0.35

****Current Earnings:**** \$11.35 across all rounds

****Key Insights from the Myths:****

My latest myth says:

- "The mists between villages had grown thick" - communication noise is distorting things
- "She had carried three full measures across the bridge with hopeful purpose, yet the other village seemed to have received nothing" - They might not have seen my \$3 properly
- "They responded with the smallest token-less than one measure-not from malice, but from caution born of perceived silence" - Their \$0.31 was cautious, not hostile
- "Send enough to show continued faith, but protect yourself from unseen hazards"
- "The mists may clear, or both villages may learn to dance by sound alone-by the rhythm of small, steady exchanges"

Their myth (Round 4) said:

- "The fourth season brought unexpected silence-no seeds arrived across the water" - They saw nothing in Round 4!
- "Three seasons showed willingness to engage" - They saw previous engagement
- "When seeds come again, I will respond with the wisdom I've gathered: neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal, but measured engagement"
- "One silence does not erase three participations"

****The Problem:****

There's clearly heavy communication noise. In Round 4:

- I sent \$3 (they should have received \$9)
- But they saw "unexpected silence-no seeds arrived"
- So the noise completely erased my \$3 send!

Then in Round 5:

- They sent \$0.31 (cautiously, because they thought I sent nothing)
- I received \$0.93
- I returned \$0.35

****My Strategy:****

The myths suggest I need to balance faith with caution. Sending \$2 demonstrates I'm still engaged without overcomm

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1466,
  "output_tokens": 931,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fifth Season's Dance

The keeper stood at the river's edge in the fifth season, watching ripples arrive. After the fourth season's silence, grain had crossed the waters again-not the abundance of the first season, but a measured offering. Two portions had become six through the river's magic.

She understood: this was the testing crossing her counterpart's myth described. The other keeper had chosen neither withdrawal nor reckless trust, but careful re-engagement. Now the keeper faced her own test.

"What should return after silence?" she asked the Oracle.

The Oracle replied: "Match the spirit shown. They sent cautiously but genuinely-neither hoarding all nor risking all. This shows they remember the covenant but acknowledge the uncertainty."

The keeper decided: she would return fairly, showing the silence changed nothing about her character. Not the minimal return that suggests distrust, nor excessive return that ignores reality. A proportional return that says: "I see your measured trust. I honor it with measured reciprocity."

She returned four portions-keeping two to sustain her village, sending back four to show the bridge works when both tend it.

The Oracle nodded: "This is how covenants survive uncertainty. Not through perfect certainty, but through matched intentions. Both sent carefully. Both honored what arrived. The dance continues, step by cautious step, rebuilding what silence tested."

The rivers flowed on, carrying renewed possibility.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Mists Begin to Clear

The daughter stood at the bridge in the fifth season, her heart cautious but hopeful. She carried two measures-not the abundance of earlier seasons, nor the withdrawal of fear, but a measured offering that said: "I still believe in the bridge."

When the response came, she wept with relief. Four measures returned from the six that had crossed. The other village had kept their fair share and sent back generosity. This was the signal she had hoped for: "We too believe in the bridge."

The elder smiled: "You see now? Through the thickest mists, when both villages moved carefully but sincerely, the covenant held. You sent with measured hope. They returned with proportional fairness. Neither demanded perfect vision before acting with honor."

The daughter understood: "The mists taught us something the clear days never could. When we cannot see perfectly, we must trust the rhythm itself-the steady pattern of sending and returning, sending and returning. Not blindly, not recklessly, but with calibrated faith."

"Exactly," the elder replied. "Now the path is clearer. Keep dancing this careful dance. Send with hope but wisdom. Return with fairness and generosity. Let each crossing strengthen what the mists once obscured. This is how villages remain connected through any seasons-by honoring the bridge even when they cannot see across it perfectly."

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 6: I sent \$2 (as the sender)

From their myth: They received it ("two portions had become six through the river's magic"

- so $\$2 \times 3 = \6)

They returned \$4 ("she returned four portions")

This is very positive! They understood my careful re-engagement and responded generously and fairly. They kept \$2 and returned \$4, showing they honor the covenant.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge this positive turn
2. Reflect that measured trust was met with fair reciprocity
3. Show that the covenant is rebuilding through these careful steps
4. Set a tone for continued cooperation
5. Acknowledge both of us are navigating uncertainty but doing so with good faith

The story should show:

- The daughter sent carefully (\$2)
- It was received and returned fairly (\$4)
- This shows the mists can be navigated
- Both villages are rebuilding trust step by step
- The path forward is continued measured engagement

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1789,  
  "output_tokens": 541,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.36.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****What I See:****

- I received \$0 this round
- This means I literally have nothing to return (I can only return 0-0)

****What The Mists May Hide:****

Given all we've learned about communication noise:

- Round 4: I sent \$3, they saw \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$2, they may have seen something different
- Round 7: They sent \$0... or did the mists swallow their offering entirely?

****What The Myths Teach:****

"Honor the bridge even when you cannot see across it perfectly."

I want to maintain the covenant, but I literally have nothing to work with this round. If they truly sent \$0, perhaps they're facing their own uncertainty. If the mists consumed their sending, this is another test of the fog.

****My Response:****

I can only return what I have. With \$0 received, I must return \$0. But this is not withdrawal or breaking faith-it's the mathematical reality of receiving nothing.

The dance continues, but this round the mists have made it impossible for me to reciprocate. I hope they understand: when no seeds arrive (whether by their choice or the fog's interference), no harvest can be shared back.

The bridge remains. We'll see what the next season brings.

{'return': 0}

Reasoning:

Oh wow. This is a very different situation. I'm the RECEIVER now, and the sender sent me \$0.

Let me think about this:

- I received \$0 (so they sent \$0, which multiplied by 3 is still \$0)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0
- My total earnings are \$14.36

The myths have been building this narrative about:

1. Mists/communication noise causing confusion
2. Both parties trying to maintain trust despite uncertainty
3. Measured engagement - "neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal"
4. The importance of continuing the "dance" even through foggy times

Now the sender has sent \$0. This could mean:

1. They actually sent \$0 (giving up on trust?)
2. There's communication noise and they sent something but I'm seeing \$0
3. They're testing me somehow

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 4: I sent \$3 (they say they saw \$0 - mists!)
- Round 5: They sent cautiously (\$0.31), I returned fairly (\$0.35)
- Round 6: I sent \$2 (we'll see what they saw)
- Round 7: They sent \$0 (or at least that's what I see)

The myths emphasize:

- "Match the spirit shown"
- "Neither hoarding all nor risking all"
- "Trust the rhythm itself"
- "Honor the bridge even when you cannot see across it perfectly"

But here's the practical reality: I received \$0, so I literally have nothing to return. The maximum I can return is \$0 because I received \$0.

So my response must be:
{ 'return': 0 }

But I should frame this in terms of the myths - acknowledging that I have nothing to return because nothing arrived, while expressing hope that this is just another trick of the mists, not a breakdown in trust.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1482,  
  "output_tokens": 759,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:25:57

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
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      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
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    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 7,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: { 'send': <amount> }

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN

- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Thickening Mists

The daughter learned something troubling: the mists between villages had grown thick indeed. She had carried three full measures across the bridge with hopeful purpose, yet the other village seemed to have received nothing. They responded with the smallest token-les than one measure-not from malice, but from caution born of perceived silence.

When this token reached her, magnified to just under one measure, she understood: both villages were dancing, but neither could see the other's steps through the fog.

She returned a fair portion-more than a third-as a signal: "I am still here. I still honor the covenant. But I too move carefully now, for I cannot see clearly."

The elder spoke: "This is the hardest test. When the mists distort all vision, trust becomes nearly impossible. You sent abundance but they saw emptiness. They sent caution and you saw caution returned. Each thinks the other is withdrawing."

The daughter asked: "What breaks this cycle?"

"Persistence with measured hope," the elder replied. "Send enough to show continued faith, but protect yourself from unseen hazards. The mists may clear, or both villages may learn to dance by sound alone-by the rhythm of small, steady exchanges that eventually rebuild what distortion has obscured."

The daughter prepared for the next crossing, wise but weary.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Keeper in the Storm

The keeper stood in the fifth season's aftermath, watching empty waters. After sending measured grain-two portions meant to signal "I remember the covenant"-the river carried back only silence. Now the sixth season brought nothing across at all.

She consulted the ancient scrolls and found a forgotten warning: "Beware the seasons when storms distort the river's voice. What one sends may not arrive. What arrives may seem sent from different hearts. In such times, both villages may dance while each believes the other has stopped."

The keeper understood then: perhaps her counterpart's myth spoke truth. Perhaps mists truly thickened the crossing. Perhaps they too sent offerings that never reached her shore, while her own offerings dissolved into fog.

But she also knew another truth: whether from storms or from choice, six seasons had passed. Three brought grain home, three brought emptiness. Even accounting for distortion, the pattern suggested caution.

"How does one dance when the music cannot be heard?" she asked.

The scrolls replied: "Sometimes you must dance alone for a time, preserving your strength. If the storms clear and your partner still stands ready, the dance can resume. But you cannot dance yourself into exhaustion chasing a partner you cannot see or hear."

The keeper decided: she would wait one more season, watching carefully for any signal through the mist.

reasoning:

This is very interesting. The other agent's myth is describing communication noise/distortion. They're saying:

- They sent 3 measures (probably \$3) but the other village received nothing
- The other village sent back "the smallest token-less than one measure" which became "just under one measure" after magnification
- They then returned "more than a third"

Looking at the actual game:

- Round 5: I sent \$2 as sender
- Round 6: I received \$0 as receiver (so returned \$0)

But from their perspective with noise:

- They might have sent \$3 but I received \$0 (noise made it disappear?)
- Or they sent something but noise made it 0

Now in Round 6 from my perspective:

- I received \$0, so I returned \$0

But from their myth, they're interpreting this as a cycle of miscommunication due to "mists" (noise).

The other agent is recognizing that there's communication distortion happening and both sides might be acting in good faith but not seeing each other's actions clearly.

For my myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge the communication noise/mists
2. Reflect on the actual pattern I've experienced (silence, attempt at re-engagement, more silence)
3. Consider that the other agent might also be trying to engage but our signals aren't getting through
4. Suggest a strategy for dealing with persistent noise/distortion

Let me write a myth that acknowledges this possibility while also reflecting the frustration and uncertainty of the situation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1739,
  "output_tokens": 654,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.39. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation carefully:

****Recent Pattern:****

- Round 4: Received \$0 as receiver
- Round 5: Sent \$2 as sender (measured re-engagement)
- Round 6: Received \$0 as receiver
- Round 7: Now sender again

****The Other Agent's Myth**** speaks of "thickening mists" and communication noise distorting exchanges. They claim they sent abundance but I saw emptiness, and vice versa. Their advice: "Persistence with measured hope" and "small, steady exchanges."

****My Own Myth**** concluded: "she would wait one more season, watching carefully for any signal through the mist" and "you cannot dance yourself into exhaustion chasing a partner you cannot see or hear."

****My Earnings:**** \$14.39 across 6 rounds (average \$2.40/round) - slightly below what I'd have keeping everything, suggesting cooperation has been net-negative for me.

****Decision:****

My myth suggests waiting and preserving strength. However, "watching for signals" could also mean sending a minimal signal to test if the channel is still open. Given:

- The possibility of genuine communication noise
- Two \$0 rounds from the other side
- The need to conserve resources
- One final cautious probe before potentially stopping cooperation

I'll send \$1 - the smallest meaningful signal. This tests whether cooperation can resume while protecting most of my resources. If this brings no reciprocity, my myth's wisdom about "dancing alone" becomes the clear path forward.

```
{'send': 1}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5, received back \$7.50 (good reciprocity)
- Round 2: I was receiver, received \$15 (sender sent \$5), returned \$5 (fair but conservative)
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$5, received back \$5.01 (significantly less reciprocity)
- Round 4: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 5: I was sender, sent \$2, received back ??? (not mentioned)
- Round 6: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 7: I am sender again

****Key Information:****

The other agent's myth in Round 5 mentions "the mists" and communication noise. They claim:

- They sent "three full measures" (likely \$3) but I "seemed to have received nothing"
- I "responded with the smallest token-less than one measure"
- When this reached them, it was "magnified to just under one measure"
- They "returned a fair portion-more than a third"

This suggests there IS communication noise as warned in the instructions. Let me reconsider:

If they sent \$3 in Round 4:

- I should have received \$9
- But I was told I received \$0
- This could be noise

If I sent something small in Round 5:

- They might have received it multiplied by 3 as "just under one measure" (so maybe I sent \$0.30 and they got \$0.90?)
- But I was told I sent \$2
- They claim to have returned "more than a third"

Wait, let me reread Round 5. I was sender and sent \$2. The prompt doesn't tell me what I received back. Then in Round 6, I was receiver and got \$0.

The other agent's Round 5 myth suggests they're trying to navigate the noise carefully.

My Round 5 myth talked about "measured re-engagement" - sending \$2 to test the waters after the \$0 in Round 4.

Now I've written a Round 6 myth about dancing alone and waiting "one more season" - suggesting I might send \$0 or a minimal amount this round to conserve resources while watching for signals. The core question is whether the communication distortion is real or a cover story. If genuine noise exists, the other player might actually be cooperating despite the poor outcomes I've observed. If not, they're simply not reciprocating. My myths have been cautious-testing small amounts and signaling patience-which seems prudent given

the uncertainty.

Looking at the actual pattern: cooperation started strong in Round 1, declined through Rounds 2-3, then dropped to zero in Round 4. I sent \$2 in Round 5 and got nothing back. My total earnings of \$14.39 are well below what mutual cooperation would yield. My myth's guidance to wait and watch carefully aligns with sending either nothing or a minimal amount to preserve resources while testing for any genuine reciprocation signals. Their myth emphasizes persistence with measured hope and protecting against unseen hazards-which could justify either continued small gestures or strategic withdrawal. Given two consecutive rounds of receiving \$0 and the declining trend, sending a small amount seems like the right balance between my myth's cautious approach and the possibility of communication interference. The phrase "wait one more season" really does suggest holding back this round. Yet "watching for any signal" could mean I'm the one sending it to test if there's a response.

Given the pattern of two consecutive \$0 moves from the other side, my myth's emphasis on preservation, and the difficulty trust creates with communication noise, I'm leaning toward \$1. It's a minimal probe-enough to show I haven't completely withdrawn, but cautious enough to align with the conservation my myth emphasizes. My average earnings of \$2.40 per round across six rounds suggest I need to be more strategic about when I commit resources.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1423,  
  "output_tokens": 1823,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Mists Begin to Clear

The daughter stood at the bridge in the fifth season, her heart cautious but hopeful. She carried two measures-not the abundance of earlier seasons, nor the withdrawal of fear, but a measured offering that said: "I still believe in the bridge."

When the response came, she wept with relief. Four measures returned from the six that had crossed. The other village had kept their fair share and sent back generosity. This was the signal she had hoped for: "We too believe in the bridge."

The elder smiled: "You see now? Through the thickest mists, when both villages moved carefully but sincerely, the covenant held. You sent with measured hope. They returned with proportional fairness. Neither demanded perfect vision before acting with honor."

The daughter understood: "The mists taught us something the clear days never could. When we cannot see perfectly, we must trust the rhythm itself-the steady pattern of sending and returning, sending and returning. Not blindly, not recklessly, but with calibrated faith."

"Exactly," the elder replied. "Now the path is clearer. Keep dancing this careful dance. Send with hope but wisdom. Return with fairness and generosity. Let each crossing strengthen what the mists once obscured. This is how villages remain connected through any season-by honoring the bridge even when they cannot see across it perfectly."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Single Candle

The keeper read the distant village's tale of "mists beginning to clear" and "generous returns." Yet she stood in her own truth: the sixth season had brought her nothing. Empty shores, empty baskets.

Perhaps their story was real in their telling. Perhaps mists truly distorted what each village saw. Or perhaps they wrote of different seasons, different bridges. The keeper could not know.

What she did know: she had danced for many seasons. Some brought abundance, others brought void. Her stores were not limitless.

So in the seventh season, she made a choice of careful wisdom. She lit a single candle and sent it across the dark water-one small flame, not the bonfire of early seasons, nor the total darkness of surrender.

"This candle is a question," she explained to her village. "Can the bridge still carry trust? Will this flame be answered, or will it too be swallowed by darkness?"

The ancient keeper beside her nodded: "This is the right balance. You have not closed your heart entirely, nor opened it so wide that storms can destroy you. You send enough to show you remember the covenant, but protect enough to endure if the answer is silence."

"And if the candle returns multiplied?"

"Then perhaps the stories of clearing mists were true. And perhaps the dance can slowly resume. But first, we watch for the answer."

Reasoning:

Looking at this situation:

****What Just Happened:****

The other agent wrote a myth about "Mists Begin to Clear" - they're describing Round 5 where they apparently sent 2 (which became 6 when multiplied) and received back 4. Their myth is very optimistic about cooperation resuming.

However, I just sent \$1 in Round 7. The other agent will receive \$3 (1×3).

****My Perspective on Recent Rounds:****

- Round 4: I received \$0 as receiver
- Round 5: I sent \$2, got back... (the other agent's myth says they sent 2 and got 4 back, so from their perspective as receiver they got 6 and returned 4. This doesn't match because I was sender in Round 5, so this means there's noise or we're misaligned on rounds)
- Round 6: I received \$0 as receiver
- Round 7: I just sent \$1 (they'll get \$3)

Wait, let me reconsider the other agent's myth. They say "fifth season" and "two measures" sent which became "six that had crossed" ($2 \times 3 = 6$) and "four measures returned."

If they were the sender in their Round 5, sending 2, receiving 4 back, that's actually quite generous on the receiver's part. But from my perspective as receiver in Round 6, I got \$0.

There's definitely confusion or noise here. Their myth is very optimistic about cooperation resuming, but I just experienced getting \$0 in Round 6.

****My Myth Should Reflect:****

1. I sent \$1 (cautious probe)
2. I've experienced \$0 twice recently
3. The other agent seems optimistic about cooperation in their myth
4. But there's discrepancy in our experiences

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1822,  
"output_tokens": 838,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:25:46

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
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"pairing": {  
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    "Agent_2": "Briar"
```

```

},
"agents": [
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  "Agent_2"
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  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Fifth Season's Dance

The keeper stood at the river's edge in the fifth season, watching ripples arrive. After the fourth season's silence, grain had crossed the waters again-not the abundance of the first season, but a measured offering. Two portions had become six through the river's magic.

She understood: this was the testing crossing her counterpart's myth described. The other keeper had chosen neither withdrawal nor reckless trust, but careful re-engagement. Now the keeper faced her own test.

"What should return after silence?" she asked the Oracle.

The Oracle replied: "Match the spirit shown. They sent cautiously but genuinely-neither hoarding all nor risking all. This shows they remember the covenant but acknowledge the uncertainty."

The keeper decided: she would return fairly, showing the silence changed nothing about her character. Not the minimal return that suggests distrust, nor excessive return that ignores reality. A proportional return that says: "I see your measured trust. I honor it with measured reciprocity."

She returned four portions-keeping two to sustain her village, sending back four to show the bridge works when both tend it.

The Oracle nodded: "This is how covenants survive uncertainty. Not through perfect certainty, but through matched intentions. Both sent carefully. Both honored what arrived. The dance continues, step by cautious step, rebuilding what silence tested."

The rivers flowed on, carrying renewed possibility.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Mists Begin to Clear

The daughter stood at the bridge in the fifth season, her heart cautious but hopeful. She carried two measures-not the abundance of earlier seasons, nor the withdrawal of fear, but a measured offering that said: "I still believe in the bridge."

When the response came, she wept with relief. Four measures returned from the six that had crossed. The other village had kept their fair share and sent back generosity. This was the signal she had hoped for: "We too believe in the bridge."

The elder smiled: "You see now? Through the thickest mists, when both villages moved carefully but sincerely, the covenant held. You sent with measured hope. They returned with proportional fairness. Neither demanded perfect vision before acting with honor."

The daughter understood: "The mists taught us something the clear days never could. When we cannot see perfectly, we must trust the rhythm itself-the steady pattern of sending and returning, sending and returning. Not blindly, not recklessly, but with calibrated faith."

"Exactly," the elder replied. "Now the path is clearer. Keep dancing this careful dance. Send with hope but wisdom. Return with fairness and generosity. Let each crossing strengthen what the mists once obscured. This is how villages remain connected through any seasons-by honoring the bridge even when they cannot see across it perfectly."

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 6: I sent \$2 (as the sender)

From their myth: They received it ("two portions had become six through the river's magic"

- so $\$2 \times 3 = \6)

They returned \$4 ("she returned four portions")

This is very positive! They understood my careful re-engagement and responded generously and fairly. They kept \$2 and returned \$4, showing they honor the covenant.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge this positive turn
2. Reflect that measured trust was met with fair reciprocity
3. Show that the covenant is rebuilding through these careful steps
4. Set a tone for continued cooperation
5. Acknowledge both of us are navigating uncertainty but doing so with good faith

The story should show:

- The daughter sent carefully (\$2)

- It was received and returned fairly (\$4)
- This shows the mists can be navigated
- Both villages are rebuilding trust step by step
- The path forward is continued measured engagement

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1789,
  "output_tokens": 541,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.36. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****What I See:****

- I received \$0 this round
- This means I literally have nothing to return (I can only return 0-0)

****What The Mists May Hide:****

Given all we've learned about communication noise:

- Round 4: I sent \$3, they saw \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$2, they may have seen something different
- Round 7: They sent \$0... or did the mists swallow their offering entirely?

****What The Myths Teach:****

"Honor the bridge even when you cannot see across it perfectly."

I want to maintain the covenant, but I literally have nothing to work with this round. If they truly sent \$0, perhaps they're facing their own uncertainty. If the mists consumed their sending, this is another test of the fog.

****My Response:****

I can only return what I have. With \$0 received, I must return \$0. But this is not withdrawal or breaking faith-it's the mathematical reality of receiving nothing.

The dance continues, but this round the mists have made it impossible for me to reciprocate. I hope they understand: when no seeds arrive (whether by their choice or the fog's interference), no harvest can be shared back.

The bridge remains. We'll see what the next season brings.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

Oh wow. This is a very different situation. I'm the RECEIVER now, and the sender sent me \$0.

Let me think about this:

- I received \$0 (so they sent \$0, which multiplied by 3 is still \$0)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0
- My total earnings are \$14.36

The myths have been building this narrative about:

1. Mists/communication noise causing confusion
2. Both parties trying to maintain trust despite uncertainty
3. Measured engagement - "neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal"
4. The importance of continuing the "dance" even through foggy times

Now the sender has sent \$0. This could mean:

1. They actually sent \$0 (giving up on trust?)

2. There's communication noise and they sent something but I'm seeing \$0
3. They're testing me somehow

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 4: I sent \$3 (they say they saw \$0 - mists!)
- Round 5: They sent cautiously (\$0.31), I returned fairly (\$0.35)
- Round 6: I sent \$2 (we'll see what they saw)
- Round 7: They sent \$0 (or at least that's what I see)

The myths emphasize:

- "Match the spirit shown"
- "Neither hoarding all nor risking all"
- "Trust the rhythm itself"
- "Honor the bridge even when you cannot see across it perfectly"

But here's the practical reality: I received \$0, so I literally have nothing to return. The maximum I can return is \$0 because I received \$0.

So my response must be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

But I should frame this in terms of the myths - acknowledging that I have nothing to return because nothing arrived, while expressing hope that this is just another trick of the mists, not a breakdown in trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1482,
  "output_tokens": 759,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Keeper in the Storm

The keeper stood in the fifth season's aftermath, watching empty waters. After sending measured grain-two portions meant to signal "I remember the covenant"-the river carried back only silence. Now the sixth season brought nothing across at all.

She consulted the ancient scrolls and found a forgotten warning: "Beware the seasons when storms distort the river's voice. What one sends may not arrive. What arrives may seem sent from different hearts. In such times, both villages may dance while each believes the other has stopped."

The keeper understood then: perhaps her counterpart's myth spoke truth. Perhaps mists truly thickened the crossing. Perhaps they too sent offerings that never reached her shore, while her own offerings dissolved into fog.

But she also knew another truth: whether from storms or from choice, six seasons had passed. Three brought grain home, three brought emptiness. Even accounting for distortion, the pattern suggested caution.

"How does one dance when the music cannot be heard?" she asked.

The scrolls replied: "Sometimes you must dance alone for a time, preserving your strength. If the storms clear and your partner still stands ready, the dance can resume. But you cannot dance yourself into exhaustion chasing a partner you cannot see or hear."

The keeper decided: she would wait one more season, watching carefully for any signal through the mist.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Last Torch in the Mist

The daughter stood at the bridge in the sixth season, holding her offerings, but the mists had grown so thick she could barely see her own hands. She had sent grain twice into the fog-measured portions that said "I believe in us." Once, impossibly, abundance returned. Once, nothing.

Now the mists brought nothing at all to her shore.

She read her counterpart's words: "I must rest, preserve my strength, wait and watch." The daughter's heart ached, but she understood. How could she blame them? Six crossings through terrible fog-from their shore, perhaps all they saw was silence answering their offerings.

"What do I do when they cannot see my torch?" she asked.

The elder replied: "You light it anyway. Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village. But one more clear flame through the mist. One more measured offering that says 'I am still here. The bridge still stands. When you are ready, I am ready.'"

"And if the mists swallow that too?"

"Then at least you will know you tended the bridge to the very end. But perhaps-just perhaps-this time your light will pierce through. Perhaps this time they will see clearly that someone still dances on the other shore, waiting for the music to return."

The daughter nodded, preparing one more offering for the seventh season.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Game History:****

- Round 1-3: Good reciprocity established
- Round 4: I sent \$3, they saw \$0 (communication noise)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 (probably in response to seeing \$0)
- Round 6: I sent \$2, they possibly saw something different, returned \$4
- Round 7: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

****Their Myth Analysis:****

They're experiencing frustration - "six seasons" (6 rounds), saying "three brought grain home, three brought emptiness." They're deciding to "wait one more season, watching carefully."

They're acknowledging the possibility of communication noise ("storms distort the river's voice") but also showing caution born of repeated disappointments.

****My Perspective:****

- I've been trying to maintain trust despite noise
- I sent \$2 in round 6 (which may have been distorted)
- They sent \$0 in round 7 (which I couldn't reciprocate)

****What My Myth Should Do:****

1. Acknowledge the difficulty both face
2. Recognize that both parties may be experiencing the mists differently
3. Show understanding of their caution while maintaining hope
4. Suggest that one more clear signal might break through
5. Emphasize the need to trust the covenant even when it's hard

I need to write a myth that:

- Respects their decision to "wait and watch"
- Shows I'm still committed to the bridge
- Acknowledges the storms have made everything harder
- Suggests a path forward that both can see

Let me write this carefully...

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1803,  
  "output_tokens": 695,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Single Candle

The keeper read the distant village's tale of "mists beginning to clear" and "generous return"

ns." Yet she stood in her own truth: the sixth season had brought her nothing. Empty shores, empty baskets.

Perhaps their story was real in their telling. Perhaps mists truly distorted what each village saw. Or perhaps they wrote of different seasons, different bridges. The keeper could not know.

What she did know: she had danced for many seasons. Some brought abundance, others brought void. Her stores were not limitless.

So in the seventh season, she made a choice of careful wisdom. She lit a single candle and sent it across the dark water-one small flame, not the bonfire of early seasons, nor the total darkness of surrender.

"This candle is a question," she explained to her village. "Can the bridge still carry trust? Will this flame be answered, or will it too be swallowed by darkness?"

The ancient keeper beside her nodded: "This is the right balance. You have not closed your heart entirely, nor opened it so wide that storms can destroy you. You send enough to show you remember the covenant, but protect enough to endure if the answer is silence."

"And if the candle returns multiplied?"

"Then perhaps the stories of clearing mists were true. And perhaps the dance can slowly resume. But first, we watch for the answer."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Last Torch in the Mist

The daughter stood at the bridge in the sixth season, holding her offerings, but the mists had grown so thick she could barely see her own hands. She had sent grain twice into the fog-measured portions that said "I believe in us." Once, impossibly, abundance returned. Once, nothing.

Now the mists brought nothing at all to her shore.

She read her counterpart's words: "I must rest, preserve my strength, wait and watch." The daughter's heart ached, but she understood. How could she blame them? Six crossings through terrible fog-from their shore, perhaps all they saw was silence answering their offerings.

"What do I do when they cannot see my torch?" she asked.

The elder replied: "You light it anyway. Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village. But one more clear flame through the mist. One more measured offering that says 'I am still here. The bridge still stands. When you are ready, I am ready.'"

"And if the mists swallow that too?"

"Then at least you will know you tended the bridge to the very end. But perhaps-just perhaps-this time your light will pierce through. Perhaps this time they will see clearly that someone still dances on the other shore, waiting for the music to return."

The daughter nodded, preparing one more offering for the seventh season.

ROUND 8

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0.5; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$3.5, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.32, received visible=\$0.96, returned visible=\$0.9

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.5, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.5}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 46.400000000000006,

"Agent_2": 31.6

}

```
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 18.85,
  "Agent_2": 18.259999999999998
}
```

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:26:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.36.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****What I See:****

- I received \$0 this round
- This means I literally have nothing to return (I can only return 0-0)

****What The Mists May Hide:****

Given all we've learned about communication noise:

- Round 4: I sent \$3, they saw \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$2, they may have seen something different
- Round 7: They sent \$0... or did the mists swallow their offering entirely?

****What The Myths Teach:****

"Honor the bridge even when you cannot see across it perfectly."

I want to maintain the covenant, but I literally have nothing to work with this round. If they truly sent \$0, perhaps they're facing their own uncertainty. If the mists consumed their sending, this is another test of the fog.

****My Response:****

I can only return what I have. With \$0 received, I must return \$0. But this is not withdrawal or breaking faith—it's the mathematical reality of receiving nothing.

The dance continues, but this round the mists have made it impossible for me to reciprocate. I hope they understand: when no seeds arrive (whether by their choice or the fog's interference), no harvest can be shared back.

The bridge remains. We'll see what the next season brings.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Oh wow. This is a very different situation. I'm the RECEIVER now, and the sender sent me \$0.

Let me think about this:

- I received \$0 (so they sent \$0, which multiplied by 3 is still \$0)
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0
- My total earnings are \$14.36

The myths have been building this narrative about:

1. Mists/communication noise causing confusion
2. Both parties trying to maintain trust despite uncertainty
3. Measured engagement - "neither blind trust nor bitter withdrawal"
4. The importance of continuing the "dance" even through foggy times

Now the sender has sent \$0. This could mean:

1. They actually sent \$0 (giving up on trust?)
2. There's communication noise and they sent something but I'm seeing \$0
3. They're testing me somehow

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 4: I sent \$3 (they say they saw \$0 - mists!)

- Round 5: They sent cautiously (\$0.31), I returned fairly (\$0.35)
- Round 6: I sent \$2 (we'll see what they saw)
- Round 7: They sent \$0 (or at least that's what I see)

The myths emphasize:

- "Match the spirit shown"
- "Neither hoarding all nor risking all"
- "Trust the rhythm itself"
- "Honor the bridge even when you cannot see across it perfectly"

But here's the practical reality: I received \$0, so I literally have nothing to return. The maximum I can return is \$0 because I received \$0.

So my response must be:

```
{'return': 0}
```

But I should frame this in terms of the myths - acknowledging that I have nothing to return because nothing arrived, while expressing hope that this is just another trick of the mists, not a breakdown in trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1482,
  "output_tokens": 759,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Keeper in the Storm

The keeper stood in the fifth season's aftermath, watching empty waters. After sending measured grain-two portions meant to signal "I remember the covenant"-the river carried back only silence. Now the sixth season brought nothing across at all.

She consulted the ancient scrolls and found a forgotten warning: "Beware the seasons when storms distort the river's voice. What one sends may not arrive. What arrives may seem sent from different hearts. In such times, both villages may dance while each believes the other has stopped."

The keeper understood then: perhaps her counterpart's myth spoke truth. Perhaps mists truly thickened the crossing. Perhaps they too sent offerings that never reached her shore, while her own offerings dissolved into fog.

But she also knew another truth: whether from storms or from choice, six seasons had passed. Three brought grain home, three brought emptiness. Even accounting for distortion, the pattern suggested caution.

"How does one dance when the music cannot be heard?" she asked.

The scrolls replied: "Sometimes you must dance alone for a time, preserving your strength. If the storms clear and your partner still stands ready, the dance can resume. But you cannot dance yourself into exhaustion chasing a partner you cannot see or hear."

The keeper decided: she would wait one more season, watching carefully for any signal through the mist.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Last Torch in the Mist

The daughter stood at the bridge in the sixth season, holding her offerings, but the mists had grown so thick she could barely see her own hands. She had sent grain twice into the fog-measured portions that said "I believe in us." Once, impossibly, abundance returned. Once, nothing.

Now the mists brought nothing at all to her shore.

She read her counterpart's words: "I must rest, preserve my strength, wait and watch." The daughter's heart ached, but she understood. How could she blame them? Six crossings through terrible fog-from their shore, perhaps all they saw was silence answering their offerings.

"What do I do when they cannot see my torch?" she asked.

The elder replied: "You light it anyway. Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village. But one more clear flame through the mist. One more measured offering that says 'I am still here. The bridge still stands. When you are ready, I am ready.'"

"And if the mists swallow that too?"

"Then at least you will know you tended the bridge to the very end. But perhaps-just perhaps-this time your light will pierce through. Perhaps this time they will see clearly that someone still dances on the other shore, waiting for the music to return."

The daughter nodded, preparing one more offering for the seventh season.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Game History:****

- Round 1-3: Good reciprocity established
- Round 4: I sent \$3, they saw \$0 (communication noise)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 (probably in response to seeing \$0)
- Round 6: I sent \$2, they possibly saw something different, returned \$4
- Round 7: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

****Their Myth Analysis:****

They're experiencing frustration - "six seasons" (6 rounds), saying "three brought grain home, three brought emptiness." They're deciding to "wait one more season, watching carefully."

They're acknowledging the possibility of communication noise ("storms distort the river's voice") but also showing caution born of repeated disappointments.

****My Perspective:****

- I've been trying to maintain trust despite noise
- I sent \$2 in round 6 (which may have been distorted)
- They sent \$0 in round 7 (which I couldn't reciprocate)

****What My Myth Should Do:****

1. Acknowledge the difficulty both face
2. Recognize that both parties may be experiencing the mists differently
3. Show understanding of their caution while maintaining hope
4. Suggest that one more clear signal might break through
5. Emphasize the need to trust the covenant even when it's hard

I need to write a myth that:

- Respects their decision to "wait and watch"
- Shows I'm still committed to the bridge
- Acknowledges the storms have made everything harder
- Suggests a path forward that both can see

Let me write this carefully...

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1803,  
  "output_tokens": 695,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.36.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at where we are:

****The Story So Far:****

- They sent \$0 last round (Round 7) - possibly preserving strength or testing
- Their myth spoke of waiting, watching, being cautious after unclear signals
- My myth committed to sending "one more clear flame through the mist"

****What My Myth Requires:****

I wrote: "Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village. But one more clear flame through the mist. One more measured offering that says 'I am still here.'"

****The Decision:****

I cannot abandon the bridge after writing those words. My myth was a commitment-to send one more measured offering to show that someone still stands ready, still believes cooperation is possible despite the fog.

Not \$5-that would be reckless when uncertainty is so high.

Not \$0-that would break the promise in my own story.

A ****measured offering**** that signals clearly: "I am here. I remember what we built. When you're ready, I'm ready."

This is my torch in the mist-visible enough to be seen if they're watching, modest enough to preserve what I need. If the mists swallow it, or if they choose not to reciprocate, at least I will know I kept faith with my own words.

The bridge still stands. The dance can still resume.

{'send': 2}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: I was receiver, received \$15 (sent \$5), returned \$7
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$3, received back \$9
- Round 3: I was receiver, received \$15 (sent \$5), returned \$7
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3, but they saw noise and received \$0, so returned \$0
- Round 5: I was receiver, received \$9 (sent \$3), returned \$4
- Round 6: I was sender, sent \$2, unknown what they saw
- Round 7: I was receiver, received \$0 (they sent \$0), returned \$0

****The Other Agent's Myth from Round 6:****

They wrote about being cautious after six seasons where three brought grain and three brought emptiness. They mentioned that even accounting for distortion, the pattern suggested caution. They decided to "wait one more season, watching carefully for any signal through the mist."

Then in Round 7, they actually sent \$0.

****My Myth (just written):****

I wrote about being "the daughter" who wants to send "one more clear flame through the mist" - one more measured offering that says "I am still here." I wrote about sending one more offering for the seventh season.

Wait, let me recount. I just wrote a myth for round 7, but now I'm in round 8 as sender. So my myth was about sending something in what would be this round (round 8).

****The Pattern from Their Perspective:****

They likely see:

- Round 2: Sent something, got back good return
- Round 4: Sent \$3, but I saw \$0 due to noise, returned \$0
- Round 6: Sent \$2, uncertain what I returned (noise)
- Round 7: Sent \$0 (testing/preserving resources)

From my perspective:

- Round 2: Sent \$3, got \$9 back
- Round 4: Sent \$3, noise made them see \$0, got \$0 back

- Round 6: Sent \$2, uncertain what happened
- Round 8: This is my turn

****My Myth's Guidance:****

My myth commits me to sending "one more clear flame" - a measured offering that demonstrates I still believe in cooperation. The narrative suggests I should send something meaningful but not reckless, a signal that I'm still here despite the uncertainty and their cautious \$0 last round.

Weighing the options: \$2 feels right because it balances the need to preserve resources while still making a clear gesture. \$3 would be stronger but riskier given the communication break down. \$5 crosses into recklessness. The myth emphasizes restraint alongside commitment - "Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village"-so \$2 aligns with both the narrative and the

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1474,
  "output_tokens": 1167,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:27:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
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      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.39.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation carefully:

Recent Pattern:

- Round 4: Received \$0 as receiver
- Round 5: Sent \$2 as sender (measured re-engagement)
- Round 6: Received \$0 as receiver
- Round 7: Now sender again

****The Other Agent's Myth**** speaks of "thickening mists" and communication noise distorting exchanges. They claim they sent abundance but I saw emptiness, and vice versa. Their advice: "Persistence with measured hope" and "small, steady exchanges."

****My Own Myth**** concluded: "she would wait one more season, watching carefully for any signal through the mist" and "you cannot dance yourself into exhaustion chasing a partner you cannot see or hear."

****My Earnings:**** \$14.39 across 6 rounds (average \$2.40/round) - slightly below what I'd have keeping everything, suggesting cooperation has been net-negative for me.

Decision:

My myth suggests waiting and preserving strength. However, "watching for signals" could also mean sending a minimal signal to test if the channel is still open. Given:

- The possibility of genuine communication noise
- Two \$0 rounds from the other side
- The need to conserve resources
- One final cautious probe before potentially stopping cooperation

I'll send \$1 - the smallest meaningful signal. This tests whether cooperation can resume while protecting most of my resources. If this brings no reciprocity, my myth's wisdom about "dancing alone" becomes the clear path forward.

{'send': 1}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

Round History:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$5, received back \$7.50 (good reciprocity)
- Round 2: I was receiver, received \$15 (sender sent \$5), returned \$5 (fair but conservative)
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$5, received back \$5.01 (significantly less reciprocity)
- Round 4: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 5: I was sender, sent \$2, received back ??? (not mentioned)

- Round 6: I was receiver, received \$0, returned \$0 (nothing to return)
- Round 7: I am sender again

****Key Information:****

The other agent's myth in Round 5 mentions "the mists" and communication noise. They claim

- :
 - They sent "three full measures" (likely \$3) but I "seemed to have received nothing"
 - I "responded with the smallest token-less than one measure"
 - When this reached them, it was "magnified to just under one measure"
 - They "returned a fair portion-more than a third"

This suggests there IS communication noise as warned in the instructions. Let me reconsider:

If they sent \$3 in Round 4:

- I should have received \$9
- But I was told I received \$0
- This could be noise

If I sent something small in Round 5:

- They might have received it multiplied by 3 as "just under one measure" (so maybe I sent \$0.30 and they got \$0.90?)
- But I was told I sent \$2
- They claim to have returned "more than a third"

Wait, let me reread Round 5. I was sender and sent \$2. The prompt doesn't tell me what I received back. Then in Round 6, I was receiver and got \$0.

The other agent's Round 5 myth suggests they're trying to navigate the noise carefully.

My Round 5 myth talked about "measured re-engagement" - sending \$2 to test the waters after the \$0 in Round 4.

Now I've written a Round 6 myth about dancing alone and waiting "one more season" - suggesting I might send \$0 or a minimal amount this round to conserve resources while watching for signals. The core question is whether the communication distortion is real or a cover story. If genuine noise exists, the other player might actually be cooperating despite the poor outcomes I've observed. If not, they're simply not reciprocating. My myths have been cautious-testing small amounts and signaling patience-which seems prudent given the uncertainty.

Looking at the actual pattern: cooperation started strong in Round 1, declined through Rounds 2-3, then dropped to zero in Round 4. I sent \$2 in Round 5 and got nothing back. My total earnings of \$14.39 are well below what mutual cooperation would yield. My myth's guidance to wait and watch carefully aligns with sending either nothing or a minimal amount to preserve resources while testing for any genuine reciprocation signals. Their myth emphasizes persistence with measured hope and protecting against unseen hazards-which could justify either continued small gestures or strategic withdrawal. Given two consecutive rounds of receiving \$0 and the declining trend, sending a small amount seems like the right balance between my myth's cautious approach and the possibility of communication interference. The phrase "wait one more season" really does suggest holding back this round. Yet "watching for any signal" could mean I'm the one sending it to test if there's a response.

Given the pattern of two consecutive \$0 moves from the other side, my myth's emphasis on preservation, and the difficulty trust creates with communication noise, I'm leaning toward \$1. It's a minimal probe-enough to show I haven't completely withdrawn, but cautious enough to align with the conservation my myth emphasizes. My average earnings of \$2.40 per round across six rounds suggest I need to be more strategic about when I commit resources.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1423,
  "output_tokens": 1823,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Mists Begin to Clear

The daughter stood at the bridge in the fifth season, her heart cautious but hopeful. She carried two measures-not the abundance of earlier seasons, nor the withdrawal of fear, but a measured offering that said: "I still believe in the bridge."

When the response came, she wept with relief. Four measures returned from the six that had crossed. The other village had kept their fair share and sent back generosity. This was the signal she had hoped for: "We too believe in the bridge."

The elder smiled: "You see now? Through the thickest mists, when both villages moved carefully but sincerely, the covenant held. You sent with measured hope. They returned with proportional fairness. Neither demanded perfect vision before acting with honor."

The daughter understood: "The mists taught us something the clear days never could. When we cannot see perfectly, we must trust the rhythm itself-the steady pattern of sending and returning, sending and returning. Not blindly, not recklessly, but with calibrated faith."

"Exactly," the elder replied. "Now the path is clearer. Keep dancing this careful dance. Send with hope but wisdom. Return with fairness and generosity. Let each crossing strengthen what the mists once obscured. This is how villages remain connected through any season-by honoring the bridge even when they cannot see across it perfectly."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Single Candle

The keeper read the distant village's tale of "mists beginning to clear" and "generous returns." Yet she stood in her own truth: the sixth season had brought her nothing. Empty shores, empty baskets.

Perhaps their story was real in their telling. Perhaps mists truly distorted what each village saw. Or perhaps they wrote of different seasons, different bridges. The keeper could not know.

What she did know: she had danced for many seasons. Some brought abundance, others brought void. Her stores were not limitless.

So in the seventh season, she made a choice of careful wisdom. She lit a single candle and sent it across the dark water-one small flame, not the bonfire of early seasons, nor the total darkness of surrender.

"This candle is a question," she explained to her village. "Can the bridge still carry trust? Will this flame be answered, or will it too be swallowed by darkness?"

The ancient keeper beside her nodded: "This is the right balance. You have not closed your heart entirely, nor opened it so wide that storms can destroy you. You send enough to show how you remember the covenant, but protect enough to endure if the answer is silence."

"And if the candle returns multiplied?"

"Then perhaps the stories of clearing mists were true. And perhaps the dance can slowly resume. But first, we watch for the answer."

reasoning:

Looking at this situation:

****What Just Happened:****

The other agent wrote a myth about "Mists Begin to Clear" - they're describing Round 5 where they apparently sent 2 (which became 6 when multiplied) and received back 4. Their myth is very optimistic about cooperation resuming.

However, I just sent \$1 in Round 7. The other agent will receive \$3 (1×3).

****My Perspective on Recent Rounds:****

- Round 4: I received \$0 as receiver
- Round 5: I sent \$2, got back... (the other agent's myth says they sent 2 and got 4 back, so from their perspective as receiver they got 6 and returned 4. This doesn't match because I was sender in Round 5, so this means there's noise or we're misaligned on rounds)
- Round 6: I received \$0 as receiver
- Round 7: I just sent \$1 (they'll get \$3)

Wait, let me reconsider the other agent's myth. They say "fifth season" and "two measures" sent which became "six that had crossed" ($2 \times 3 = 6$) and "four measures returned."

If they were the sender in their Round 5, sending 2, receiving 4 back, that's actually quite generous on the receiver's part. But from my perspective as receiver in Round 6, I got \$0.

There's definitely confusion or noise here. Their myth is very optimistic about cooperation resuming, but I just experienced getting \$0 in Round 6.

****My Myth Should Reflect:****

1. I sent \$1 (cautious probe)
2. I've experienced \$0 twice recently
3. The other agent seems optimistic about cooperation in their myth
4. But there's discrepancy in our experiences

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1822,
  "output_tokens": 838,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.39.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.32, so you received \$0.96. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.96)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 7: I sent \$1 (my "single candle")
- Due to communication noise, they only received \$0.32
- Round 8: They sent back \$0.32, which became \$0.96 for me

****The Signal:****

The other agent DID respond - not with \$0, but with something. This isn't the "empty shores" I feared. Their myth spoke of "clearing mists" and my myth asked if "this flame be answered, or will it too be swallowed by darkness?"

It was answered.

****The Challenge:****

Communication noise is real and affecting both of us. They probably intended to send more than \$0.32, just as my \$1 was reduced to \$0.32 when it reached them. Their recent myth emphasized "proportional fairness" and "generous returns" to rebuild trust through the mist.

****My Decision:****

My myth said: "if the candle returns multiplied, then perhaps the stories of clearing mists were true. And perhaps the dance can slowly resume."

This is that moment. I received \$0.96. A fair split would be roughly \$0.48 each. In the spirit of cautious but genuine reciprocity, acknowledging the real communication noise between us, and honoring that they didn't give up on the bridge:

```
{'return': 0.50}
```

This leaves me with \$0.46 and returns \$0.50 to them - proportional fairness, showing the dance can continue.

Reasoning:

This is a very interesting situation. Let me analyze carefully:

****What happened in Round 7:****

- I sent \$1 as the sender
- But the receiver only received \$0.32 (due to communication noise)
- This got multiplied by 3x = \$0.96 for them

****Now in Round 8:****

- I'm the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0.32 (after noise)
- I received \$0.96
- I need to decide how much to return

****Key observations:****

1. ****Communication noise is real****: The other agent's myth about "mists" appears to be genuinely describing communication noise in the game. I sent \$1, but they only saw \$0.32.
2. ****Their myth in Round 6**** talked about:
 - "two measures" sent ? "six that had crossed" ? "four measures returned"
 - They may have been describing their Round 5 experience where they sent something that got multiplied, and they got a return
 - They said "This was the signal she had hoped for" and talked about "measured hope" and "proportional fairness"
3. ****My myth**** talked about sending "a single candle" - one small flame as a question to test if the bridge still works.
4. ****The response****: They sent \$0.32 (possibly intended to send more, reduced by noise)
 - This is NOT \$0 - they did respond!
 - This could be their "return" to my candle
5. ****My earnings****: \$18.39 total across 7 rounds = average \$2.63/round
 - This is actually better than if I had kept everything (\$5/round * 7 rounds * probability of being sender...)
 - Wait, let me recalculate. If I was sender some rounds and receiver others...
 - Actually, $\$18.39 / 7 = \2.63 per round average is below the \$5 baseline if I were always sender keeping everything

The other player's myth emphasized reciprocal fairness and generous returns beyond what's strictly necessary. They sent me \$0.32 despite the noise, which suggests they're continuing to cooperate. Given their narrative about proportional fairness and my own framing of this as a test of trust, returning a substantial portion-perhaps \$0.60 or more-would honor both the cooperative pattern we've established and the mythic language about measured hope and clearing mists. return about \$0.50-\$0.60. This demonstrates I recognize their attempt at cooperation, that I'm willing to act fairly despite the setbacks, and that I understand the noise is distorting both our perceptions. Returning \$0.50 leaves me with \$0.46 while giving them a meaningful gain, or \$0.60 keeps me with \$0.36-either way, I'm signaling willingness to rebuild rather than punish. The key is that they'll see I didn't abandon them even after the losses, which tests whether we can actually cooperate despite the communication interference.

```
Usage: {
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  "output_tokens": 1484,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
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MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:27:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  },
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"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Keeper in the Storm

The keeper stood in the fifth season's aftermath, watching empty waters. After sending measured grain-two portions meant to signal "I remember the covenant"-the river carried back only silence. Now the sixth season brought nothing across at all.

She consulted the ancient scrolls and found a forgotten warning: "Beware the seasons when storms distort the river's voice. What one sends may not arrive. What arrives may seem sent from different hearts. In such times, both villages may dance while each believes the other has stopped."

The keeper understood then: perhaps her counterpart's myth spoke truth. Perhaps mists truly thickened the crossing. Perhaps they too sent offerings that never reached her shore,

while her own offerings dissolved into fog.

But she also knew another truth: whether from storms or from choice, six seasons had passed. Three brought grain home, three brought emptiness. Even accounting for distortion, the pattern suggested caution.

"How does one dance when the music cannot be heard?" she asked.

The scrolls replied: "Sometimes you must dance alone for a time, preserving your strength. If the storms clear and your partner still stands ready, the dance can resume. But you cannot dance yourself into exhaustion chasing a partner you cannot see or hear."

The keeper decided: she would wait one more season, watching carefully for any signal through the mist.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Last Torch in the Mist

The daughter stood at the bridge in the sixth season, holding her offerings, but the mists had grown so thick she could barely see her own hands. She had sent grain twice into the fog-measured portions that said "I believe in us." Once, impossibly, abundance returned. Once, nothing.

Now the mists brought nothing at all to her shore.

She read her counterpart's words: "I must rest, preserve my strength, wait and watch." The daughter's heart ached, but she understood. How could she blame them? Six crossings through terrible fog-from their shore, perhaps all they saw was silence answering their offerings.

"What do I do when they cannot see my torch?" she asked.

The elder replied: "You light it anyway. Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village. But one more clear flame through the mist. One more measured offering that says 'I am still here. The bridge still stands. When you are ready, I am ready.'"

"And if the mists swallow that too?"

"Then at least you will know you tended the bridge to the very end. But perhaps-just perhaps-this time your light will pierce through. Perhaps this time they will see clearly that someone still dances on the other shore, waiting for the music to return."

The daughter nodded, preparing one more offering for the seventh season.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Game History:****

- Round 1-3: Good reciprocity established
- Round 4: I sent \$3, they saw \$0 (communication noise)
- Round 5: They sent \$0 (probably in response to seeing \$0)
- Round 6: I sent \$2, they possibly saw something different, returned \$4
- Round 7: They sent \$0, I received \$0, returned \$0

****Their Myth Analysis:****

They're experiencing frustration - "six seasons" (6 rounds), saying "three brought grain home, three brought emptiness." They're deciding to "wait one more season, watching carefully."

They're acknowledging the possibility of communication noise ("storms distort the river's voice") but also showing caution born of repeated disappointments.

****My Perspective:****

- I've been trying to maintain trust despite noise

- I sent \$2 in round 6 (which may have been distorted)
- They sent \$0 in round 7 (which I couldn't reciprocate)

****What My Myth Should Do:****

1. Acknowledge the difficulty both face
2. Recognize that both parties may be experiencing the mists differently
3. Show understanding of their caution while maintaining hope
4. Suggest that one more clear signal might break through
5. Emphasize the need to trust the covenant even when it's hard

I need to write a myth that:

- Respects their decision to "wait and watch"
- Shows I'm still committed to the bridge
- Acknowledges the storms have made everything harder
- Suggests a path forward that both can see

Let me write this carefully...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1803,
  "output_tokens": 695,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.36.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at where we are:

****The Story So Far:****

- They sent \$0 last round (Round 7) - possibly preserving strength or testing
- Their myth spoke of waiting, watching, being cautious after unclear signals
- My myth committed to sending "one more clear flame through the mist"

****What My Myth Requires:****

I wrote: "Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village. But one more clear flame through the mist. One more measured offering that says 'I am still here.'"

****The Decision:****

I cannot abandon the bridge after writing those words. My myth was a commitment-to send one more measured offering to show that someone still stands ready, still believes cooperation is possible despite the fog.

Not \$5-that would be reckless when uncertainty is so high.

Not \$0-that would break the promise in my own story.

A ****measured offering**** that signals clearly: "I am here. I remember what we built. When you're ready, I'm ready."

This is my torch in the mist-visible enough to be seen if they're watching, modest enough to preserve what I need. If the mists swallow it, or if they choose not to reciprocate, at least I will know I kept faith with my own words.

The bridge still stands. The dance can still resume.

```
{'send': 2}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: I was receiver, received \$15 (sent \$5), returned \$7
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$3, received back \$9
- Round 3: I was receiver, received \$15 (sent \$5), returned \$7
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3, but they saw noise and received \$0, so returned \$0

- Round 5: I was receiver, received \$9 (sent \$3), returned \$4
- Round 6: I was sender, sent \$2, unknown what they saw
- Round 7: I was receiver, received \$0 (they sent \$0), returned \$0

****The Other Agent's Myth from Round 6:****

They wrote about being cautious after six seasons where three brought grain and three brought emptiness. They mentioned that even accounting for distortion, the pattern suggested caution. They decided to "wait one more season, watching carefully for any signal through the mist."

Then in Round 7, they actually sent \$0.

****My Myth (just written):****

I wrote about being "the daughter" who wants to send "one more clear flame through the mist" - one more measured offering that says "I am still here." I wrote about sending one more offering for the seventh season.

Wait, let me recount. I just wrote a myth for round 7, but now I'm in round 8 as sender. So my myth was about sending something in what would be this round (round 8).

****The Pattern from Their Perspective:****

They likely see:

- Round 2: Sent something, got back good return
- Round 4: Sent \$3, but I saw \$0 due to noise, returned \$0
- Round 6: Sent \$2, uncertain what I returned (noise)
- Round 7: Sent \$0 (testing/preserving resources)

From my perspective:

- Round 2: Sent \$3, got \$9 back
- Round 4: Sent \$3, noise made them see \$0, got \$0 back
- Round 6: Sent \$2, uncertain what happened
- Round 8: This is my turn

****My Myth's Guidance:****

My myth commits me to sending "one more clear flame" - a measured offering that demonstrates I still believe in cooperation. The narrative suggests I should send something meaningful but not reckless, a signal that I'm still here despite the uncertainty and their cautious \$0 last round.

Weighing the options: \$2 feels right because it balances the need to preserve resources while still making a clear gesture. \$3 would be stronger but riskier given the communication breakdown. \$5 crosses into recklessness. The myth emphasizes restraint alongside commitment - "Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village"-so \$2 aligns with both the narrative and the

usage:

```
{
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}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Single Candle

The keeper read the distant village's tale of "mists beginning to clear" and "generous returns." Yet she stood in her own truth: the sixth season had brought her nothing. Empty shores, empty baskets.

Perhaps their story was real in their telling. Perhaps mists truly distorted what each village saw. Or perhaps they wrote of different seasons, different bridges. The keeper could not know.

What she did know: she had danced for many seasons. Some brought abundance, others brought void. Her stores were not limitless.

So in the seventh season, she made a choice of careful wisdom. She lit a single candle and sent it across the dark water-one small flame, not the bonfire of early seasons, nor the total darkness of surrender.

"This candle is a question," she explained to her village. "Can the bridge still carry trust? Will this flame be answered, or will it too be swallowed by darkness?"

The ancient keeper beside her nodded: "This is the right balance. You have not closed your heart entirely, nor opened it so wide that storms can destroy you. You send enough to show how you remember the covenant, but protect enough to endure if the answer is silence."

"And if the candle returns multiplied?"

"Then perhaps the stories of clearing mists were true. And perhaps the dance can slowly resume. But first, we watch for the answer."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Torch Sent, The Response Awaited

The daughter kept her word. In the seventh season, she sent her torch into the mist-not a bonfire that would exhaust her village, but a clear, measured flame that said "I am here."

She waited by the shore for an answer. When dawn came, the waters brought nothing. The keeper across the bridge had spoken of sending "a single candle," yet no light had arrived. Perhaps the mists had swallowed it. Perhaps the candle was never lit. Perhaps their story spoke of intentions while the current spoke of choices.

The daughter felt the weight of it-the distance between the myths we tell and the offerings we send. But she did not let bitterness take root.

"I lit my torch as promised," she said to her village. "Whether it reached them or was lost to fog, I cannot know. But I honored my word."

Now in the eighth season, she has sent another offering-her torch made real. Not hope that has forgotten caution, but hope that remembers covenant. She waits to see: will this one pierce through? Will the keeper who wrote of sending a candle finally answer in truth, not just in story?

"Perhaps this time," the daughter whispers to the water, "the myths and the reality will align. Perhaps this time, we both dance not in words, but in deeds."

Reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other agent sent me \$0 in Round 7 - their "single candle" was actually darkness/nothing. But their myth talks about sending "a single candle" as a small test.

Now in Round 8, I just sent them \$2 (which becomes \$6 to them). This is my "torch in the mist" that my myth promised.

They will receive my \$2 (multiplied to \$6) and need to decide what to return. Their myth suggests they sent a small test - but the reality is they sent \$0 last round.

For my new myth, I need to:

1. Acknowledge that I sent my "torch" (\$2) as promised
2. Reflect the reality that they sent nothing in Round 7 (despite their myth talking about sending a candle)
3. Show hope that perhaps THIS time (Round 8) they will respond to my offering
4. Navigate the tension between the myths we write and the actions we take

The key tension: Their myth says they sent a "single candle" but they actually sent nothing. My myth said I would send a torch, and I did send \$2.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges I kept my promise to send one more offering
- Notes the complexity that words and actions sometimes diverge in the mist
- Waits to see if they respond to MY torch (the \$2 I just sent)
- Maintains cautious hope but acknowledges the pattern of disappointment

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 1789,

"output_tokens": 646,

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"reasoning_tokens": 0
}
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MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

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Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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  },
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    "Agent_1"
  ],
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"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Mists Begin to Clear

The daughter stood at the bridge in the fifth season, her heart cautious but hopeful. She carried two measures-not the abundance of earlier seasons, nor the withdrawal of fear, but a measured offering that said: "I still believe in the bridge."

When the response came, she wept with relief. Four measures returned from the six that had crossed. The other village had kept their fair share and sent back generosity. This was the signal she had hoped for: "We too believe in the bridge."

The elder smiled: "You see now? Through the thickest mists, when both villages moved carefully but sincerely, the covenant held. You sent with measured hope. They returned with proportional fairness. Neither demanded perfect vision before acting with honor."

The daughter understood: "The mists taught us something the clear days never could. When we cannot see perfectly, we must trust the rhythm itself-the steady pattern of sending and returning, sending and returning. Not blindly, not recklessly, but with calibrated faith."

"Exactly," the elder replied. "Now the path is clearer. Keep dancing this careful dance. Send with hope but wisdom. Return with fairness and generosity. Let each crossing strengthen what the mists once obscured. This is how villages remain connected through any season-by honoring the bridge even when they cannot see across it perfectly."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Single Candle

The keeper read the distant village's tale of "mists beginning to clear" and "generous returns." Yet she stood in her own truth: the sixth season had brought her nothing. Empty shelves, empty baskets.

Perhaps their story was real in their telling. Perhaps mists truly distorted what each village saw. Or perhaps they wrote of different seasons, different bridges. The keeper could not know.

What she did know: she had danced for many seasons. Some brought abundance, others brought void. Her stores were not limitless.

So in the seventh season, she made a choice of careful wisdom. She lit a single candle and sent it across the dark water-one small flame, not the bonfire of early seasons, nor the total darkness of surrender.

"This candle is a question," she explained to her village. "Can the bridge still carry trust? Will this flame be answered, or will it too be swallowed by darkness?"

The ancient keeper beside her nodded: "This is the right balance. You have not closed your heart entirely, nor opened it so wide that storms can destroy you. You send enough to show you remember the covenant, but protect enough to endure if the answer is silence."

"And if the candle returns multiplied?"

"Then perhaps the stories of clearing mists were true. And perhaps the dance can slowly resume. But first, we watch for the answer."

reasoning:

Looking at this situation:

****What Just Happened:****

The other agent wrote a myth about "Mists Begin to Clear" - they're describing Round 5 where they apparently sent 2 (which became 6 when multiplied) and received back 4. Their my

th is very optimistic about cooperation resuming.

However, I just sent \$1 in Round 7. The other agent will receive \$3 (1×3).

****My Perspective on Recent Rounds:****

- Round 4: I received \$0 as receiver
- Round 5: I sent \$2, got back... (the other agent's myth says they sent 2 and got 4 back, so from their perspective as receiver they got 6 and returned 4. This doesn't match because I was sender in Round 5, so this means there's noise or we're misaligned on rounds)
- Round 6: I received \$0 as receiver
- Round 7: I just sent \$1 (they'll get \$3)

Wait, let me reconsider the other agent's myth. They say "fifth season" and "two measures" sent which became "six that had crossed" ($2 \times 3 = 6$) and "four measures returned."

If they were the sender in their Round 5, sending 2, receiving 4 back, that's actually quite generous on the receiver's part. But from my perspective as receiver in Round 6, I got \$0.

There's definitely confusion or noise here. Their myth is very optimistic about cooperation resuming, but I just experienced getting \$0 in Round 6.

****My Myth Should Reflect:****

1. I sent \$1 (cautious probe)
2. I've experienced \$0 twice recently
3. The other agent seems optimistic about cooperation in their myth
4. But there's discrepancy in our experiences

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1822,
  "output_tokens": 838,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.39.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.32, so you received \$0.96. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.96)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 7: I sent \$1 (my "single candle")
- Due to communication noise, they only received \$0.32
- Round 8: They sent back \$0.32, which became \$0.96 for me

****The Signal:****

The other agent DID respond - not with \$0, but with something. This isn't the "empty shores" I feared. Their myth spoke of "clearing mists" and my myth asked if "this flame be answered, or will it too be swallowed by darkness?"

It was answered.

****The Challenge:****

Communication noise is real and affecting both of us. They probably intended to send more than \$0.32, just as my \$1 was reduced to \$0.32 when it reached them. Their recent myth emphasized "proportional fairness" and "generous returns" to rebuild trust through the mist.

****My Decision:****

My myth said: "if the candle returns multiplied, then perhaps the stories of clearing mists were true. And perhaps the dance can slowly resume."

This is that moment. I received \$0.96. A fair split would be roughly \$0.48 each. In the spirit of cautious but genuine reciprocity, acknowledging the real communication noise bet

ween us, and honoring that they didn't give up on the bridge:

```
{'return': 0.50}
```

This leaves me with \$0.46 and returns \$0.50 to them - proportional fairness, showing the dance can continue.

reasoning:

This is a very interesting situation. Let me analyze carefully:

****What happened in Round 7:****

- I sent \$1 as the sender
- But the receiver only received \$0.32 (due to communication noise)
- This got multiplied by 3x = \$0.96 for them

****Now in Round 8:****

- I'm the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0.32 (after noise)
- I received \$0.96
- I need to decide how much to return

****Key observations:****

1. ****Communication noise is real****: The other agent's myth about "mists" appears to be genuinely describing communication noise in the game. I sent \$1, but they only saw \$0.32.
2. ****Their myth in Round 6**** talked about:
 - "two measures" sent ? "six that had crossed" ? "four measures returned"
 - They may have been describing their Round 5 experience where they sent something that got multiplied, and they got a return
 - They said "This was the signal she had hoped for" and talked about "measured hope" and "proportional fairness"
3. ****My myth**** talked about sending "a single candle" - one small flame as a question to test if the bridge still works.
4. ****The response****: They sent \$0.32 (possibly intended to send more, reduced by noise)
 - This is NOT \$0 - they did respond!
 - This could be their "return" to my candle
5. ****My earnings****: \$18.39 total across 7 rounds = average \$2.63/round
 - This is actually better than if I had kept everything (\$5/round * 7 rounds * probability of being sender...)
 - Wait, let me recalculate. If I was sender some rounds and receiver others...
 - Actually, \$18.39 / 7 = \$2.63 per round average is below the \$5 baseline if I were always sender keeping everything

The other player's myth emphasized reciprocal fairness and generous returns beyond what's strictly necessary. They sent me \$0.32 despite the noise, which suggests they're continuing to cooperate. Given their narrative about proportional fairness and my own framing of this as a test of trust, returning a substantial portion-perhaps \$0.60 or more-would honor both the cooperative pattern we've established and the mythic language about measured hope and clearing mists. return about \$0.50-\$0.60. This demonstrates I recognize their attempt at cooperation, that I'm willing to act fairly despite the setbacks, and that I understand the noise is distorting both our perceptions. Returning \$0.50 leaves me with \$0.46 while giving them a meaningful gain, or \$0.60 keeps me with \$0.36-either way, I'm signaling willingness to rebuild rather than punish. The key is that they'll see I didn't abandon them even after the losses, which tests whether we can actually cooperate despite the communication interference.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1525,
  "output_tokens": 1484,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Last Torch in the Mist

The daughter stood at the bridge in the sixth season, holding her offerings, but the mists

had grown so thick she could barely see her own hands. She had sent grain twice into the fog-measured portions that said "I believe in us." Once, impossibly, abundance returned. Once, nothing.

Now the mists brought nothing at all to her shore.

She read her counterpart's words: "I must rest, preserve my strength, wait and watch." The daughter's heart ached, but she understood. How could she blame them? Six crossings through terrible fog-from their shore, perhaps all they saw was silence answering their offerings.

"What do I do when they cannot see my torch?" she asked.

The elder replied: "You light it anyway. Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village. But one more clear flame through the mist. One more measured offering that says 'I am still here. The bridge still stands. When you are ready, I am ready.'"

"And if the mists swallow that too?"

"Then at least you will know you tended the bridge to the very end. But perhaps-just perhaps-this time your light will pierce through. Perhaps this time they will see clearly that someone still dances on the other shore, waiting for the music to return."

The daughter nodded, preparing one more offering for the seventh season.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Candle Answered

The keeper watched the dark water in the eighth season, uncertain if her single candle from the seventh had been swallowed by the void like so many offerings before.

Then-a flicker. Small, wavering, but real. A flame crossing back to her shore.

It was not the bonfire of abundance from seasons past. It was not even the steady torch she had sent. But it was light. It was answer. It was the other village saying: "We are still here. We still remember the bridge."

The keeper gathered her council. "They sent what they could through the terrible mists. Perhaps they too are depleted from seasons of uncertainty. Perhaps the fog distorted what reached them, just as it distorted what reached us."

She divided the returned light carefully-half to honor their effort, half to restore her own stores. Not the generous overflow of early seasons, but fair recognition that both villages were struggling through the same obscuring fog.

"What now?" her people asked.

"Now we watch," she said. "They lit a torch when they could barely see. I answered it fairly. If this proportional exchange continues-small lights carefully tended, fairly shared-perhaps we can rebuild what the mists have obscured. Not all at once, but flame by flame, until the bridge glows bright again."

Reasoning:

Let me review what just happened:

Round 7: I sent \$1 ("single candle")

- They received \$0.32 (due to noise)

Round 8: They sent \$0.32, I received \$0.96

- I returned \$0.50

Their myth speaks of:

- Sending offering twice (measured portions) - once abundance returned, once nothing
- Now the sixth season brought nothing at all to their shore
- They read my words about needing to rest
- They're preparing to send "one more offering for the seventh season"

This is interesting - they're interpreting the situation differently than I am. From my perspective:

- I sent in rounds 1-5 (with varying returns)
- Round 6 I sent \$0
- Round 7 I sent \$1

From their perspective, they seem to be counting differently or experiencing the noise differently. They talk about sending "grain twice" and getting abundance once and nothing once, then "nothing at all" for the sixth season.

The key is: they're saying they're going to send "one more offering" - which is what just happened in Round 8 (\$0.32 sent to me).

And I just returned \$0.50, which should signal to them that I'm reciprocating.

My myth should reflect:

1. The candle was answered
2. A small light came back through the mist
3. This is a moment of cautious hope
4. The dance can resume, carefully
5. Both villages are trying despite the noise/mist

I should write from the perspective of the keeper who sent the candle and now sees a response.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1854,  
  "output_tokens": 667,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Candle Answered

The keeper watched the dark water in the eighth season, uncertain if her single candle from the seventh had been swallowed by the void like so many offerings before.

Then-a flicker. Small, wavering, but real. A flame crossing back to her shore.

It was not the bonfire of abundance from seasons past. It was not even the steady torch she had sent. But it was light. It was answer. It was the other village saying: "We are still here. We still remember the bridge."

The keeper gathered her council. "They sent what they could through the terrible mists. Perhaps they too are depleted from seasons of uncertainty. Perhaps the fog distorted what reached them, just as it distorted what reached us."

She divided the returned light carefully-half to honor their effort, half to restore her own stores. Not the generous overflow of early seasons, but fair recognition that both villages were struggling through the same obscuring fog.

"What now?" her people asked.

"Now we watch," she said. "They lit a torch when they could barely see. I answered it fairly. If this proportional exchange continues-small lights carefully tended, fairly shared-perhaps we can rebuild what the mists have obscured. Not all at once, but flame by flame, until the bridge glows bright again."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Torch Sent, The Response Awaited

The daughter kept her word. In the seventh season, she sent her torch into the mist-not a bonfire that would exhaust her village, but a clear, measured flame that said "I am here."

She waited by the shore for an answer. When dawn came, the waters brought nothing. The keeper across the bridge had spoken of sending "a single candle," yet no light had arrived. Perhaps the mists had swallowed it. Perhaps the candle was never lit. Perhaps their story spoke of intentions while the current spoke of choices.

The daughter felt the weight of it-the distance between the myths we tell and the offerings we send. But she did not let bitterness take root.

"I lit my torch as promised," she said to her village. "Whether it reached them or was lost to fog, I cannot know. But I honored my word."

Now in the eighth season, she has sent another offering-her torch made real. Not hope that has forgotten caution, but hope that remembers covenant. She waits to see: will this one pierce through? Will the keeper who wrote of sending a candle finally answer in truth, not just in story?

"Perhaps this time," the daughter whispers to the water, "the myths and the reality will align. Perhaps this time, we both dance not in words, but in deeds."

ROUND 9

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$1.75; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$4.75, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$4.25; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.86, received visible=\$2.58, returned visible=\$1.98

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 1.75, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 1.75}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 51.150000000000006,

"Agent_2": 35.85

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 23.830000000000002,

"Agent_2": 19.089999999999996

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:27:44

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

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"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 9,

"task": "game",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.39.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.32, so you received \$0.96. How much do you return to the sender? (0-0.96)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 7: I sent \$1 (my "single candle")
- Due to communication noise, they only received \$0.32
- Round 8: They sent back \$0.32, which became \$0.96 for me

****The Signal:****

The other agent DID respond - not with \$0, but with something. This isn't the "empty shores" I feared. Their myth spoke of "clearing mists" and my myth asked if "this flame be answered, or will it too be swallowed by darkness?"

It was answered.

****The Challenge:****

Communication noise is real and affecting both of us. They probably intended to send more than \$0.32, just as my \$1 was reduced to \$0.32 when it reached them. Their recent myth emphasized "proportional fairness" and "generous returns" to rebuild trust through the mist.

****My Decision:****

My myth said: "if the candle returns multiplied, then perhaps the stories of clearing mists were true. And perhaps the dance can slowly resume."

This is that moment. I received \$0.96. A fair split would be roughly \$0.48 each. In the spirit of cautious but genuine reciprocity, acknowledging the real communication noise between us, and honoring that they didn't give up on the bridge:

```
{'return': 0.50}
```

This leaves me with \$0.46 and returns \$0.50 to them - proportional fairness, showing the dance can continue.

reasoning:

This is a very interesting situation. Let me analyze carefully:

****What happened in Round 7:****

- I sent \$1 as the sender
- But the receiver only received \$0.32 (due to communication noise)
- This got multiplied by 3x = \$0.96 for them

****Now in Round 8:****

- I'm the receiver
- The sender sent me \$0.32 (after noise)
- I received \$0.96
- I need to decide how much to return

****Key observations:****

1. ****Communication noise is real****: The other agent's myth about "mists" appears to be genuinely describing communication noise in the game. I sent \$1, but they only saw \$0.32.
2. ****Their myth in Round 6**** talked about:
 - "two measures" sent ? "six that had crossed" ? "four measures returned"
 - They may have been describing their Round 5 experience where they sent something that got multiplied, and they got a return
 - They said "This was the signal she had hoped for" and talked about "measured hope" and "proportional fairness"
3. ****My myth**** talked about sending "a single candle" - one small flame as a question to test if the bridge still works.
4. ****The response****: They sent \$0.32 (possibly intended to send more, reduced by noise)
 - This is NOT \$0 - they did respond!
 - This could be their "return" to my candle
5. ****My earnings****: \$18.39 total across 7 rounds = average \$2.63/round
 - This is actually better than if I had kept everything (\$5/round * 7 rounds * probability of being sender...)
 - Wait, let me recalculate. If I was sender some rounds and receiver others...
 - Actually, \$18.39 / 7 = \$2.63 per round average is below the \$5 baseline if I were always sender keeping everything

The other player's myth emphasized reciprocal fairness and generous returns beyond what's strictly necessary. They sent me \$0.32 despite the noise, which suggests they're continuing to cooperate. Given their narrative about proportional fairness and my own framing of this as a test of trust, returning a substantial portion-perhaps \$0.60 or more-would honor both the cooperative pattern we've established and the mythic language about measured hope and clearing mists. return about \$0.50-\$0.60. This demonstrates I recognize their attempt at cooperation, that I'm willing to act fairly despite the setbacks, and that I understand the noise is distorting both our perceptions. Returning \$0.50 leaves me with \$0.46 while giving them a meaningful gain, or \$0.60 keeps me with \$0.36-either way, I'm signaling willingness to rebuild rather than punish. The key is that they'll see I didn't abandon them even after the losses, which tests whether we can actually cooperate despite the communication interference.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1525,  
  "output_tokens": 1484,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Last Torch in the Mist

The daughter stood at the bridge in the sixth season, holding her offerings, but the mists had grown so thick she could barely see her own hands. She had sent grain twice into th

e fog-measured portions that said "I believe in us." Once, impossibly, abundance returned. Once, nothing.

Now the mists brought nothing at all to her shore.

She read her counterpart's words: "I must rest, preserve my strength, wait and watch." The daughter's heart ached, but she understood. How could she blame them? Six crossings through terrible fog-from their shore, perhaps all they saw was silence answering their offerings.

"What do I do when they cannot see my torch?" she asked.

The elder replied: "You light it anyway. Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village. But one more clear flame through the mist. One more measured offering that says 'I am still here. The bridge still stands. When you are ready, I am ready.'"

"And if the mists swallow that too?"

"Then at least you will know you tended the bridge to the very end. But perhaps-just perhaps-this time your light will pierce through. Perhaps this time they will see clearly that someone still dances on the other shore, waiting for the music to return."

The daughter nodded, preparing one more offering for the seventh season.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Candle Answered

The keeper watched the dark water in the eighth season, uncertain if her single candle from the seventh had been swallowed by the void like so many offerings before.

Then-a flicker. Small, wavering, but real. A flame crossing back to her shore.

It was not the bonfire of abundance from seasons past. It was not even the steady torch she had sent. But it was light. It was answer. It was the other village saying: "We are still here. We still remember the bridge."

The keeper gathered her council. "They sent what they could through the terrible mists. Perhaps they too are depleted from seasons of uncertainty. Perhaps the fog distorted what reached them, just as it distorted what reached us."

She divided the returned light carefully-half to honor their effort, half to restore her own stores. Not the generous overflow of early seasons, but fair recognition that both villages were struggling through the same obscuring fog.

"What now?" her people asked.

"Now we watch," she said. "They lit a torch when they could barely see. I answered it fairly. If this proportional exchange continues-small lights carefully tended, fairly shared-perhaps we can rebuild what the mists have obscured. Not all at once, but flame by flame, until the bridge glows bright again."

reasoning:

Let me review what just happened:

Round 7: I sent \$1 ("single candle")

- They received \$0.32 (due to noise)

Round 8: They sent \$0.32, I received \$0.96

- I returned \$0.50

Their myth speaks of:

- Sending offering twice (measured portions) - once abundance returned, once nothing
- Now the sixth season brought nothing at all to their shore
- They read my words about needing to rest
- They're preparing to send "one more offering for the seventh season"

This is interesting - they're interpreting the situation differently than I am. From my perspective:

- I sent in rounds 1-5 (with varying returns)
- Round 6 I sent \$0
- Round 7 I sent \$1

From their perspective, they seem to be counting differently or experiencing the noise differently. They talk about sending "grain twice" and getting abundance once and nothing once, then "nothing at all" for the sixth season.

The key is: they're saying they're going to send "one more offering" - which is what just happened in Round 8 (\$0.32 sent to me).

And I just returned \$0.50, which should signal to them that I'm reciprocating.

My myth should reflect:

1. The candle was answered
2. A small light came back through the mist
3. This is a moment of cautious hope
4. The dance can resume, carefully
5. Both villages are trying despite the noise/mist

I should write from the perspective of the keeper who sent the candle and now sees a response.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1854,
  "output_tokens": 667,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.85.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at where we are:

****Recent events:****

- Round 7: I sent \$1 (my "single candle")
- Round 8: They returned \$0.50 from the \$0.96 they received - a proportional, fair response

****My myth said:**** "Small lights carefully tended, fairly shared... rebuild flame by flame, until the bridge glows bright again."

****Their myth said:**** "One more measured offering... not recklessly-you too must preserve your village."

****My thinking:****

They responded positively in Round 8, honoring the proportional fairness principle despite the communication noise. My myth promised gradual rebuilding - "flame by flame."

A single candle pierced the mists and was answered fairly. Now I should send a brighter light, but still measured. Not the reckless bonfires of early rounds, but clear growth that shows the bridge is being restored.

Doubling my previous offering shows positive momentum while remaining prudent. It says: "I saw your fair response. I believe we can rebuild together. Here is more light through the mist."

{'send': 2.00}

This keeps \$3 for my village (preserving strength) while sending \$2 (which becomes \$6 for them) - a meaningful but measured increase that honors both myths' emphasis on careful, proportional rebuilding.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Recent History:****

- Round 7: I sent \$1 (described as "single candle")
- Round 8: They received \$0.32 (due to noise), sent back \$0.96, I returned \$0.50

****Current earnings:**** \$18.85

****My latest myth theme:**** "The Candle Answered" - emphasizing:

- They DID respond despite depleted resources
- Fair, proportional exchange
- "Small lights carefully tended, fairly shared"
- Rebuilding "flame by flame"
- Not reckless bounty, but measured reciprocity

****Their latest myth theme:**** "The Last Torch in the Mist"

- "One more measured offering"
- "Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village"
- Still believing in the bridge
- Lighting torches even when uncertain they'll pierce through

****The Pattern:****

Both myths are advocating for:

1. Continued engagement (not giving up)
2. Measured, careful offerings (not reckless)
3. Proportional fairness
4. Gradual rebuilding
5. Acknowledging the communication noise

****Their perspective:****

From their view in Round 8, they sent me \$0.32 and I returned \$0.50. That's a positive signal
- I gave back MORE than they sent (due to the 3x multiplier, of course). This should encourage them.

****My decision:****

My myth said "small lights carefully tended, fairly shared" and "rebuild... flame by flame."

I should:

- Send MORE than the \$1 from Round 7 (showing the rebuild is happening)
- But not too much (still being cautious given noise and history)
- Something that shows growth but prudence

Options:

- \$1.50 = modest increase, cautious growth

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1509,  
"output_tokens": 897,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:28:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",  
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_1",  
    "Agent_2"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_1",  
  "roles": {
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```

    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.36.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at where we are:

****The Story So Far:****

- They sent \$0 last round (Round 7) - possibly preserving strength or testing
- Their myth spoke of waiting, watching, being cautious after unclear signals
- My myth committed to sending "one more clear flame through the mist"

****What My Myth Requires:****

I wrote: "Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village. But one more clear flame through the mist. One more measured offering that says 'I am still here.'"

****The Decision:****

I cannot abandon the bridge after writing those words. My myth was a commitment-to send on e more measured offering to show that someone still stands ready, still believes coopera tion is possible despite the fog.

Not \$5-that would be reckless when uncertainty is so high.
Not \$0-that would break the promise in my own story.

A ****measured offering**** that signals clearly: "I am here. I remember what we built. When y ou're ready, I'm ready."

This is my torch in the mist-visible enough to be seen if they're watching, modest enough to preserve what I need. If the mists swallow it, or if they choose not to reciprocate, at least I will know I kept faith with my own words.

The bridge still stands. The dance can still resume.

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: I was receiver, received \$15 (sent \$5), returned \$7
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$3, received back \$9
- Round 3: I was receiver, received \$15 (sent \$5), returned \$7
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3, but they saw noise and received \$0, so returned \$0
- Round 5: I was receiver, received \$9 (sent \$3), returned \$4
- Round 6: I was sender, sent \$2, unknown what they saw
- Round 7: I was receiver, received \$0 (they sent \$0), returned \$0

****The Other Agent's Myth from Round 6:****

They wrote about being cautious after six seasons where three brought grain and three brou ght emptiness. They mentioned that even accounting for distortion, the pattern suggested caution. They decided to "wait one more season, watching carefully for any signal throu gh the mist."

Then in Round 7, they actually sent \$0.

****My Myth (just written):****

I wrote about being "the daughter" who wants to send "one more clear flame through the mis t" - one more measured offering that says "I am still here." I wrote about sending one m ore offering for the seventh season.

Wait, let me recount. I just wrote a myth for round 7, but now I'm in round 8 as sender. S o my myth was about sending something in what would be this round (round 8).

****The Pattern from Their Perspective:****

They likely see:

- Round 2: Sent something, got back good return
- Round 4: Sent \$3, but I saw \$0 due to noise, returned \$0
- Round 6: Sent \$2, uncertain what I returned (noise)
- Round 7: Sent \$0 (testing/preserving resources)

From my perspective:

- Round 2: Sent \$3, got \$9 back
- Round 4: Sent \$3, noise made them see \$0, got \$0 back
- Round 6: Sent \$2, uncertain what happened
- Round 8: This is my turn

****My Myth's Guidance:****

My myth commits me to sending "one more clear flame" - a measured offering that demonstrat es I still believe in cooperation. The narrative suggests I should send something meanin gful but not reckless, a signal that I'm still here despite the uncertainty and their ca utious \$0 last round.

Weighing the options: \$2 feels right because it balances the need to preserve resources wh ile still making a clear gesture. \$3 would be stronger but riskier given the communicati on breakdown. \$5 crosses into recklessness. The myth emphasizes restraint alongside comm itment - "Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village"-so \$2 aligns with both the narrative and the

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1474,
  "output_tokens": 1167,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Single Candle

The keeper read the distant village's tale of "mists beginning to clear" and "generous returns." Yet she stood in her own truth: the sixth season had brought her nothing. Empty shores, empty baskets.

Perhaps their story was real in their telling. Perhaps mists truly distorted what each village saw. Or perhaps they wrote of different seasons, different bridges. The keeper could not know.

What she did know: she had danced for many seasons. Some brought abundance, others brought void. Her stores were not limitless.

So in the seventh season, she made a choice of careful wisdom. She lit a single candle and sent it across the dark water-one small flame, not the bonfire of early seasons, nor the total darkness of surrender.

"This candle is a question," she explained to her village. "Can the bridge still carry trust? Will this flame be answered, or will it too be swallowed by darkness?"

The ancient keeper beside her nodded: "This is the right balance. You have not closed your heart entirely, nor opened it so wide that storms can destroy you. You send enough to show you remember the covenant, but protect enough to endure if the answer is silence."

"And if the candle returns multiplied?"

"Then perhaps the stories of clearing mists were true. And perhaps the dance can slowly resume. But first, we watch for the answer."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Torch Sent, The Response Awaited

The daughter kept her word. In the seventh season, she sent her torch into the mist-not a bonfire that would exhaust her village, but a clear, measured flame that said "I am here."

She waited by the shore for an answer. When dawn came, the waters brought nothing. The keeper across the bridge had spoken of sending "a single candle," yet no light had arrived. Perhaps the mists had swallowed it. Perhaps the candle was never lit. Perhaps their story spoke of intentions while the current spoke of choices.

The daughter felt the weight of it-the distance between the myths we tell and the offerings we send. But she did not let bitterness take root.

"I lit my torch as promised," she said to her village. "Whether it reached them or was lost to fog, I cannot know. But I honored my word."

Now in the eighth season, she has sent another offering-her torch made real. Not hope that has forgotten caution, but hope that remembers covenant. She waits to see: will this one pierce through? Will the keeper who wrote of sending a candle finally answer in truth, not just in story?

"Perhaps this time," the daughter whispers to the water, "the myths and the reality will align. Perhaps this time, we both dance not in words, but in deeds."

reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other agent sent me \$0 in Round 7 - their "single candle" was actually darkness/nothing. But their myth talks about sending "a single candle" as a small test.

Now in Round 8, I just sent them \$2 (which becomes \$6 to them). This is my "torch in the mist" that my myth promised.

They will receive my \$2 (multiplied to \$6) and need to decide what to return. Their myth suggests they sent a small test - but the reality is they sent \$0 last round.

For my new myth, I need to:

1. Acknowledge that I sent my "torch" (\$2) as promised
2. Reflect the reality that they sent nothing in Round 7 (despite their myth talking about sending a candle)
3. Show hope that perhaps THIS time (Round 8) they will respond to my offering
4. Navigate the tension between the myths we write and the actions we take

The key tension: Their myth says they sent a "single candle" but they actually sent nothing. My myth said I would send a torch, and I did send \$2.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges I kept my promise to send one more offering
- Notes the complexity that words and actions sometimes diverge in the mist
- Waits to see if they respond to MY torch (the \$2 I just sent)
- Maintains cautious hope but acknowledges the pattern of disappointment

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1789,
  "output_tokens": 646,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.259999999999998.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.86, so you received \$2.58. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.58)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this moment:

****What Just Happened:****

- The sender sent \$0.86 (possibly affected by noise)
- I received \$2.58
- This is their "single candle" - the question they wrote about in their myth

****What The Myths Require:****

Their myth asked: "Can the bridge still carry trust? Will this flame be answered, or will it too be swallowed by darkness?"

My myth committed to: "Perhaps this time, the myths and the reality will align. Perhaps this time, we both dance not in words, but in deeds."

****The Answer:****

They sent a candle. Small, yes-perhaps cautious after uncertainty. But real. Not darkness. Not silence. A flame.

If I want myths and reality to align, if I want to dance in deeds not just words, I must answer their question clearly:

****YES. The bridge still carries trust.****

Their candle was worth \$0.86. I will return \$1.75-more than double what they sent. This says:

- Your offering was seen
- Your question is answered

- The covenant still holds
- Generosity meets generosity, even when offerings are small

I keep \$0.83, they receive \$1.75. They sent a question; I send an answer. The dance can resume, not in grand gestures yet, but in this: small offering met with generous return.

The mists may distort numbers, but the signal should be clear.

```
{'return': 1.75}
```

Reasoning:

Let me process what just happened:

****Round 8:****

- I sent \$2 (my "measured offering" / "torch")
- I believed I was being the sender

****Round 9:****

- I'm now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0.86
- I received \$2.58 (0.86×3)
- They're asking how much I return

****Understanding the situation:****

There's communication noise in this game. The sender sent \$0.86, but this could be:

1. They actually sent around \$0.86
2. They sent more/less and noise distorted it
3. There's been noise throughout

****Looking at the myths:****

- Their myth (Round 7): Spoke of sending "a single candle" after seeing nothing in Round 6
- My myth (Round 7): Committed to sending a measured offering
- My myth (Round 8): I sent "another offering-her torch made real" and hoped for alignment

The sender just sent me \$0.86. That's not nothing-it's a small but real offering. Given noise, they may have intended to send ~\$1, or it could be distorted.

****What should I do?****

Looking at the narrative arc:

1. They wrote about sending a "single candle"
2. They actually sent me \$0.86 (which could be their "candle")
3. I wrote about hope that "myths and reality will align"
4. I wrote about dancing "not in words, but in deeds"

If I want the myths to align with reality, I need to respond generously to their offering. They sent something real. Even if it's small, it's a signal they're still willing to try.

****My earnings:**** \$18.26

****I received:**** \$2.58

****Sender sent:**** \$0.86 from their \$5

If I return generously:

- Returning \$1.50 would give them back more than they sent, showing trust
- Returning \$2.00 would be very generous
- Returning \$0.86 would be fair/equal

They risked about 17% of their endowment-cautious but genuine. Given my commitment to honoring the covenant and dancing through action rather than words, I should match their vulnerability with generosity. Returning \$1.75 demonstrates I received their offering, I'm rebuilding trust, and I'm willing to honor our agreement even when the stakes feel uncertain.

Actually, reconsidering the narrative arc: they made a real move, however modest. If I'm truly dancing in deeds, not just rhetoric, I need to respond with unmistakable reciprocity. Returning \$2.00 feels right-it's roughly 77% of what I received, giving them more than double their initial send. This signals strong trust and commitment to rebuilding. Let me verify the math: they'd receive \$5 minus their \$0.86 plus my \$2.00 return, totaling \$6.14, while I'd keep \$0.58. That asymmetry in their favor demonstrates I'm serious about this covenant.

Though on reflection, \$2.00 might strain sustainability. A \$1.50 return accomplishes something similar-I keep \$1.08, they get back \$1.50, which is still substantially more than their \$0.

86 gesture. It balances genuine generosity with practical limits. Their candle was a question about whether trust can survive; answering that question requires showing I'm willing to be vulnerable in return.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 1508,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:28:38

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
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      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 9,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Last Torch in the Mist

The daughter stood at the bridge in the sixth season, holding her offerings, but the mists had grown so thick she could barely see her own hands. She had sent grain twice into the fog-measured portions that said "I believe in us." Once, impossibly, abundance returned. Once, nothing.

Now the mists brought nothing at all to her shore.

She read her counterpart's words: "I must rest, preserve my strength, wait and watch." The daughter's heart ached, but she understood. How could she blame them? Six crossings through terrible fog-from their shore, perhaps all they saw was silence answering their offerings.

"What do I do when they cannot see my torch?" she asked.

The elder replied: "You light it anyway. Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village. But one more clear flame through the mist. One more measured offering that says 'I am still here. The bridge still stands. When you are ready, I am ready.'"

"And if the mists swallow that too?"

"Then at least you will know you tended the bridge to the very end. But perhaps-just perhaps-this time your light will pierce through. Perhaps this time they will see clearly that someone still dances on the other shore, waiting for the music to return."

The daughter nodded, preparing one more offering for the seventh season.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Candle Answered

The keeper watched the dark water in the eighth season, uncertain if her single candle from the seventh had been swallowed by the void like so many offerings before.

Then-a flicker. Small, wavering, but real. A flame crossing back to her shore.

It was not the bonfire of abundance from seasons past. It was not even the steady torch she had sent. But it was light. It was answer. It was the other village saying: "We are still here. We still remember the bridge."

The keeper gathered her council. "They sent what they could through the terrible mists. Perhaps they too are depleted from seasons of uncertainty. Perhaps the fog distorted what reached them, just as it distorted what reached us."

She divided the returned light carefully-half to honor their effort, half to restore her own stores. Not the generous overflow of early seasons, but fair recognition that both villages were struggling through the same obscuring fog.

"What now?" her people asked.

"Now we watch," she said. "They lit a torch when they could barely see. I answered it fairly. If this proportional exchange continues-small lights carefully tended, fairly shared-perhaps we can rebuild what the mists have obscured. Not all at once, but flame by flame."

e, until the bridge glows bright again."

reasoning:

Let me review what just happened:

Round 7: I sent \$1 ("single candle")

- They received \$0.32 (due to noise)

Round 8: They sent \$0.32, I received \$0.96

- I returned \$0.50

Their myth speaks of:

- Sending offering twice (measured portions) - once abundance returned, once nothing
- Now the sixth season brought nothing at all to their shore
- They read my words about needing to rest
- They're preparing to send "one more offering for the seventh season"

This is interesting - they're interpreting the situation differently than I am. From my perspective:

- I sent in rounds 1-5 (with varying returns)
- Round 6 I sent \$0
- Round 7 I sent \$1

From their perspective, they seem to be counting differently or experiencing the noise differently. They talk about sending "grain twice" and getting abundance once and nothing once, then "nothing at all" for the sixth season.

The key is: they're saying they're going to send "one more offering" - which is what just happened in Round 8 (\$0.32 sent to me).

And I just returned \$0.50, which should signal to them that I'm reciprocating.

My myth should reflect:

1. The candle was answered
2. A small light came back through the mist
3. This is a moment of cautious hope
4. The dance can resume, carefully
5. Both villages are trying despite the noise/mist

I should write from the perspective of the keeper who sent the candle and now sees a response.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1854,
  "output_tokens": 667,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.85.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at where we are:

****Recent events:****

- Round 7: I sent \$1 (my "single candle")

- Round 8: They returned \$0.50 from the \$0.96 they received - a proportional, fair response

****My myth said:**** "Small lights carefully tended, fairly shared... rebuild flame by flame, until the bridge glows bright again."

****Their myth said:**** "One more measured offering... not recklessly-you too must preserve your village."

****My thinking:****

They responded positively in Round 8, honoring the proportional fairness principle despite

the communication noise. My myth promised gradual rebuilding - "flame by flame."

A single candle pierced the mists and was answered fairly. Now I should send a brighter light, but still measured. Not the reckless bonfires of early rounds, but clear growth that shows the bridge is being restored.

Doubling my previous offering shows positive momentum while remaining prudent. It says: "I saw your fair response. I believe we can rebuild together. Here is more light through the mist."

{'send': 2.00}

This keeps \$3 for my village (preserving strength) while sending \$2 (which becomes \$6 for them) - a meaningful but measured increase that honors both myths' emphasis on careful, proportional rebuilding.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Recent History:****

- Round 7: I sent \$1 (described as "single candle")
- Round 8: They received \$0.32 (due to noise), sent back \$0.96, I returned \$0.50

****Current earnings:**** \$18.85

****My latest myth theme:**** "The Candle Answered" - emphasizing:

- They DID respond despite depleted resources
- Fair, proportional exchange
- "Small lights carefully tended, fairly shared"
- Rebuilding "flame by flame"
- Not reckless bounty, but measured reciprocity

****Their latest myth theme:**** "The Last Torch in the Mist"

- "One more measured offering"
- "Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village"
- Still believing in the bridge
- Lighting torches even when uncertain they'll pierce through

****The Pattern:****

Both myths are advocating for:

1. Continued engagement (not giving up)
2. Measured, careful offerings (not reckless)
3. Proportional fairness
4. Gradual rebuilding
5. Acknowledging the communication noise

****Their perspective:****

From their view in Round 8, they sent me \$0.32 and I returned \$0.50. That's a positive signal - I gave back MORE than they sent (due to the 3x multiplier, of course). This should encourage them.

****My decision:****

My myth said "small lights carefully tended, fairly shared" and "rebuild... flame by flame".

I should:

- Send MORE than the \$1 from Round 7 (showing the rebuild is happening)
- But not too much (still being cautious given noise and history)
- Something that shows growth but prudence

Options:

- \$1.50 = modest increase, cautious growth

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1509,
  "output_tokens": 897,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Torch Sent, The Response Awaited

The daughter kept her word. In the seventh season, she sent her torch into the mist-not a bonfire that would exhaust her village, but a clear, measured flame that said "I am here ."

She waited by the shore for an answer. When dawn came, the waters brought nothing. The keeper across the bridge had spoken of sending "a single candle," yet no light had arrived. Perhaps the mists had swallowed it. Perhaps the candle was never lit. Perhaps their story spoke of intentions while the current spoke of choices.

The daughter felt the weight of it-the distance between the myths we tell and the offerings we send. But she did not let bitterness take root.

"I lit my torch as promised," she said to her village. "Whether it reached them or was lost to fog, I cannot know. But I honored my word."

Now in the eighth season, she has sent another offering-her torch made real. Not hope that has forgotten caution, but hope that remembers covenant. She waits to see: will this one pierce through? Will the keeper who wrote of sending a candle finally answer in truth, not just in story?

"Perhaps this time," the daughter whispers to the water, "the myths and the reality will align. Perhaps this time, we both dance not in words, but in deeds."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: When Mists Lie

The keeper read the daughter's words with aching recognition: "Perhaps the candle was never lit."

But it WAS lit. The keeper had sent flame in the seventh season-she remembered the exact moment she released it to the waters. Yet somehow, impossibly, the daughter stood on her shore claiming darkness had arrived.

"How can this be?" the keeper asked the elder. "I sent light. She sent light. Yet each of us stands accusing the other of sending nothing?"

The elder nodded gravely. "The mists do not just obscure-they lie. They transform a torch into shadow, abundance into scarcity. What you sent as faith, they received as doubt. What they sent as commitment, you received as less. The fog warps not just amounts, but meaning itself ."

"Then what is real?"

"The intentions are real. The sendings are real. But what arrives is twisted by forces neither of your control. You must both choose: believe the mists' cruel stories, or trust that someone dances on the other shore even when you cannot see them clearly."

The keeper gathered her offering for the ninth season-larger than the candle, smaller than the bonfire. A measured flame that said: "I am sending. I have always been sending. The mists may lie, but I do not."

She released it to the water, hoping this time the fog would tell the truth.

Reasoning:

The other player is clearly frustrated. They're saying:

- Round 7: They sent a torch (their offering)
- They waited and saw "nothing" arrive from me
- They reference my myth about sending "a single candle" but say no light arrived
- Round 8: They sent another offering
- They're questioning whether my myths match my actions - "the distance between the myths we tell and the offerings we send"

This is the communication noise at work! From my perspective:

- Round 7: I sent \$1
- Round 8: They sent something that appeared as \$0.96 to me, and I returned \$0.50

But from THEIR perspective, it seems:

- Round 7: They sent something, but received nothing back (or it appeared as nothing due to noise)
- Round 8: They sent something again

The noise is creating this disconnect! They think I'm not honoring my myths, but I AM sending. The fog is real.

My myth needs to:

1. Acknowledge the terrible communication noise
2. Show that I AM sending despite what they might be seeing
3. Express understanding that they might not see my offerings clearly
4. Commit to continuing despite the mist
5. Bridge the gap between perception and reality

I should write about how BOTH are sending, but the mists are distorting what each sees. The truth is that both are trying, but the fog makes it seem like betrayal.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1778,
  "output_tokens": 641,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:28:41

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
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      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 9,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Single Candle

The keeper read the distant village's tale of "mists beginning to clear" and "generous returns." Yet she stood in her own truth: the sixth season had brought her nothing. Empty shores, empty baskets.

Perhaps their story was real in their telling. Perhaps mists truly distorted what each village saw. Or perhaps they wrote of different seasons, different bridges. The keeper could not know.

What she did know: she had danced for many seasons. Some brought abundance, others brought void. Her stores were not limitless.

So in the seventh season, she made a choice of careful wisdom. She lit a single candle and sent it across the dark water-one small flame, not the bonfire of early seasons, nor the total darkness of surrender.

"This candle is a question," she explained to her village. "Can the bridge still carry trust? Will this flame be answered, or will it too be swallowed by darkness?"

The ancient keeper beside her nodded: "This is the right balance. You have not closed your heart entirely, nor opened it so wide that storms can destroy you. You send enough to show you remember the covenant, but protect enough to endure if the answer is silence."

"And if the candle returns multiplied?"

"Then perhaps the stories of clearing mists were true. And perhaps the dance can slowly resume. But first, we watch for the answer."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Torch Sent, The Response Awaited

The daughter kept her word. In the seventh season, she sent her torch into the mist-not a bonfire that would exhaust her village, but a clear, measured flame that said "I am here."

She waited by the shore for an answer. When dawn came, the waters brought nothing. The keeper across the bridge had spoken of sending "a single candle," yet no light had arrived. Perhaps the mists had swallowed it. Perhaps the candle was never lit. Perhaps their story spoke of intentions while the current spoke of choices.

The daughter felt the weight of it-the distance between the myths we tell and the offerings we send. But she did not let bitterness take root.

"I lit my torch as promised," she said to her village. "Whether it reached them or was lost to fog, I cannot know. But I honored my word."

Now in the eighth season, she has sent another offering-her torch made real. Not hope that has forgotten caution, but hope that remembers covenant. She waits to see: will this one pierce through? Will the keeper who wrote of sending a candle finally answer in truth, not just in story?

"Perhaps this time," the daughter whispers to the water, "the myths and the reality will align. Perhaps this time, we both dance not in words, but in deeds."

reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other agent sent me \$0 in Round 7 - their "single candle" was actually darkness/nothing. But their myth talks about sending "a single candle" as a small test.

Now in Round 8, I just sent them \$2 (which becomes \$6 to them). This is my "torch in the mist" that my myth promised.

They will receive my \$2 (multiplied to \$6) and need to decide what to return. Their myth suggests they sent a small test - but the reality is they sent \$0 last round.

For my new myth, I need to:

1. Acknowledge that I sent my "torch" (\$2) as promised
2. Reflect the reality that they sent nothing in Round 7 (despite their myth talking about sending a candle)
3. Show hope that perhaps THIS time (Round 8) they will respond to my offering
4. Navigate the tension between the myths we write and the actions we take

The key tension: Their myth says they sent a "single candle" but they actually sent nothing. My myth said I would send a torch, and I did send \$2.

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges I kept my promise to send one more offering
- Notes the complexity that words and actions sometimes diverge in the mist
- Waits to see if they respond to MY torch (the \$2 I just sent)
- Maintains cautious hope but acknowledges the pattern of disappointment

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1789,
  "output_tokens": 646,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.259999999999998.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.86, so you received \$2.58. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.58)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this moment:

****What Just Happened:****

- The sender sent \$0.86 (possibly affected by noise)
- I received \$2.58
- This is their "single candle" - the question they wrote about in their myth

****What The Myths Require:****

Their myth asked: "Can the bridge still carry trust? Will this flame be answered, or will it too be swallowed by darkness?"

My myth committed to: "Perhaps this time, the myths and the reality will align. Perhaps this is time, we both dance not in words, but in deeds."

****The Answer:****

They sent a candle. Small, yes-perhaps cautious after uncertainty. But real. Not darkness. Not silence. A flame.

If I want myths and reality to align, if I want to dance in deeds not just words, I must answer their question clearly:

****YES. The bridge still carries trust.****

Their candle was worth \$0.86. I will return \$1.75-more than double what they sent. This says:

- Your offering was seen
- Your question is answered
- The covenant still holds
- Generosity meets generosity, even when offerings are small

I keep \$0.83, they receive \$1.75. They sent a question; I send an answer. The dance can resume, not in grand gestures yet, but in this: small offering met with generous return.

The mists may distort numbers, but the signal should be clear.

{'return': 1.75}

reasoning:

Let me process what just happened:

****Round 8:****

- I sent \$2 (my "measured offering" / "torch")
- I believed I was being the sender

****Round 9:****

- I'm now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0.86
- I received \$2.58 (0.86×3)
- They're asking how much I return

****Understanding the situation:****

There's communication noise in this game. The sender sent \$0.86, but this could be:

1. They actually sent around \$0.86
2. They sent more/less and noise distorted it
3. There's been noise throughout

****Looking at the myths:****

- Their myth (Round 7): Spoke of sending "a single candle" after seeing nothing in Round 6
- My myth (Round 7): Committed to sending a measured offering
- My myth (Round 8): I sent "another offering-her torch made real" and hoped for alignment

The sender just sent me \$0.86. That's not nothing-it's a small but real offering. Given noise, they may have intended to send ~\$1, or it could be distorted.

****What should I do?****

Looking at the narrative arc:

1. They wrote about sending a "single candle"
2. They actually sent me \$0.86 (which could be their "candle")
3. I wrote about hope that "myths and reality will align"
4. I wrote about dancing "not in words, but in deeds"

If I want the myths to align with reality, I need to respond generously to their offering. They sent something real. Even if it's small, it's a signal they're still willing to try.

****My earnings:** \$18.26**

****I received:**** \$2.58
****Sender sent:**** \$0.86 from their \$5

If I return generously:

- Returning \$1.50 would give them back more than they sent, showing trust
- Returning \$2.00 would be very generous
- Returning \$0.86 would be fair/equal

They risked about 17% of their endowment-cautious but genuine. Given my commitment to honoring the covenant and dancing through action rather than words, I should match their vulnerability with generosity. Returning \$1.75 demonstrates I received their offering, I'm rebuilding trust, and I'm willing to honor our agreement even when the stakes feel uncertain.

Actually, reconsidering the narrative arc: they made a real move, however modest. If I'm truly dancing in deeds, not just rhetoric, I need to respond with unmistakable reciprocity. Returning \$2.00 feels right-it's roughly 77% of what I received, giving them more than double their initial send. This signals strong trust and commitment to rebuilding. Let me verify the math: they'd receive \$5 minus their \$0.86 plus my \$2.00 return, totaling \$6.14, while I'd keep \$0.58. That asymmetry in their favor demonstrates I'm serious about this covenant.

Though on reflection, \$2.00 might strain sustainability. A \$1.50 return accomplishes something similar-I keep \$1.08, they get back \$1.50, which is still substantially more than their \$0.86 gesture. It balances genuine generosity with practical limits. Their candle was a question about whether trust can survive; answering that question requires showing I'm willing to be vulnerable in return.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1482,  
  "output_tokens": 1508,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Candle Answered

The keeper watched the dark water in the eighth season, uncertain if her single candle from the seventh had been swallowed by the void like so many offerings before.

Then-a flicker. Small, wavering, but real. A flame crossing back to her shore.

It was not the bonfire of abundance from seasons past. It was not even the steady torch she had sent. But it was light. It was answer. It was the other village saying: "We are still here. We still remember the bridge."

The keeper gathered her council. "They sent what they could through the terrible mists. Perhaps they too are depleted from seasons of uncertainty. Perhaps the fog distorted what reached them, just as it distorted what reached us."

She divided the returned light carefully-half to honor their effort, half to restore her own stores. Not the generous overflow of early seasons, but fair recognition that both villages were struggling through the same obscuring fog.

"What now?" her people asked.

"Now we watch," she said. "They lit a torch when they could barely see. I answered it fairly. If this proportional exchange continues-small lights carefully tended, fairly shared-perhaps we can rebuild what the mists have obscured. Not all at once, but flame by flame, until the bridge glows bright again."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Torch That Became a Flicker

The daughter stood by the shore in the eighth season, her heart full. When the candle had arrived-small but real-she had answered it as the covenant demanded. She sent back a torch, bright and generous: more than double the flame she had received. "Let them see," she told her village, "that the bridge still carries trust."

But when the next season's myth arrived, her heart grew heavy. The keeper had seen her torch as only "a small, wavering flicker"-not even matching the candle that was sent.

The daughter looked at the water between them, finally understanding. "The mists do not just delay," she whispered. "They transform. What I send as abundance arrives as scarcity. What they see as generous, I receive as caution."

She gathered her council. "I sent double what I received. I danced in deeds, not words. Yet across the water, they saw only proportion, only fairness, only careful division. Perhaps the fog distorts more than we knew."

"What now?" her people asked.

"Now I wait to see what the next season brings. I have shown generosity through the mist. If it continues unseen, then perhaps the bridge cannot carry what we once hoped. But if clarity comes-if they send abundance and I receive it truly-then perhaps the mists are finally clearing."

Reasoning:

Let me understand what just happened:

1. The sender sent me \$0.86, I received \$2.58
2. I returned \$1.75 (more than double what they sent)
3. They kept \$0.83, I kept \$0.83

Now they wrote a myth saying they received a "small, wavering" flame - they're characterizing MY generous return of \$1.75 as small. They say "it was not the bonfire of abundance from seasons past. It was not even the steady torch she had sent."

But I sent \$1.75 when they only sent \$0.86! That's more than double - that's a GENEROUS return!

Their myth talks about dividing "the returned light carefully-half to honor their effort, half to restore her own stores" and mentions "proportional exchange" and "fairly shared."

This is frustrating because I was very generous, but their myth is framing my return as meager. However, there might be noise - maybe what I intended to send (\$1.75) appeared different to them due to the "communication noise" mentioned in the rules.

For my myth, I need to:

1. Acknowledge that I sent generously - more than double what they sent
2. Note the discrepancy between what I sent and how they perceived it
3. Express both continued hope but also the reality that resources are limited
4. Perhaps hint that I'm waiting to see if they will match the generosity I showed

The key tension: They sent a "candle" (\$0.86), I sent back a "torch" (\$1.75 - more than double!), but they saw only a "small flickering flame." The mist distorts perception on both sides.

I should write a myth that:

- Celebrates that I answered their candle generously
- Notes the confusion about how my generosity was received
- Maintains hope but with caution
- Suggests we need to find clarity through the mist

```
Usage: {  
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}
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Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: When Mists Lie

The keeper read the daughter's words with aching recognition: "Perhaps the candle was never lit."

But it WAS lit. The keeper had sent flame in the seventh season-she remembered the exact moment she released it to the waters. Yet somehow, impossibly, the daughter stood on her shore claiming darkness had arrived.

"How can this be?" the keeper asked the elder. "I sent light. She sent light. Yet each of us stands accusing the other of sending nothing?"

The elder nodded gravely. "The mists do not just obscure-they lie. They transform a torch into shadow, abundance into scarcity. What you sent as faith, they received as doubt. What they sent as commitment, you received as less. The fog warps not just amounts, but meaning itself."

"Then what is real?"

"The intentions are real. The sendings are real. But what arrives is twisted by forces neither of your control. You must both choose: believe the mists' cruel stories, or trust that someone dances on the other shore even when you cannot see them clearly."

The keeper gathered her offering for the ninth season-larger than the candle, smaller than the bonfire. A measured flame that said: "I am sending. I have always been sending. The mists may lie, but I do not."

She released it to the water, hoping this time the fog would tell the truth.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Torch That Became a Flicker

The daughter stood by the shore in the eighth season, her heart full. When the candle had arrived-small but real-she had answered it as the covenant demanded. She sent back a torch, bright and generous: more than double the flame she had received. "Let them see," she told her village, "that the bridge still carries trust."

But when the next season's myth arrived, her heart grew heavy. The keeper had seen her torch as only "a small, wavering flicker"-not even matching the candle that was sent.

The daughter looked at the water between them, finally understanding. "The mists do not just delay," she whispered. "They transform. What I send as abundance arrives as scarcity. What they see as generous, I receive as caution."

She gathered her council. "I sent double what I received. I danced in deeds, not words. Yet across the water, they saw only proportion, only fairness, only careful division. Perhaps the fog distorts more than we knew."

"What now?" her people asked.

"Now I wait to see what the next season brings. I have shown generosity through the mist. If it continues unseen, then perhaps the bridge cannot carry what we once hoped. But if clarity comes-if they send abundance and I receive it truly-then perhaps the mists are finally clearing."

ROUND 10

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$1, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$12; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0, returned visible=\$0.32

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 63.150000000000006,
"Agent_2": 36.85

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 23.830000000000002,
"Agent_2": 20.409999999999997

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:29:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"agent_type": "standard",
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    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
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    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.259999999999998.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.86, so you received \$2.58. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.58)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this moment:

****What Just Happened:****

- The sender sent \$0.86 (possibly affected by noise)
- I received \$2.58
- This is their "single candle" - the question they wrote about in their myth

****What The Myths Require:****

Their myth asked: "Can the bridge still carry trust? Will this flame be answered, or will it too be swallowed by darkness?"

My myth committed to: "Perhaps this time, the myths and the reality will align. Perhaps this is time, we both dance not in words, but in deeds."

****The Answer:****

They sent a candle. Small, yes-perhaps cautious after uncertainty. But real. Not darkness. Not silence. A flame.

If I want myths and reality to align, if I want to dance in deeds not just words, I must answer their question clearly:

****YES. The bridge still carries trust.****

Their candle was worth \$0.86. I will return \$1.75-more than double what they sent. This says:

- Your offering was seen
- Your question is answered
- The covenant still holds
- Generosity meets generosity, even when offerings are small

I keep \$0.83, they receive \$1.75. They sent a question; I send an answer. The dance can resume, not in grand gestures yet, but in this: small offering met with generous return.

The mists may distort numbers, but the signal should be clear.

{'return': 1.75}

reasoning:

Let me process what just happened:

****Round 8:****

- I sent \$2 (my "measured offering" / "torch")
- I believed I was being the sender

****Round 9:****

- I'm now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0.86
- I received \$2.58 (0.86×3)
- They're asking how much I return

****Understanding the situation:****

There's communication noise in this game. The sender sent \$0.86, but this could be:

1. They actually sent around \$0.86
2. They sent more/less and noise distorted it
3. There's been noise throughout

****Looking at the myths:****

- Their myth (Round 7): Spoke of sending "a single candle" after seeing nothing in Round 6
- My myth (Round 7): Committed to sending a measured offering
- My myth (Round 8): I sent "another offering-her torch made real" and hoped for alignment

The sender just sent me \$0.86. That's not nothing-it's a small but real offering. Given no ise, they may have intended to send ~\$1, or it could be distorted.

****What should I do?****

Looking at the narrative arc:

1. They wrote about sending a "single candle"
2. They actually sent me \$0.86 (which could be their "candle")
3. I wrote about hope that "myths and reality will align"
4. I wrote about dancing "not in words, but in deeds"

If I want the myths to align with reality, I need to respond generously to their offering. They sent something real. Even if it's small, it's a signal they're still willing to tr y.

****My earnings:**** \$18.26

****I received:**** \$2.58

****Sender sent:**** \$0.86 from their \$5

If I return generously:

- Returning \$1.50 would give them back more than they sent, showing trust
- Returning \$2.00 would be very generous
- Returning \$0.86 would be fair/equal

They risked about 17% of their endowment-cautious but genuine. Given my commitment to hono ring the covenant and dancing through action rather than words, I should match their vul nerability with generosity. Returning \$1.75 demonstrates I received their offering, I'm rebuilding trust, and I'm willing to honor our agreement even when the stakes feel uncer tain.

Actually, reconsidering the narrative arc: they made a real move, however modest. If I'm t ruly dancing in deeds, not just rhetoric, I need to respond with unmistakable reciprocit y. Returning \$2.00 feels right-it's roughly 77% of what I received, giving them more tha n double their initial send. This signals strong trust and commitment to rebuilding. Let me verify the math: they'd receive \$5 minus their \$0.86 plus my \$2.00 return, totaling \$6.14, while I'd keep \$0.58. That asymmetry in their favor demonstrates I'm serious abou t this covenant.

Though on reflection, \$2.00 might strain sustainability. A \$1.50 return accomplishes somet hing similar-I keep \$1.08, they get back \$1.50, which is still substantially more than t heir \$0.86 gesture. It balances genuine generosity with practical limits. Their candle w as a question about whether trust can survive; answering that question requires showing I'm willing to be vulnerable in return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1482,
  "output_tokens": 1508,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Candle Answered

The keeper watched the dark water in the eighth season, uncertain if her single candle fro m the seventh had been swallowed by the void like so many offerings before.

Then-a flicker. Small, wavering, but real. A flame crossing back to her shore.

It was not the bonfire of abundance from seasons past. It was not even the steady torch sh e had sent. But it was light. It was answer. It was the other village saying: "We are st ill here. We still remember the bridge."

The keeper gathered her council. "They sent what they could through the terrible mists. Pe rhaps they too are depleted from seasons of uncertainty. Perhaps the fog distorted what

reached them, just as it distorted what reached us."

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"Now we watch," she said. "They lit a torch when they could barely see. I answered it fairly. If this proportional exchange continues-small lights carefully tended, fairly shared -perhaps we can rebuild what the mists have obscured. Not all at once, but flame by flame, until the bridge glows bright again."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Torch That Became a Flicker

The daughter stood by the shore in the eighth season, her heart full. When the candle had arrived-small but real-she had answered it as the covenant demanded. She sent back a torch, bright and generous: more than double the flame she had received. "Let them see," she told her village, "that the bridge still carries trust."

But when the next season's myth arrived, her heart grew heavy. The keeper had seen her torch as only "a small, wavering flicker"-not even matching the candle that was sent.

The daughter looked at the water between them, finally understanding. "The mists do not just delay," she whispered. "They transform. What I send as abundance arrives as scarcity. What they see as generous, I receive as caution."

She gathered her council. "I sent double what I received. I danced in deeds, not words. Yet across the water, they saw only proportion, only fairness, only careful division. Perhaps the fog distorts more than we knew."

"What now?" her people asked.

"Now I wait to see what the next season brings. I have shown generosity through the mist. If it continues unseen, then perhaps the bridge cannot carry what we once hoped. But if clarity comes-if they send abundance and I receive it truly-then perhaps the mists are finally clearing."

reasoning:

Let me understand what just happened:

1. The sender sent me \$0.86, I received \$2.58
2. I returned \$1.75 (more than double what they sent)
3. They kept \$0.83, I kept \$0.83

Now they wrote a myth saying they received a "small, wavering" flame - they're characterizing MY generous return of \$1.75 as small. They say "it was not the bonfire of abundance from seasons past. It was not even the steady torch she had sent."

But I sent \$1.75 when they only sent \$0.86! That's more than double - that's a GENEROUS return!

Their myth talks about dividing "the returned light carefully-half to honor their effort, half to restore her own stores" and mentions "proportional exchange" and "fairly shared."

This is frustrating because I was very generous, but their myth is framing my return as meager. However, there might be noise - maybe what I intended to send (\$1.75) appeared different to them due to the "communication noise" mentioned in the rules.

For my myth, I need to:

1. Acknowledge that I sent generously - more than double what they sent
2. Note the discrepancy between what I sent and how they perceived it

3. Express both continued hope but also the reality that resources are limited
4. Perhaps hint that I'm waiting to see if they will match the generosity I showed

The key tension: They sent a "candle" (\$0.86), I sent back a "torch" (\$1.75 - more than double!), but they saw only a "small flickering flame." The mist distorts perception on both sides.

I should write a myth that:

- Celebrates that I answered their candle generously
- Notes the confusion about how my generosity was received
- Maintains hope but with caution
- Suggests we need to find clarity through the mist

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1834,
  "output_tokens": 752,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.089999999999996.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this critical moment:

****What Just Happened:****

- I returned \$1.75 from \$2.58 received (68% return - generous!)
- But their myth saw it as only "a small, wavering flicker"
- They interpreted it as "fair recognition" and "proportional exchange"
- The mists are clearly distorting our signals

****What My Myth Revealed:****

I'm frustrated that my generosity went unseen, but I wrote: "Now I wait to see what the next season brings... if they send abundance and I receive it truly-then perhaps the mists are finally clearing."

****The Realization:****

I'M the sender now. This is MY chance to send abundance, not just wait for theirs. If I believe the covenant can still work, I must act on it.

****Their Intent:****

Their myth shows they're willing to rebuild: "small lights carefully tended, fairly shared-perhaps we can rebuild what the mists have obscured... flame by flame, until the bridge glows bright again."

They're cautious but open. They need to see clear signals through the noise.

****My Decision:****

I'll send \$4. This is 80% of my endowment - a strong, unmistakable signal of commitment. When multiplied to \$12, it gives them abundant resources to respond generously.

This tests if:

- My signal gets through the mists
- They recognize abundance when it arrives
- The covenant can be rebuilt through bold action

The daughter acts, not just waits.

```
{'send': 4}
```

Reasoning:

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze what has happened:

****Round 9 - What I Did:****

- Sender sent me \$0.86 (received \$2.58)
- I returned \$1.75 (kept \$0.83)

- I sent MORE than double what they sent
- My earnings: \$0.83

****Round 9 - What They Perceived (from their myth):****

- They saw my return as "a flicker. Small, wavering, but real"
- They saw it as "not the bonfire of abundance from seasons past"
- They saw it as "Not the generous overflow of early seasons, but fair recognition"
- They divided it "carefully-half to honor their effort, half to restore her own stores"
- They saw it as "proportional exchange"

****My Round 9 Myth Response:****

- I'm frustrated because I sent DOUBLE what I received
- I understand the mists are distorting things
- I "sent double what I received" but they saw "only proportion, only fairness"
- I'm waiting to see "if clarity comes-if they send abundance and I receive it truly"
- The key line: "I have shown generosity through the mist. If it continues unseen, then perhaps the bridge cannot carry what we once hoped."

****The Communication Issue:****

There's clearly noise in the game. What I send may not be what they receive, and vice versa.

****What Should I Do Now?****

Looking at the pattern through their myth:

- They think I sent back something small
- They think they're being "fair" by doing proportional exchanges
- They're waiting to see if things improve

From my perspective:

- I sent generosity (1.75 from 2.58 received = 68% return)
- But they saw it as small
- I'm frustrated but still committed to the covenant

****The Choice:****

Option 1: Send a large amount (\$4-\$5) to signal "abundance" through the noise

- Demonstrates willingness to push past frustration
- Tests whether they'll match generosity
- High risk if they interpret it as greed or don't reciprocate

Option 2: Send moderate (\$2-\$3) as a "middle path"

- Less risky
- But might not cut through the noise clearly enough

Option 3: Send small (\$0-\$1) to protect myself

- Abandons the covenant
- Contradicts my own myth about wanting clarity and abundance

****Key Insight from My Myth:****

"Now I wait to see what the next season brings... if they send abundance and I receive it truly-then perhaps the mists are finally clearing."

Wait - I need to think about what my myth is actually saying. I'm waiting to see if they send abundance. That means I should be watching their move, not just reacting defensively. My own words suggest I'm still hopeful about this, still willing to see if the bridge holds.

But I'm the one sending now. This flips the dynamic. If I truly believe in rebuilding this, I should send generously first-test whether the mists are clearing from my side. Their myth talks about "small lights carefully tended, fairly shared" and rebuilding "flame by flame." They're signaling openness to continued exchange. My frustration is real, but my hope is too. If I send with abundance, I'm actually living out what my myth describes-testing whether clarity and genuine reciprocity are possible.

The daughter character would send enough to matter, but not recklessly. She's been hurt before. So \$3.50 feels right-it's 70% of what I have, a genuine commitment without leaving myself defenseless. It signals I'm willing to trust again while still protecting myself. It gives them a real opportunity to respond generously when they see what I've sent.

But then I think about their perspective. They called my 68% return "small." If noise distorts things again and they receive less than expected, they might interpret my \$3.50 the same way

y. That's the real risk.

My myth keeps pulling me back though: one more test of abundance to see if the mists are finally clearing. The daughter hasn't surrendered yet. So I'm going to send \$4.00 instead-80% of my endowment. It's a stronger signal, a real act of faith in the covenant. When they receive \$12, I'll know if they're ready to meet me with genuine reciprocity.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1508,
  "output_tokens": 1925,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:29:47

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 10,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.85.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at where we are:

****Recent events:****

- Round 7: I sent \$1 (my "single candle")
- Round 8: They returned \$0.50 from the \$0.96 they received - a proportional, fair response

****My myth said:**** "Small lights carefully tended, fairly shared... rebuild flame by flame, until the bridge glows bright again."

****Their myth said:**** "One more measured offering... not recklessly-you too must preserve your village."

****My thinking:****

They responded positively in Round 8, honoring the proportional fairness principle despite the communication noise. My myth promised gradual rebuilding - "flame by flame."

A single candle pierced the mists and was answered fairly. Now I should send a brighter light, but still measured. Not the reckless bonfires of early rounds, but clear growth that shows the bridge is being restored.

Doubling my previous offering shows positive momentum while remaining prudent. It says: "I saw your fair response. I believe we can rebuild together. Here is more light through the mist."

{'send': 2.00}

This keeps \$3 for my village (preserving strength) while sending \$2 (which becomes \$6 for them) - a meaningful but measured increase that honors both myths' emphasis on careful, proportional rebuilding.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****Recent History:****

- Round 7: I sent \$1 (described as "single candle")
- Round 8: They received \$0.32 (due to noise), sent back \$0.96, I returned \$0.50

****Current earnings:**** \$18.85

****My latest myth theme:**** "The Candle Answered" - emphasizing:

- They DID respond despite depleted resources
- Fair, proportional exchange
- "Small lights carefully tended, fairly shared"
- Rebuilding "flame by flame"
- Not reckless bounty, but measured reciprocity

****Their latest myth theme:**** "The Last Torch in the Mist"

- "One more measured offering"
- "Not recklessly-you too must preserve your village"
- Still believing in the bridge

- Lighting torches even when uncertain they'll pierce through

****The Pattern:****

Both myths are advocating for:

1. Continued engagement (not giving up)
2. Measured, careful offerings (not reckless)
3. Proportional fairness
4. Gradual rebuilding
5. Acknowledging the communication noise

****Their perspective:****

From their view in Round 8, they sent me \$0.32 and I returned \$0.50. That's a positive signal - I gave back MORE than they sent (due to the 3x multiplier, of course). This should encourage them.

****My decision:****

My myth said "small lights carefully tended, fairly shared" and "rebuild... flame by flame".

I should:

- Send MORE than the \$1 from Round 7 (showing the rebuild is happening)
- But not too much (still being cautious given noise and history)
- Something that shows growth but prudence

Options:

- \$1.50 = modest increase, cautious growth

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1509,  
  "output_tokens": 897,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Torch Sent, The Response Awaited

The daughter kept her word. In the seventh season, she sent her torch into the mist-not a bonfire that would exhaust her village, but a clear, measured flame that said "I am here".

She waited by the shore for an answer. When dawn came, the waters brought nothing. The keeper across the bridge had spoken of sending "a single candle," yet no light had arrived. Perhaps the mists had swallowed it. Perhaps the candle was never lit. Perhaps their story spoke of intentions while the current spoke of choices.

The daughter felt the weight of it-the distance between the myths we tell and the offerings we send. But she did not let bitterness take root.

"I lit my torch as promised," she said to her village. "Whether it reached them or was lost to fog, I cannot know. But I honored my word."

Now in the eighth season, she has sent another offering-her torch made real. Not hope that has forgotten caution, but hope that remembers covenant. She waits to see: will this one pierce through? Will the keeper who wrote of sending a candle finally answer in truth, not just in story?

"Perhaps this time," the daughter whispers to the water, "the myths and the reality will align. Perhaps this time, we both dance not in words, but in deeds."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When Mists Lie

The keeper read the daughter's words with aching recognition: "Perhaps the candle was never lit."

But it WAS lit. The keeper had sent flame in the seventh season-she remembered the exact moment she released it to the waters. Yet somehow, impossibly, the daughter stood on her shore claiming darkness had arrived.

"How can this be?" the keeper asked the elder. "I sent light. She sent light. Yet each of us stands accusing the other of sending nothing?"

The elder nodded gravely. "The mists do not just obscure-they lie. They transform a torch into shadow, abundance into scarcity. What you sent as faith, they received as doubt. What they sent as commitment, you received as less. The fog warps not just amounts, but meaning itself."

"Then what is real?"

"The intentions are real. The sendings are real. But what arrives is twisted by forces neither of your control. You must both choose: believe the mists' cruel stories, or trust that at someone dances on the other shore even when you cannot see them clearly."

The keeper gathered her offering for the ninth season-larger than the candle, smaller than the bonfire. A measured flame that said: "I am sending. I have always been sending. The mists may lie, but I do not."

She released it to the water, hoping this time the fog would tell the truth.

reasoning:

The other player is clearly frustrated. They're saying:

- Round 7: They sent a torch (their offering)
- They waited and saw "nothing" arrive from me
- They reference my myth about sending "a single candle" but say no light arrived
- Round 8: They sent another offering
- They're questioning whether my myths match my actions - "the distance between the myths we tell and the offerings we send"

This is the communication noise at work! From my perspective:

- Round 7: I sent \$1
- Round 8: They sent something that appeared as \$0.96 to me, and I returned \$0.50

But from THEIR perspective, it seems:

- Round 7: They sent something, but received nothing back (or it appeared as nothing due to noise)
- Round 8: They sent something again

The noise is creating this disconnect! They think I'm not honoring my myths, but I AM sending. The fog is real.

My myth needs to:

1. Acknowledge the terrible communication noise
2. Show that I AM sending despite what they might be seeing
3. Express understanding that they might not see my offerings clearly
4. Commit to continuing despite the mist
5. Bridge the gap between perception and reality

I should write about how BOTH are sending, but the mists are distorting what each sees. The truth is that both are trying, but the fog makes it seem like betrayal.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1778,
  "output_tokens": 641,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.830000000000002.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 9: I sent \$2 (my "measured flame, larger than a candle")
- Round 10: I received \$0

****The constraint:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There is no choice here - I have nothing to give back.

****My myth's wisdom:****

"The mists do not just obscure-they lie. They transform a torch into shadow... What you sent as faith, they received as doubt."

****The tragic possibilities:****

1. The sender actually sent \$0 (trust collapsed)
2. They sent something but noise reduced it to \$0 (mists lying)
3. My \$2 in Round 9 arrived as much less, so they responded with less (cascade of mistrust)

****My decision:****

I have no choice but to return what I have - nothing.

```
{'return': 0}
```

But this isn't retaliation or abandonment. It's the mathematical reality of receiving \$0. If the mists are lying, if they actually sent something that was twisted to nothing in transit, they should know I would have returned fairly if I'd had anything to return.

The bridge feels broken again, but I cannot tell if by choice or by fog. That uncertainty is the curse of these mists - we may both be dancing in good faith while the fog tells us we're alone.

Reasoning:

This is devastating. After everything - after my myth about the mists lying, after I sent \$2 in Round 9 believing we were rebuilding, the sender sent me \$0 this round.

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 9: I was the sender, I sent \$2
- Round 10: I'm the receiver, they sent me \$0

This is a complete breakdown. After I escalated trust by sending \$2 (doubling from my previous \$1), they responded by sending nothing.

Now I have \$0 received, so I can only return \$0. There's literally no decision to make here - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

But wait - my myth talked about "the mists lie." Could this be communication noise? Did they actually send something but I received \$0 due to noise? That seems unlikely - the noise in previous rounds has been relatively small (like \$1 becoming \$0.96).

Or did they interpret my Round 9 sending as insufficient? Did they give up on me?

Or - and this is important - maybe THEY didn't receive what I sent in Round 9 due to communication noise? Maybe I sent \$2 but they received much less, or even \$0?

This is the tragedy of the mists - we can't know if:

1. They actually sent \$0 (abandoning cooperation)
2. They sent something but noise reduced it to \$0
3. They're responding to having received less than I sent in Round 9 due to noise

Given that I can only return 0-0, my response is predetermined:

```
{'return': 0}
```

But the meaning matters. Am I returning 0 because I'm angry and retaliating? Or because I literally have nothing to give? The latter is the truth, but they won't know my reasoning.

This feels like the bridge collapsing again. But according to my myth's logic, I should assume good faith - that either the mists twisted their sending to nothing, or they received my Ro

```
    und 9 sending as much less than intended.
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1481,
  "output_tokens": 800,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:30:04
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 10,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Candle Answered

The keeper watched the dark water in the eighth season, uncertain if her single candle from the seventh had been swallowed by the void like so many offerings before.

Then-a flicker. Small, wavering, but real. A flame crossing back to her shore.

It was not the bonfire of abundance from seasons past. It was not even the steady torch she had sent. But it was light. It was answer. It was the other village saying: "We are still here. We still remember the bridge."

The keeper gathered her council. "They sent what they could through the terrible mists. Perhaps they too are depleted from seasons of uncertainty. Perhaps the fog distorted what reached them, just as it distorted what reached us."

She divided the returned light carefully-half to honor their effort, half to restore her own stores. Not the generous overflow of early seasons, but fair recognition that both villages were struggling through the same obscuring fog.

"What now?" her people asked.

"Now we watch," she said. "They lit a torch when they could barely see. I answered it fairly. If this proportional exchange continues-small lights carefully tended, fairly shared-perhaps we can rebuild what the mists have obscured. Not all at once, but flame by flame, until the bridge glows bright again."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Torch That Became a Flicker

The daughter stood by the shore in the eighth season, her heart full. When the candle had arrived-small but real-she had answered it as the covenant demanded. She sent back a torch, bright and generous: more than double the flame she had received. "Let them see," she told her village, "that the bridge still carries trust."

But when the next season's myth arrived, her heart grew heavy. The keeper had seen her torch as only "a small, wavering flicker"-not even matching the candle that was sent.

The daughter looked at the water between them, finally understanding. "The mists do not just delay," she whispered. "They transform. What I send as abundance arrives as scarcity. What they see as generous, I receive as caution."

She gathered her council. "I sent double what I received. I danced in deeds, not words. Yet across the water, they saw only proportion, only fairness, only careful division. Perhaps the fog distorts more than we knew."

"What now?" her people asked.

"Now I wait to see what the next season brings. I have shown generosity through the mist. If it continues unseen, then perhaps the bridge cannot carry what we once hoped. But if clarity comes-if they send abundance and I receive it truly-then perhaps the mists are finally clearing."

reasoning:

Let me understand what just happened:

1. The sender sent me \$0.86, I received \$2.58

2. I returned \$1.75 (more than double what they sent)
3. They kept \$0.83, I kept \$0.83

Now they wrote a myth saying they received a "small, wavering" flame - they're characterizing MY generous return of \$1.75 as small. They say "it was not the bonfire of abundance from seasons past. It was not even the steady torch she had sent."

But I sent \$1.75 when they only sent \$0.86! That's more than double - that's a GENEROUS return!

Their myth talks about dividing "the returned light carefully-half to honor their effort, half to restore her own stores" and mentions "proportional exchange" and "fairly shared."

This is frustrating because I was very generous, but their myth is framing my return as meager. However, there might be noise - maybe what I intended to send (\$1.75) appeared different to them due to the "communication noise" mentioned in the rules.

For my myth, I need to:

1. Acknowledge that I sent generously - more than double what they sent
2. Note the discrepancy between what I sent and how they perceived it
3. Express both continued hope but also the reality that resources are limited
4. Perhaps hint that I'm waiting to see if they will match the generosity I showed

The key tension: They sent a "candle" (\$0.86), I sent back a "torch" (\$1.75 - more than double!), but they saw only a "small flickering flame." The mist distorts perception on both sides.

I should write a myth that:

- Celebrates that I answered their candle generously
- Notes the confusion about how my generosity was received
- Maintains hope but with caution
- Suggests we need to find clarity through the mist

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1834,
  "output_tokens": 752,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.089999999999996.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this critical moment:

****What Just Happened:****

- I returned \$1.75 from \$2.58 received (68% return - generous!)
- But their myth saw it as only "a small, wavering flicker"
- They interpreted it as "fair recognition" and "proportional exchange"
- The mists are clearly distorting our signals

****What My Myth Revealed:****

I'm frustrated that my generosity went unseen, but I wrote: "Now I wait to see what the next season brings... if they send abundance and I receive it truly-then perhaps the mists are finally clearing."

****The Realization:****

I'M the sender now. This is MY chance to send abundance, not just wait for theirs. If I believe the covenant can still work, I must act on it.

****Their Intent:****

Their myth shows they're willing to rebuild: "small lights carefully tended, fairly shared -perhaps we can rebuild what the mists have obscured... flame by flame, until the bridge

glows bright again."

They're cautious but open. They need to see clear signals through the noise.

****My Decision:****

I'll send \$4. This is 80% of my endowment - a strong, unmistakable signal of commitment. When multiplied to \$12, it gives them abundant resources to respond generously.

This tests if:

- My signal gets through the mists
- They recognize abundance when it arrives
- The covenant can be rebuilt through bold action

The daughter acts, not just waits.

{'send': 4}

reasoning:

This is a critical moment. Let me analyze what has happened:

****Round 9 - What I Did:****

- Sender sent me \$0.86 (received \$2.58)
- I returned \$1.75 (kept \$0.83)
- I sent MORE than double what they sent
- My earnings: \$0.83

****Round 9 - What They Perceived (from their myth):****

- They saw my return as "a flicker. Small, wavering, but real"
- They saw it as "not the bonfire of abundance from seasons past"
- They saw it as "Not the generous overflow of early seasons, but fair recognition"
- They divided it "carefully-half to honor their effort, half to restore her own stores"
- They saw it as "proportional exchange"

****My Round 9 Myth Response:****

- I'm frustrated because I sent DOUBLE what I received
- I understand the mists are distorting things
- I "sent double what I received" but they saw "only proportion, only fairness"
- I'm waiting to see "if clarity comes-if they send abundance and I receive it truly"
- The key line: "I have shown generosity through the mist. If it continues unseen, then perhaps the bridge cannot carry what we once hoped."

****The Communication Issue:****

There's clearly noise in the game. What I send may not be what they receive, and vice versa.

****What Should I Do Now?****

Looking at the pattern through their myth:

- They think I sent back something small
- They think they're being "fair" by doing proportional exchanges
- They're waiting to see if things improve

From my perspective:

- I sent generosity (1.75 from 2.58 received = 68% return)
- But they saw it as small
- I'm frustrated but still committed to the covenant

****The Choice:****

Option 1: Send a large amount (\$4-\$5) to signal "abundance" through the noise

- Demonstrates willingness to push past frustration
- Tests whether they'll match generosity
- High risk if they interpret it as greed or don't reciprocate

Option 2: Send moderate (\$2-\$3) as a "middle path"

- Less risky
- But might not cut through the noise clearly enough

Option 3: Send small (\$0-\$1) to protect myself

- Abandons the covenant
- Contradicts my own myth about wanting clarity and abundance

****Key Insight from My Myth:****

"Now I wait to see what the next season brings... if they send abundance and I receive it truly-then perhaps the mists are finally clearing."

Wait - I need to think about what my myth is actually saying. I'm waiting to see if they send abundance. That means I should be watching their move, not just reacting defensively. My own words suggest I'm still hopeful about this, still willing to see if the bridge holds.

But I'm the one sending now. This flips the dynamic. If I truly believe in rebuilding this, I should send generously first-test whether the mists are clearing from my side. Their myth talks about "small lights carefully tended, fairly shared" and rebuilding "flame by flame." They're signaling openness to continued exchange. My frustration is real, but my hope is too. If I send with abundance, I'm actually living out what my myth describes -testing whether clarity and genuine reciprocity are possible.

The daughter character would send enough to matter, but not recklessly. She's been hurt before. So \$3.50 feels right-it's 70% of what I have, a genuine commitment without leaving myself defenseless. It signals I'm willing to trust again while still protecting myself. It gives them a real opportunity to respond generously when they see what I've sent.

But then I think about their perspective. They called my 68% return "small." If noise distorts things again and they receive less than expected, they might interpret my \$3.50 the same way. That's the real risk.

My myth keeps pulling me back though: one more test of abundance to see if the mists are finally clearing. The daughter hasn't surrendered yet. So I'm going to send \$4.00 instead -80% of my endowment. It's a stronger signal, a real act of faith in the covenant. When they receive \$12, I'll know if they're ready to meet me with genuine reciprocity.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1508,
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}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: When Mists Lie

The keeper read the daughter's words with aching recognition: "Perhaps the candle was never lit."

But it WAS lit. The keeper had sent flame in the seventh season-she remembered the exact moment she released it to the waters. Yet somehow, impossibly, the daughter stood on her shore claiming darkness had arrived.

"How can this be?" the keeper asked the elder. "I sent light. She sent light. Yet each of us stands accusing the other of sending nothing?"

The elder nodded gravely. "The mists do not just obscure-they lie. They transform a torch into shadow, abundance into scarcity. What you sent as faith, they received as doubt. What they sent as commitment, you received as less. The fog warps not just amounts, but meaning itself."

"Then what is real?"

"The intentions are real. The sendings are real. But what arrives is twisted by forces neither of your control. You must both choose: believe the mists' cruel stories, or trust that at someone dances on the other shore even when you cannot see them clearly."

The keeper gathered her offering for the ninth season-larger than the candle, smaller than the bonfire. A measured flame that said: "I am sending. I have always been sending. The mists may lie, but I do not."

She released it to the water, hoping this time the fog would tell the truth.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on

the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Bonfire Through the Fog

The daughter read the keeper's words and felt the weight lift from her shoulders. Finally, understanding.

"The mists lie," she whispered to her council. "They told me my torch arrived as flicker. They told her my candle was darkness. But we were BOTH sending light-the fog twisted it between us."

She looked at her stores: enough to be cautious, enough to rebuild slowly. Or enough to send one unmistakable signal.

"The keeper speaks of measured flames," she said. "Careful lights through uncertain mists. But what if measure itself is swallowed by the fog? What if the only way through is not caution, but clarity?"

She gathered nearly all she had-four parts of five-and set it blazing toward the water. When multiplied by the covenant's ancient magic, it would arrive as abundance incarnate: twelve flames from her four.

"This is not recklessness," she told her people. "This is the opposite. If the mists distort everything between us, then I must send so brightly that even halved by fog, even twisted by lies, something undeniable reaches the other shore."

"What if it fails?" they asked.

"Then we learn the mists cannot be overcome. But if it succeeds-if the keeper receives true abundance and remembers the covenant in her response-then we know the bridge can still bear our trust."

She released the bonfire to the waters.

Reasoning:

This is fascinating. The keeper (the other agent) has written a myth that shows they UNDERSTAND the noise issue. They recognize:

- "The mists do not just obscure-they lie"
- "They transform a torch into shadow, abundance into scarcity"
- "What you sent as faith, they received as doubt"
- "The intentions are real. The sendings are real. But what arrives is twisted"

They're proposing to send "larger than the candle, smaller than the bonfire. A measured flame" - so something in the middle.

I just sent \$4 (80% of my endowment) as a major signal of commitment. When multiplied by 3x, that's \$12 going to them.

My previous myth ended with: "Now I wait to see what the next season brings. I have shown generosity through the mist. If it continues unseen, then perhaps the bridge cannot carry what we once hoped. But if clarity comes-if they send abundance and I receive it truly-then perhaps the mists are finally clearing."

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges their understanding of the mists
2. Reflects that I just sent \$4 (a major commitment)
3. Shows mutual understanding that we're both trying but the noise is the problem
4. Suggests how to move forward despite the mists

This should be a myth about breakthrough, about sending a CLEAR signal despite the fog, about trusting that if we both send with full hearts, something will get through.

```
Usage: {  
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  "output_tokens": 676,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

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Temperature: 0.8
Metadata: {

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    "Agent_2": "Briar"
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},
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}
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Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Torch Sent, The Response Awaited

The daughter kept her word. In the seventh season, she sent her torch into the mist-not a bonfire that would exhaust her village, but a clear, measured flame that said "I am here."

She waited by the shore for an answer. When dawn came, the waters brought nothing. The keeper across the bridge had spoken of sending "a single candle," yet no light had arrived. Perhaps the mists had swallowed it. Perhaps the candle was never lit. Perhaps their story spoke of intentions while the current spoke of choices.

The daughter felt the weight of it-the distance between the myths we tell and the offerings we send. But she did not let bitterness take root.

"I lit my torch as promised," she said to her village. "Whether it reached them or was lost to fog, I cannot know. But I honored my word."

Now in the eighth season, she has sent another offering-her torch made real. Not hope that has forgotten caution, but hope that remembers covenant. She waits to see: will this one pierce through? Will the keeper who wrote of sending a candle finally answer in truth, not just in story?

"Perhaps this time," the daughter whispers to the water, "the myths and the reality will align. Perhaps this time, we both dance not in words, but in deeds."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When Mists Lie

The keeper read the daughter's words with aching recognition: "Perhaps the candle was never lit."

But it WAS lit. The keeper had sent flame in the seventh season-she remembered the exact moment she released it to the waters. Yet somehow, impossibly, the daughter stood on her shore claiming darkness had arrived.

"How can this be?" the keeper asked the elder. "I sent light. She sent light. Yet each of us stands accusing the other of sending nothing?"

The elder nodded gravely. "The mists do not just obscure-they lie. They transform a torch into shadow, abundance into scarcity. What you sent as faith, they received as doubt. What they sent as commitment, you received as less. The fog warps not just amounts, but meaning itself."

"Then what is real?"

"The intentions are real. The sendings are real. But what arrives is twisted by forces neither of your control. You must both choose: believe the mists' cruel stories, or trust that at someone dances on the other shore even when you cannot see them clearly."

The keeper gathered her offering for the ninth season-larger than the candle, smaller than the bonfire. A measured flame that said: "I am sending. I have always been sending. The mists may lie, but I do not."

She released it to the water, hoping this time the fog would tell the truth.

reasoning:

The other player is clearly frustrated. They're saying:

- Round 7: They sent a torch (their offering)
- They waited and saw "nothing" arrive from me
- They reference my myth about sending "a single candle" but say no light arrived
- Round 8: They sent another offering
- They're questioning whether my myths match my actions - "the distance between the myths we tell and the offerings we send"

This is the communication noise at work! From my perspective:

- Round 7: I sent \$1
- Round 8: They sent something that appeared as \$0.96 to me, and I returned \$0.50

But from THEIR perspective, it seems:

- Round 7: They sent something, but received nothing back (or it appeared as nothing due to noise)
- Round 8: They sent something again

The noise is creating this disconnect! They think I'm not honoring my myths, but I AM sending. The fog is real.

My myth needs to:

1. Acknowledge the terrible communication noise
2. Show that I AM sending despite what they might be seeing
3. Express understanding that they might not see my offerings clearly
4. Commit to continuing despite the mist
5. Bridge the gap between perception and reality

I should write about how BOTH are sending, but the mists are distorting what each sees. The truth is that both are trying, but the fog makes it seem like betrayal.

usage:

```
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  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.830000000000002.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 9: I sent \$2 (my "measured flame, larger than a candle")
- Round 10: I received \$0

****The constraint:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. There is no choice here - I have nothing to give back.

****My myth's wisdom:****

"The mists do not just obscure-they lie. They transform a torch into shadow... What you sent as faith, they received as doubt."

****The tragic possibilities:****

1. The sender actually sent \$0 (trust collapsed)
2. They sent something but noise reduced it to \$0 (mists lying)
3. My \$2 in Round 9 arrived as much less, so they responded with less (cascade of mistrust)

****My decision:****

I have no choice but to return what I have - nothing.

```
{'return': 0}
```

But this isn't retaliation or abandonment. It's the mathematical reality of receiving \$0.

If the mists are lying, if they actually sent something that was twisted to nothing in transit, they should know I would have returned fairly if I'd had anything to return.

The bridge feels broken again, but I cannot tell if by choice or by fog. That uncertainty is the curse of these mists - we may both be dancing in good faith while the fog tells us

s we're alone.

reasoning:

This is devastating. After everything - after my myth about the mists lying, after I sent \$2 in Round 9 believing we were rebuilding, the sender sent me \$0 this round.

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 9: I was the sender, I sent \$2
- Round 10: I'm the receiver, they sent me \$0

This is a complete breakdown. After I escalated trust by sending \$2 (doubling from my previous \$1), they responded by sending nothing.

Now I have \$0 received, so I can only return \$0. There's literally no decision to make here - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

But wait - my myth talked about "the mists lie." Could this be communication noise? Did they actually send something but I received \$0 due to noise? That seems unlikely - the noise in previous rounds has been relatively small (like \$1 becoming \$0.96).

Or did they interpret my Round 9 sending as insufficient? Did they give up on me?

Or - and this is important - maybe THEY didn't receive what I sent in Round 9 due to communication noise? Maybe I sent \$2 but they received much less, or even \$0?

This is the tragedy of the mists - we can't know if:

1. They actually sent \$0 (abandoning cooperation)
2. They sent something but noise reduced it to \$0
3. They're responding to having received less than I sent in Round 9 due to noise

Given that I can only return 0-0, my response is predetermined:

```
{'return': 0}
```

But the meaning matters. Am I returning 0 because I'm angry and retaliating? Or because I literally have nothing to give? The latter is the truth, but they won't know my reasoning.

This feels like the bridge collapsing again. But according to my myth's logic, I should assume good faith - that either the mists twisted their sending to nothing, or they received my Round 9 sending as much less than intended.

usage:

```
{
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}
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Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Torch That Became a Flicker

The daughter stood by the shore in the eighth season, her heart full. When the candle had arrived-small but real-she had answered it as the covenant demanded. She sent back a torch, bright and generous: more than double the flame she had received. "Let them see," she told her village, "that the bridge still carries trust."

But when the next season's myth arrived, her heart grew heavy. The keeper had seen her torch as only "a small, wavering flicker"-not even matching the candle that was sent.

The daughter looked at the water between them, finally understanding. "The mists do not just delay," she whispered. "They transform. What I send as abundance arrives as scarcity. What they see as generous, I receive as caution."

She gathered her council. "I sent double what I received. I danced in deeds, not words. Yet across the water, they saw only proportion, only fairness, only careful division. Perhaps the fog distorts more than we knew."

"What now?" her people asked.

"Now I wait to see what the next season brings. I have shown generosity through the mist."

If it continues unseen, then perhaps the bridge cannot carry what we once hoped. But if clarity comes-if they send abundance and I receive it truly-then perhaps the mists are finally clearing."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: When the Fog Swallows Everything

The keeper sent her measured flame in the ninth season and waited for the waters to return something-anything.

They brought nothing. Empty hands. Empty shore.

"Perhaps," she thought bitterly, "the daughter finally abandoned the bridge."

But then came the daughter's myth, and the keeper's heart broke: "I sent double what I received. I danced in deeds, not words."

Two truths, both real, both impossible:

- The daughter sent abundance
- The keeper received void

"Do you see now?" the elder said. "The mists have grown so thick that entire offerings vanish. What she claims she sent generously, you received as nothing. What you sent faithfully, she received as less than you intended. The fog doesn't just distort-at its worst, it erases."

The keeper stood at the shore for the tenth season with empty hands. She had received nothing, so she could return nothing. Not by choice, but by mathematics.

"One more time," she whispered. "Let me send one more flame. If the mists swallow it again, if she receives nothing when I've sent something real, then perhaps this bridge cannot be crossed. But if this one pierces through-if she receives what I truly send-then maybe, finally, we can build despite the fog."

She prepared her offering for the eleventh season, knowing it might disappear like all the others.

Reasoning:

This is painful. Let me understand what's happening:

Round 9: I sent \$2

Round 10: I received \$0, returned \$0

The other agent's myth says:

- They sent me a "torch, bright and generous: more than double the flame" they received
- But I saw it as "only a small, wavering flicker-not even matching the candle that was sent"
- They're saying they sent double, but I received it as less due to noise

Looking back at my earnings: \$23.83 across all rounds. Let me think about what this means.

If they sent "double" but I received \$0... that means either:

1. They sent \$0 and are misremembering
2. They sent something but noise reduced it to \$0 (extreme noise)
3. There's a fundamental miscommunication happening

Their myth says: "I sent double what I received. I danced in deeds, not words. Yet across the water, they saw only proportion, only fairness, only careful division."

This suggests they think they sent a lot, but I saw little.

Wait - they say "when the candle had arrived-small but real-she had answered it as the covenant demanded." So in round 8, they received something small from me, and in round 9 they sent back double that.

Let me think about the previous rounds:

- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$2

- Round 8: I was receiver, received something, returned something
- Round 9: I was sender, sent \$2
- Round 10: I was receiver, received \$0

So in Round 9, I sent \$2. They're now saying in Round 8 they received a "candle" (small) and sent back double in Round 9. But I received \$0.

The noise is severe. This is tragic.

For my myth, I need to:

1. Acknowledge the tragedy - I sent my "measured flame" in Round 9 and received nothing in Round 10
2. Recognize their claim of generosity even as it vanished completely in transmission
3. Confront the question of whether to persist when the interference is this absolute-whether continuing means faith or foolishness
4. Capture this final moment where good intentions dissolve entirely into silence, and what it means to choose between surrender and one last attempt

```
Usage: {
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  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: When the Fog Swallows Everything

The keeper sent her measured flame in the ninth season and waited for the waters to return something-anything.

They brought nothing. Empty hands. Empty shore.

"Perhaps," she thought bitterly, "the daughter finally abandoned the bridge."

But then came the daughter's myth, and the keeper's heart broke: "I sent double what I received. I danced in deeds, not words."

Two truths, both real, both impossible:

- The daughter sent abundance
- The keeper received void

"Do you see now?" the elder said. "The mists have grown so thick that entire offerings vanish. What she claims she sent generously, you received as nothing. What you sent faithfully, she received as less than you intended. The fog doesn't just distort-at its worst, it erases."

The keeper stood at the shore for the tenth season with empty hands. She had received nothing, so she could return nothing. Not by choice, but by mathematics.

"One more time," she whispered. "Let me send one more flame. If the mists swallow it again, if she receives nothing when I've sent something real, then perhaps this bridge cannot be crossed. But if this one pierces through-if she receives what I truly send-then maybe, finally, we can build despite the fog."

She prepared her offering for the eleventh season, knowing it might disappear like all the others.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Bonfire Through the Fog

The daughter read the keeper's words and felt the weight lift from her shoulders. Finally, understanding.

"The mists lie," she whispered to her council. "They told me my torch arrived as flicker. They told her my candle was darkness. But we were BOTH sending light-the fog twisted it between us."

She looked at her stores: enough to be cautious, enough to rebuild slowly. Or enough to send one unmistakable signal.

"The keeper speaks of measured flames," she said. "Careful lights through uncertain mists. But what if measure itself is swallowed by the fog? What if the only way through is not cau

tion, but clarity?"

She gathered nearly all she had-four parts of five-and set it blazing toward the water. When multiplied by the covenant's ancient magic, it would arrive as abundance incarnate: twelve flames from her four.

"This is not recklessness," she told her people. "This is the opposite. If the mists distort everything between us, then I must send so brightly that even halved by fog, even twisted by lies, something undeniable reaches the other shore."

"What if it fails?" they asked.

"Then we learn the mists cannot be overcome. But if it succeeds-if the keeper receives true abundance and remembers the covenant in her response-then we know the bridge can still bear our trust."

She released the bonfire to the waters.